

NATALIE'S SEDUCTION

arnica butler



Thirteenth Line Publications



NATALIE'S SEDUCTION

A Wife-Sharing Novel

By Arnica Butler

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TO THE READER

Natalie's Seduction is designed to be enjoyable as a standalone novel, although there is a prequel to this book, [*The Houseguest*](#). As I explained in the preface to *The Houseguest*, I set out with the intention of writing a book that dealt with the couple's long-term experiences in hotwifing. By splitting the story in two, I found a way to force myself to do just that – *The Houseguest* is about their decision to try out the lifestyle, and this novel finds them in the middle of their adventures.

I'm very happy with the result, and I hope you are, too. As always, thank you for your support, and thanks to my BETA readers, who have greatly improved the quality of this book with their suggestions and edits.

Enjoy!

Arnica

CHAPTER 1: MORNING

I watched my wife from the bed. She was in the semi-darkness of our bathroom, turning in the shower, as she used a giant loofah to smear a faintly floral soap over her body. I could barely see the contours of her body in the dim light that reached the bathroom from our bedroom, but I knew her body by heart and my imagination filled in the blanks: her long thighs, thin and sculpted, and the trim landing strip of fine golden-brown hair between them. Her round ass, small but firm and plumped into two spheres above her coltish legs. Her flat stomach, the elongated oval of her belly-button, and hovering over it the shape of her eminently cuppable breasts with their pink nipples. She had a golden tan now, gained by wearing bikinis in our backyard.

Bikinis, like the sodden black one that lay crumpled on the floor next to the bed, still wet with another man's cum. Bikinis like the one that she had let my friend Ethan peel away from her body and leave tangled in her long limbs while he pounded his fat cock into her as I watched, miles away in my office on a Nanny-cam screen like a pervert.

In spite of the excitement of the evening and how much I wanted to savor it and let it torture me forever, I was exhausted. I had just fucked Natalie in the ass until she screamed, and the very man who had defiled her earlier in the day, soiling her black bikini, had heard it all through the walls of our house. Natalie had become very adventurous in bed with me since embarking on her sexual adventures with Ethan, and there was something about that bothering me. As much as I wanted to savor the perverse victory over our houseguest, and maybe pry into Natalie's sudden predilection for anal sex, I dozed off. I felt her come in and snuggle next to me, and then I drifted off to sleep again in spite of myself. I knew that maybe we should have talked about what had transpired, but the pleasant effects of my climax dragged me down into a heavy slumber.

I awoke at two o'clock. Nat had rolled over and was sleeping soundly on her side. I trailed a finger down her spine (she had gone to bed naked, after discarding a damp towel on the floor – a demonstration of carefree abandon that she had not done in at least eight years) but she didn't stir. The memories of the day surfaced in my mind, and my cock got hard against her

warm body. Natalie slept on, oblivious to my needs, peacefully dreaming, unhindered by doubt or guilt. The burn of a strange kind of jealousy came over me: she wasn't obsessed, like I was. She wasn't unable to sleep, being torn apart by her desires and her guilt. It almost enraged me.

That's when my mind started going over what we had just done. Not the visceral, sexual excitement of it, but the unforgiving reality that we were now caught up in. Like I guess most men do, I hadn't really thought ahead to the inevitable consequences of my actions.

Ethan was an old friend from high school. A ladies' man, through and through, at least back in the day, and his seduction of my wife indicated that he continued to be. He had come into some bad luck, and by chance our paths had crossed at just the "right" moment. He was getting a divorce, had come back to South Carolina from Chicago, and I had seen an opportunity. An opportunity to get a long-time fantasy fulfilled.

Now it had happened, and Natalie had performed for me in the most x-rated and spectacular scene I could ever have imagined. It was the thing I had wanted, and I had put everything in motion to make it happen. I should be thrilled, and in a way I was. I couldn't deny that the events of the day had exceeded my wildest fantasies, driving me to a point of sexual obsession I thought I'd never have again in my life. Raging obsession, adolescent in feel.

But now Ethan was living in my house, fucking my wife, and I knew about it. *He* didn't know that I did, or at least I didn't think he knew that.

Betrayal – and not the fun kind – was lurking around every corner.

Betrayal lurked in Natalie. This new Natalie, as terrifying as she was hot. I loved the "new" Natalie – and she was new, wasn't she? - but I couldn't help feeling a prickle of fear when I thought of her. What place in her mind had conjured up this side of herself? Had this sexual being been there all along, and I had never known or noticed? It wasn't even as though she was the same woman I had married so long ago, and she was just getting her groove back or something. She was a woman who had transformed into someone else, and I felt a little like I had conjured a genie. Half of me wanted to put her back in a bottle, scared of what might come next. Where would she go from here? Who would she become?

Betrayal lurked inside of me. The idea of sharing Natalie with another man, not just as a one-off, stirred something really twisted inside of me. It was so convoluted, what I felt: I loved and hated the idea. I wanted to delve

into it, see how dirty and bad Natalie could be. But I might betray myself at any moment. Change my mood, shift my thoughts. And when that happened I felt terrible.

Betrayal lurked in the strange feelings of guilt I felt, of all things, about manipulating *Ethan*.

Sure, on the one hand, Ethan had really made his own bed by fucking my wife. He sort of deserved it if he got emotionally bruised up. He *really* deserved it. And what would he do now, but continue down this path? There was no way Ethan was just going to fuck Natalie and then never try to do it again. And what if Ethan started to have deeper feelings for Natalie than just wanting to screw her? It seemed unlikely, because Ethan was a real jerk... but he seemed a little different now. Actually broken up about his soon-to-be ex-wife Moira. I wouldn't want to accidentally drag a guy into an impossible love triangle – not knowingly, not deliberately. And yet... I felt even worse because I didn't feel bad *enough* about it to actually stop what we were doing.

I had a secret half-hope that Ethan would feel so bad about having fucked Natalie that he would just spontaneously move out.

That would solve everything.

But I knew, deep down inside, that there was no point hoping for it to happen. Natalie had been... well, far too seductive for that.

It seemed that either we would have to continue down this path, letting Natalie and Ethan carry on their "affair" (and I admit the possibilities delighted me)... or do something to put a stop to it. Like tell Ethan that we had choreographed it.

Or tell him to move out.

Any way that the future panned out in my thoughts, it gave me a knot in my stomach.

I had all those thoughts mixing around in my mind as I drifted off to sleep, along with all the lurid, liquid details of the naughty things Natalie had done. The details of her slutty performance, both beautiful and terrifying.

Somewhere in the twilight of sleep, I promised myself to talk to Natalie about it the next day. When I was almost asleep, a final thought emerged from my memory, dislocated, having not much to do with anything. It was of my geography teacher/football coach from ninth grade, Mr. MacMillan.

He had made the observation that there was never any growth from stagnation, that you had to push yourself if you wanted to stay alive.

He had probably been coaching us in some demented football drill at the time. And on that note, I faded out.

Among a lot of other disturbing dreams, I dreamed that Natalie sneaked out of the room in the middle of the night, and when I went to search for her, I found her in Ethan's bed. The dream lingered when I awoke, and I turned sharply to find Natalie sitting on the bed, facing the window. She was stretching her arms above her head, and her long bare torso was silhouetted by the early light, giving her an ethereal quality.

The dream had a disturbing quality, the kind of dark film that lingers when you dream that someone has wronged you and you feel strange in their real presence. I glared at Natalie, and she caught my look when she turned around, smiling at me. She picked up her pillow to cover my face. "Don't start the day out grumpy," she said.

There was also, undeniably, a lingering effect of the dream on my cock, which throbbed with an ache that was far from being imagined. I pushed the pillow away and trailed my finger down Natalie's spine again. I watched her shiver slightly with my touch.

It was then that the dream started to brighten in my mind: after all, it was actually giving me a very good, very dirty idea. Because what if Natalie *had* sneaked off in the middle of the night to fuck Ethan?

"I have an idea for something that will change my mood," I said.

Natalie looked over at me again, gazing down, her long hair tousled and her eyes sort of wet with sleepiness. She smiled. "Oh you do, do you?"

Then her eyes traveled down my body, to where the shape of my erection was making an obvious tent in the sheets. She raised her eyebrows.

But she swung her legs back up onto the bed. As she did, I caught a whiff of her scent, and it occurred to me that Natalie might have her own reasons to already be excited.

Her *own* dreams about Ethan.

She propped herself up on her side, her head in her hand and her elbow on the bed. She dove under the sheets with her free hand, and felt for my cock. She rubbed her thumb over the crown, and I could feel the slipperiness of precum lubricating her touch.

Like any guy (so I hear), I usually had some kind of erection going on first thing the morning, but nothing like this. And it usually faded away pretty quickly, because no one had time for that kind of thing in the morning around here. The kids were away right now, but they usually caused Natalie to hop out of bed before I could even get to her.

Today, however, she smiled at me, and gripped my cock firmly in her hand. She moved her hand up and down my shaft in languid strokes. “So what were you dreaming about?” she purred.

I slid my fingers down her body and into the folds of her pussy. As I had suspected, she was wet. Sopping wet; my fingers were coated in her slippery juices in a quick second, and I could feel her excitement dripping down between her legs. “What were *you* dreaming about?” I said.

She smiled at me. She let her hand fall down, so her head was resting on the length of it, and she moved her face closer to mine. Her lips were close to my mouth, and I could feel her breath as she formed her next words. They came to me in hot little puffs of air, tickling me with a moist warmth I couldn’t help imagining on my cock. “You tell me first,” she said.

Her fingers were making tantalizing circles over the head of my cock now, and I shuddered with the almost painful excitement she was generating. “I dreamed you sneaked off to see Ethan in the middle of the night,” I said.

“Mmm,” she said, in a very feline expression of interest. “And did you come and watch?”

She bit into my lower lip as I half-mumbled: “Of course.”

Natalie ran her tongue along my upper lip, just the tip of it, tickling my mouth while her thumb made a sweep over the crown of my cock. “I really liked what we did last night,” she said.

It’s hard, really, to even describe the jolt that went through me. It was like someone filled the shell of my body with my adolescent self. And not just my everyday adolescent self – my adolescent self about two seconds from scoring with my first girl. An image of my cock sliding in and out of Natalie’s ass burned through my mind, and I almost had a seizure as her words sank in along with the action of her hands.

I just breathed like an open-mouthed moron. This was totally uncharted territory and I was half-certain it was a dream.

Natalie pulled herself closer to me by pulling on my shoulder. “I *really* liked it. I liked it so much I *thought* about sneaking off to Ethan’s

room and seeing if he could help me out...”

My cock bounced around wildly at this last bit, even though she had it in her hand.

Natalie moved closer and put a leg up and over mine. I started to move toward her, ready to plunge inside of her, but she stopped me with a gentle push. She moved her other hand down to hold my cock, and used her right hand to dip into the folds of her pussy and draw the moisture to my shaft.

It took me a moment to realize that she was lubricating it.

I tried again, thinking it might just be easier if I sank into her cunt, but she pushed gently and shook her head.

The full, filthy lewdness of what we were doing – what she seemed about to be ready to let me do to her – filled my blood with boiling lust. I dipped my own hand into her folds, and then down, down to her ass. She was so incredibly wet, I supposed there was no way she wasn’t telling the truth. I dipped a finger into her ass, and she bit her lower lip. “Go slow,” she whispered. “I’m a little sore.”

I pulled her forward toward me and then pushed her face down on the bed as I threw the covers up and got on my knees behind her. I reached for the pillows she had pushed aside at the top of the bed, and I stuffed them under her pelvis, raising her ass to me. I pulled her legs apart. Her inner thighs were sticky and wet with her excitement; the sweeter-than-usual scent rose to my nostrils and my cock flexed with heightened need.

I dipped my hand into the overflowing folds of her cunt, and drew the liquid oozing from them up to her ass. Unlike last night, her hole was tight but no longer light pink: a light reddish hue colored it, and it was a little distended. I pushed my pointer finger in, and Natalie gasped. But her ass opened for me, much more easily this time, and I rubbed my finger along the silky insides of her, pushing out against her tight walls, pressing her open. I twisted my hand and dipped my other fingers into her pussy to get them slippery with her juices. Then one at a time, I slipped them in along with my pointer finger.

Natalie moaned into the mattress, her hands on either side of her in a display of submission that drove me insane. This was a side of Natalie that I had never even imagined seeing.

Or feeling.

I stared at my own hand as though I were on another planet, as my third finger sank into her ass, and I pumped my hand slowly in and out of her stretched hole.

I used my other hand to coat my cock with her juices.

“You’re sure,” I panted, though I don’t even know why: if she had said she wasn’t, was there any stopping me at this point? Unlikely.

Natalie lifted her head and moaned. “I want you to fill me up,” she said.

Jesus.

I pulled my fingers out of her quickly, and guided my cock to her hole. Even in that short time her ass spasmed to a smaller opening. I pushed through it, and she squeezed around the head of my cock, almost too tight to get in. But the sphincter of her ass slowly opened, almost like it was unraveling, and my cock sank into her hot flesh for the second time in less than twelve hours.

I pushed all the way in, and waited until I could feel her relax around my cock. Then I began to fuck her slowly. I was very near coming already, and I wanted this to last again. It was hard: I couldn’t keep the memory of my cock bursting inside of her the night before from surfacing in my mind, egging me to feel the hot liquid gushing around my cock and her ass again.

“Wait,” Natalie said, and she impatiently pulled the pillows out from under her. Then she leaned forward until my cock flopped out of her ass.

She flipped over. “I want to try it like this,” she said.

I stared at her, still reeling from the abrupt change in sensation and the gloom that was slowly coming over me. Then I understood, as she lifted her legs high, up by her ankles. The juices from her pussy drained down, over her ass.

I guided my cock to her gaping hole, and this time I slid in easily. Her body rubbed against my cock differently this way, with more pressure, and it was sensational. I pushed forward and up to get my cock deep in her ass, and her mouth fell open. A little water formed in the corner of one eye, and dripped down her cheek. She pulled me closer to her, though, so that my body pushed hers up, sort of rolling her backward. She bent her knees and her ankles flopped against my back.

Her body was sealed up tight around my cock now, and I could barely thrust in and out. But together, we could grind, my cock deep inside of her, spreading her open.

Filling her up, just like she wanted.

She pushed her pelvis against me and rocked back and forth: it was only then that I saw the genius of this contorted position: my pelvis was grinding against her clit.

I hung on for dear life as she ground against me, rubbing her ass up and down the lower half of my shaft. I was almost relieved when finally I felt her body grow stiff and she fucked me harder, then she squeezed her eyes closed and gave a sharp yell. Her ass clenched around my cock and I pushed up, thrusting deep into her as my cum filled her ass to overflowing. Again.

I collapsed on the bed next to Natalie, and rolled over. She pulled her legs together, but didn't move much more than that. She pulled the sheets up over her.

I had no idea what to say, which was a strange feeling. All the excitement I had just felt was slowly fading, and the reality – this weird reality – of what we were doing was coming back into focus.

Natalie turned to me. She mocked my expression, frowning severely. “Why the long face?” she said.

Why, indeed?

“I don't have a long face,” I said. I propped myself up on my hand and caressed her body through the sheets. “That was just... intense.” I said.

Natalie said nothing. She looked at the ceiling and squinted her eyes.

“I didn't mean that to sound bad,” I said quickly. “I'm just... you have to admit it's pretty far off our usual...” I waved a hand in the air, struggling for the right word. “Path.”

Natalie looked over at me by turning her head a little. “You don't like it?” she said.

I shook my head, “it's not that, it's just... I guess I'm surprised *you* like it... you've just... surprised me is all.”

Natalie sat up. She looked down at me. Then she threw the covers off and flipped her legs over to get out of bed.

“Hey wait,” I said, pulling at her shoulder. She stopped and took a deep breath.

“I'm sorry,” I said, and I genuinely meant it even if I genuinely wasn't sure what I was apologizing for. “I... what's got you so upset?”

She looked back at me. “What has me so *upset*?” she repeated.

I cringed inwardly.

She rolled her eyes. Then she started to stand up again.

Ah yes. The classic. I was supposed to know, and if I didn't, she wasn't going to tell me.

"Nat -"

She stood up, and picked the towel up off the floor to hastily tie it around her. "I can't believe that you are lukewarm on this, when it's like... your idea. Your fantasy. And now you're going to, what?"

I held up a hand to make a sign that she should calm down.

I'm never sure why I do that. It only pisses her off.

She stomped into the bathroom.

"Nat. No... wait... that isn't what's going here."

"Then what is?" she snapped, turning on the water to the shower.

"Hey," I said, turning off the water and pulling her to me. "No... don't get upset.... Look, you have this all wrong. I'm sorry. I... can you please just come here and sit down on the bed with me?"

I pulled her with me to the bed, and held her to my chest. I kissed her head. "Listen... I know I seem a little... out of sorts. It's just.. a big thing -"

"But you *wanted* this -"

"And I do. I still do. I still... look, I know I wanted this, and I'm happy you did it, but it's just... a lot to take in, you know? I just... I love you, and this is something I want, but it's... I don't know, it's harder than I thought it was going to be."

Natalie looked up at me. Her face was questioning.

I looked down at my feet. "I think I feel, maybe... look, it's not you, it's not anything about you."

But was that true? Part of what was eating me *was* Natalie. How she had thrown herself into the idea, how she was getting wilder and wilder in bed, in such a short amount of time that it really made me question what I had unleashed, and why it had been locked away all through our marriage, and what would happen now. Would she always be like this? Would she just keep getting wilder and wilder, until she became insatiable? Would she get a hankering for fucking other men, and I wouldn't be able to stop her?

But I didn't feel like dealing with any of that right then.

I deflected.

"This is going to sound weird," I said. "But I feel kind of bad tricking Ethan. Like... maybe we should tell him to move out. Or come clean about

what's going on. Tell him the truth."

She frowned. She went deadly, unhappily silent.

"What?" I said.

She fell onto the bed, and stared at the ceiling, pulling the sheets up over her, almost as if she wanted more modesty.

A bad feeling coated the inside of my body.

"*You're* not feeling sorry for him now, are you?"

It was a strange question, given that I had just claimed to feel sorry for him, and I seemed to now be angry at *her* for feeling sorry for him.

Natalie pressed her lips together. "Not... well..."

"Because he *did* fuck his friend's wife," I said. It sounded harsher than I meant it to, but something about Natalie's attitude was making me wildly uncomfortable, getting the paranoia flowing again in my veins. I wasn't even really sure why, given that I had just suggested the idea of telling him because *I* had feelings of guilt.

I just... didn't want Natalie to feel that way.

Deep down inside, I wanted Natalie to feel the opposite way. I wanted Natalie to view him as someone to be used to further my fantasy and then discard.

I had also sort of wanted Natalie to call me out on trying to change the subject. To know that there was something deeper bothering me, something else about her. Instead, she was diving right into this "feeling sorry for Ethan" racket.

She shot me a look. "I mean... okay, but *we* set him up."

My jealousy flared. My face stung with anger.

It was just as I had suspected, she was getting feelings for him. My thoughts charged ahead with this idea like a freight train.

"Are you getting feelings for him?" I attacked.

Natalie sat up and pressed a hand flat to my chest. "Hey," she said. "Calm down. Don't be like that."

"Like what?"

I was pouting, and that riled me even more. I knew that even if I was right, and Natalie was getting feelings for Ethan, I really didn't have the right to complain. That had been the gamble, that had been the thrill – that Natalie's feelings were on the table. But it was burning a hole through my head just thinking about it.

You're such a fucking idiot, Erik, I told myself.

“Erik!” Natalie's voice was a sharp whisper. She snapped her fingers above my face. “Look, don't blow this out of proportion. I just... I feel for the guy. You weren't there when he was talking about his wife, he's really beat up about the divorce.”

The idea of Natalie having a heart-to-heart with Ethan about his divorce incensed me to the point I couldn't even talk. I just moved my mouth like a stupid fish.

“Don't you see,” I finally seethed, “that that's all just a bunch of shit he told you to get you to fuck him?”

Natalie sat up like a bolt of lightening and threw the covers off of herself. She folded up to her knees and looked down at me with the most vicious expression I had ever seen on her face. “*Excuse me?*” she said.

I raised my eyebrows.

My brain *was* reviewing the words that had just come out of my mouth, and I *did* have a sneaking suspicion that I had said something incredibly stupid, and I was just getting around to what it was, when Natalie sorted it for me:

“Do you think,” she said, waving a hand around as if there were an audience in the room, “that I am such a fucking *idiot*, that I'm some bimbo, who doesn't have any idea when a guy is lying to me to get into my pants? Is it... do you actually think I would just be *so* bowled over by him crying about his divorce that I would go have sex with him upstairs? You *told me* to do this!” She jutted her chin and looked at the ceiling. “Agghh!” she hollered. “I swear to God!” She stood up and stomped into the bathroom.

I'll confess: this turned me on quite a bit.

But I had problems to solve, so I flung myself wildly around in my mind, searching for answers.

“Nat,” I said, to buy myself some time.

She started brushing her teeth like she wanted them to fall out of her mouth.

“Okay, that was out of line.”

She spat into the sink. “You think?”

She started brushing again.

I looked at my hands. “Look, I just...”

She stopped brushing and raised her eyebrows at me in the mirror.

“Whuh? Though I wuh some kinuh idiot? Well, I'm not.”

She wiped a bit of dribbled toothpaste from her chin angrily. Then she spat, tossed the toothbrush at the sink and headed for the shower. "I don't even know what the point of this conversation is anymore."

Well, that made two of us. What *was* the point of this conversation?

I got out of bed and approached the shower slowly.

I was less and less clear on why she was so angry.

Natalie got pretty ticked if someone insinuated that she had been conned or done something stupid. I hadn't meant that... had I? I flipped through the conversation I'd just had.

Oh.

I had.

"It isn't that," I said after a while. "It's..."

Nat turned slowly in the shower, like I wasn't even there.

What was it? Why had I lashed out at her like that?

"Look, it makes me sort of touchy that you're talking about Ethan's feelings," I admitted.

It stung, admitting that.

Natalie stopped turning circles in the shower and wiped the steam away from the glass door to stare at me. She looked like she was about to yell something, but then she stepped back. The water from the shower ran down her body, and the steam slowly fogged up the glass again. Her pretty nipples, her trimmed snatch, her softly curved thighs faded away. "I don't get it," she said.

Her voice was, to my relief, a degree cooler.

I was cold, myself. Actually cold.

"Can I come in there?" I said. "I'm freezing."

No answer for a moment, and I was sure I was in the doghouse for real, when she erupted in a snort. "Explain this nonsense to me and I'll let you in," she said.

I cast a glance at the towels about five feet away. They were a better bet than me trying to explain myself, but I leaned on the shower and looked up at the ceiling. I let out a sigh. "Okay. It's... look, I know this sounds shitty, but... I'm not okay with you... I don't know, feeling sorry for Ethan or having some kind of..."

"Emotional relationship?" she offered.

I shrugged. "With him," I finished.

Natalie turned off the water. The door popped open. “Look,” she said. She pointed at a towel and I leaned over to grab it and hand it to her, for some reason not wanting to move my feet. She wrapped it around herself and pushed some water out of her face. I tried very hard – and failed – not to stare at the rivulets of water snaking down her chest, between her breasts, traveling down to her patch of snatch. “I’m not having an emotional relationship with him. I just... think the thing you’ve proposed is... harsh. I mean, the guy *did* just get divorced.”

“And then hop into bed with his friend’s wife,” I said.

Natalie wrung out her hair. “You *are*...” she shook her head, unable to find an appropriate word to finish her sentence.

“I know,” I said. I didn’t have a word for myself either, but I got the gist of it.

Natalie stepped toward me and rested her arms on my shoulders. The towel slipped loose without falling off her body. “Look,” she said. “I’m only doing this because we agreed to do it. It’s fun. It’s exciting, but... Ethan’s not my kind of guy.”

“So you aren’t attracted to him?” I said, furrowing my brow. I was actually amazed this conversation was somehow getting back on track after such a major derailment.

Natalie kissed me and leaned close to me. She pressed her body against me, and I was sure she could feel my erection through the towel. “I mean, I’m *attracted* to him,” she said, grabbing my cock and giving it a squeeze. “Just not... *attracted* to him.”

“So you don’t “like-him,” like him,” I said, rolling my eyes and using the elementary-school language to indicate that I felt this was infantile, but deep down inside really desperate to hear an answer to the question.

Natalie laughed. “I don’t “like-him” like him. I “like-like” Erik Ossington.”

She squeezed my cock again.

“I have another plan,” she said. “For taking care of the... predicament we’ve created. And I think maybe you’ll like it.”

Natalie’s plan, which I got half of before she pushed me into the shower and then, once I was cleaned up, sucked the fountain of cum from my cock while still on her knees. The other half I received later.

It was reckless and dangerous and way too delicious to turn down.

It solved my problems of guilt with Ethan without having to resort to telling him what we had done.

It got him out of the house.

It gave me another opportunity to watch my wife get fucked by Ethan, and she made all sorts of promises that drove me wild, which is why we had to take a break in the middle of her plan.

And it also left the door open for Ethan to seduce my wife away from me, or for everything Natalie had just told me to be an elaborate lie designed to buy her some time with Ethan without me realizing she was cheating on me, and also it was just...

Crazy.

"I like it," I said, still out of breath from her blowjob and from spewing my cum into her mouth. A vague sense of worry was throbbing inside of me every time Natalie had sex with me. It grew each time that Natalie did something so... unusual. Hot, for sure, but unlike herself. Swallowing my cum was definitely not her thing, just like anal had never been her thing... and now it seemed like new thing after new thing surfaced.

I couldn't help but be paranoid, even while I enjoyed it as much as I did.

And I couldn't help but agree to her plan.

"Okay," she said, shimmying into a pair of red boy-short bikini bottoms. She snapped the material into place and gave me a twirl. Somehow, these shorts were even more sexy than the black bikini, riding along the mid-line of the curve of her ass. Part of her ass peeked out from the bottom, and the remainder tantalized from behind the fabric. It also gave her legs an especially coltish appearance.

This was the other suit Natalie had promised to show me the night before.

Which reminded me...

"So how is it you guys ended up going shopping?" I said. At some point yesterday, she and our houseguest had ended up shopping together. Which I found... disconcerting, to say the least.

She slipped a red top over her head and pulled it into position over her breasts. It was a sporty suit, with a deep plunge in the center that let her breasts tease the same way the shorts did. It was a dark red, and it looked good against her bronzing summer skin. She looked really confused for a

moment, and then recognition flickered on her face. “Oh... you know,” she said, looking down and using her hands to put her breasts into position.

I frowned.

She looked up at me and smiled. “Ethan needed a suit,” she said, shrugging. “So we could go to the pool.”

“Did he try on his suits for you?” I couldn’t hide my hopeful tone.

Natalie rolled her eyes. “Do guys even do that? He grabbed one off the rack.” She twisted her body for my approval. I nodded, and my eyes took a very lecherous walk over her body.

“Oh,” she said. “What you really want to know is if *he* watched *me* try on suits. ”

She walked toward me, her head cocked. She put a finger to her lips and teased me by biting on it. “I may have asked for some input.”

My cock throbbed.

“How else is a girl supposed to arrange these things?” She walked past me to a pile of clothes on a basket next to the door.

“And then what happened? At the pool?”

She was slipping on some cutoffs now. They seemed to be a new pair. She smiled mysteriously. “Well... suntanning, swimming... I think he put some lotion on my back.” She winked at me. “I wonder where he’ll put it today?”

And then just as quickly as you could say “boo,” she threw open the bedroom door and said loudly, and almost too theatrically: “They *can’t* be serious! That doesn't give you a lot of time!”

She winked at me and ducked out of the bedroom.

Natalie, dear Natalie, was putting her plan into action.

CHAPTER 2: NATALIE'S PLANS

Ethan wasn't out of his room for Natalie's performance, which it would seem involved building a credible background of events for her ultimate plan. She marched cheerfully into the kitchen anyway and started making breakfast for three.

I watched her in her sporty red bikini, and her cheerful demeanor began bringing the same state of unease into me that I had felt this morning, and the night before, and generally, since Ethan had moved in. Larger and larger doses of it each day. Natalie's ponytail swung *so* cheerfully, and she seemed so confident of herself and her plan, and so excited about it, that I could barely recognize her at all.

Natalie wasn't a girl who *lacked* confidence, that was for sure, but this particular kind of confidence was a new thing in her. It was a sexual, almost *predatory* confidence.

I watched her as she stood on tiptoe and reached for some cups. Her smooth bottom peeked out from the sliver of red bikini that peeked out of the cutoffs. She was moving like she hadn't just let someone have anal sex with her – twice - for the first time in her life.

I couldn't help it. I couldn't help let the suspicions rise and cover me with their horrible warmth. The insinuation behind it all. Maybe all this time I'd been married to a woman who was actually someone else. It was too juicy to just set aside.

Too juicy, and too awful, to imagine.

Natalie turned on the blender to make me a shake, and she held the lid on and turned around to face me as she did, her hand sassily placed on her hip.

She smiled. But past me, over my head. Then she quickly turned and flipped the blender to off.

"Hey there, darlin.'"

I looked behind me to see Ethan running his fingers through his hair. He looked rough. He smelled like a gin mill, and I had little flash of pleasure snake through me thinking that he had probably heard all the commotion in our room, and felt jealous, and had too many drinks.

Ethan looked a little like a dark, American version of Gordon Ramsay. He wasn't the kind of guy that would end up on the cover of GQ – his looks were a little too hard for that. But women changed in his presence, because he was athletic and commanding. He had the definitive cool stare of an alpha male.

"Sorry, Ethan," Natalie said, falling all over herself with apologetic giggles. "This thing is from the eighties."

It was, actually, from the eighties. But it wouldn't die, so we kept it. It took me a second to understand that she was apologizing for the noise from the blender.

Ethan gave me a nod, and walked over to the kitchen. If he had burned with jealousy the night before, or I had somehow shaken him from his alpha-male throne, he was back on it in fine form today. He strode over to the bacon Natalie was cooking (the shake was for me, the bacon for Ethan) and took a piece straight out of the pan without flinching at all. He bit into it as he turned to Natalie and smiled. "Mmm-mmm!" he declared, in a mumble that even sounded especially Southern.

I half expected him to slap Natalie on the ass after this, so sexual and dominating had that "mmm-mmm" sounded. And standing there, in a picture of domesticity – Ethan's hastily thrown-on gray shirt and boxer shorts, Natalie's swimsuit that looked like a sports bra, frying bacon – it would not have been unusual at all to see that. *They* looked like the married couple, and *I* felt like the voyeur. A sort of camaraderie sparkled between them.

Ethan bit through the bacon, and then he extended it to Natalie. I thought she was going to bite into it – I was wishing she would – but she shook her head. "I'm eating healthy today," she said cheerfully, patting the blender.

A small victory for me, though Ethan seemed unfazed by it. He stuffed the bacon into his mouth and crunched it loudly. Then he turned the stove off and moved the pan. "It's perfect!" he said, slapping his hands together. "Well, gang, what are we doing today?"

He looked at me. "Lawyer stuff for you, I see," he said. His voice was cheerful, but I was sure I picked up on a hint of challenge underneath it.

I rubbed my eye.

Ethan wasn't "challenging" me. I reminded myself that he didn't know that I knew he had fucked my wife.

I looked at him.

Or did he? Was there a twinkle in his eye? He almost seemed to be winking at me.

He turned to Natalie. "Mrs. Ossington? You have big plans for the day I see."

Natalie was pouring her smoothie into two glasses. A large chunk of frozen fruit plopped into one of the glasses and splashed on to her stomach before she could answer.

"Shit," she said.

She looked down at herself and used her ring finger to scoop the glob of smoothie from her stomach. Then she lifted her finger to her mouth and sucked the mixture off.

The white, creamy smoothie.

She sucked it like she was sucking it off someone's cock. She closed her lips around the tip of her finger slowly, so that the tickling movement of her tongue was visible just before she sealed her lips on her own flesh. She did this while she looked at Ethan.

For just a second too long.

There was a silence, one that was also just a little too long. The silence gave the gesture a little flick, right out of the category "appropriate and G-rated." And then she turned back to the blender and dumped the contents of the glass into it. "It's summer," she said, picking up the conversation as though nothing had happened at all. "I plan to bake by the pool until I'm covered in sweat."

There was another pause, during which no one moved and it was painfully obvious that everyone was taking a second to conjure an image of Natalie covered in sweat, picturing each little droplet nestled between her breasts or rolling down her inner thigh to get soaked up by her red swimsuit.

Or not.

Ethan grinned, and then got himself another piece of bacon.

Natalie turned on the blender and looked back at me.

Did she wink?

Was she playing this game just for me? Or was she playing us both? I wondered.

She poured my smoothie for me, and after a look at the time, I asked her if she could find a to-go cup. Ethan wandered away, munching on his

third piece of bacon.

Natalie leaned over the counter as she handed me the smoothie. I had a nice view of her pert breasts, snuggling together in the confines of her bikini. She ran her fingers along either side of the glass, and the metaphor was easily drawn between the glass and cock she was stroking sinuously. “Don’t worry,” she said. “I’m in good hands for the day, and so is the plan.”

I felt like someone had stabbed me in the chest.

“Don’t... don’t forget the Nanny-cam,” I croaked.

She dipped a finger into the smoothie and brought a bit of it to her lips. So different from her normal self, so sure that such a cliched move would make my cock hard (which it did). “I’ll do my best,” she said.

Then she leaned over and kissed me.

“Later, Ethan,” I called.

“Yo.”

And so I left my wife alone with Ethan. Again.

It was the absolute worst day of my life. The longest and the worst. It dragged by minute after torturous minute.

I was behind on work from the day before. I could feel the delicate balance between utter chaos and staying afloat coming undone. Unraveling. Yet I couldn’t work for most of the day. Sandy, my paralegal, had taken a week-long vacation. It had been a bad combination with my own inability to get things done.

Figuring that Natalie would not jump on Ethan’s cock that early in the morning (though who knew?), I set out to do some work in the morning. I succeeded in taking care of three files and having a phone call I had been avoiding since the week before.

But... at 11:00 I lost my mind to thoughts about Ethan and Natalie. There were no calls from her. The Nanny-cam had been on, but there was nothing that had happened -

I clicked on the Nanny-cam app. Again. I clicked maniacally.

It was off.

I sat back in my chair.

Of course it was off. Of course it had run out batteries.

Of course I was an idiot.

I fished my phone out and wrote a text to Natalie. I typed, *nannycams off*, before I had a second thought.

What if Ethan was reading her texts?

It was a silly thought. Surely he wasn't. Surely he wasn't such an asshole that he wanted to read texts from her husband and gloat privately at what a cuckold I was?

I felt another shiver of pleasure. It was fun thinking about that, since the joke was really on him.

Unless it isn't, my inner voice suggested. *Unless Ethan is the one pulling all the strings, and you're just a fool who believes it is you.*

I didn't *really* think that was possible. I did a quick run-down of the way this whole thing had unfolded, to reassure myself.

But I deleted the text and wrote instead: *call me*.

Then I waited some more.

The minutes ticked by. Where were they now? What were they doing?

I imagined various scenarios: Natalie going to the pool; Natalie deciding to work in her studio. All of them involved Ethan waiting, waiting like I was waiting. Maybe he was sitting in the yard, flipping through a magazine. Natalie was walking by, right at this moment, her hips swinging, stripped down to just her bikini. What would he do? Reach out and touch her leg? Pull her toward him, stroking the back of her knee until goosebumps ran along the back of her leg? Maybe right this moment he was pressing his lips to her leg, right on the inside of her thigh, right above her knee. Then moving up slowly, slowly...

Just then, a cold realization chilled my blood. My thoughts stopped cold.

Ethan.

Ethan was not the kind of guy to wait around all day for Natalie to do some painting, go to the pool, walk by him a few times before he snapped his tongue out like frog and reeled her in.

The back of my neck itched.

Ethan would have gone after her right away. As soon as I walked out the door.

After all, what was stopping him? He had already done something bad. Already crossed the line. He had already tasted plenty of sweet Natalie, why not get some more? Why wait?

I flicked my eyes back and forth from my phone to the Nanny-cam.

I bet I could have seen them together if I had just driven around the block after leaving, and sneaked back to the house.

I could have surprised them.
Or I could have watched.
My heart rate skyrocketed.
No messages.
No change in the Nanny-cam.
I took out a file and tried desperately to focus my thoughts on it.
I had work to do. I couldn't spend my days like this.

I managed to get some work done. By then it was 2:00. I was hungry, and I had been for hours, but it only made its way into my consciousness at that time. I was working at a snail's pace, falling further and further behind. I was grateful that Sandy would be back from vacation at the end of the week, though it burned me that she would find the office in a shambles. She liked to believe, as a lot of paralegals did, that she did all the work and was the real lawyer, while I just had the expensive degree that allowed me to collect money. It fried me that I would be feeding into her fantasy, but I was too obsessed with my own to do anything but let the work pile up.

I called Natalie at 2:15. There was no answer on her cell. I set the phone down and pushed myself up from the desk. I tried to take a few steps and leave, but I was overcome and picked the land line up and dialed the home phone number.

I then realized that if she and Ethan were entangled in some convoluted plot, they could be sitting there, watching the calls come in, laughing about what a maniac I was being. Ignoring me. Ignoring my desperation together, lying on their bare stomachs in our bed, laughing.

"Hello?"

I paused for a long moment, considering the sound and quality of Natalie's voice. She sounded...

Absolutely normal.

"Natalie," I breathed.

I did not sound normal.

There was a strange pause on the other end, during which time I imagine Natalie held the phone away from her and squinted at it. "Hon?" she said. "Why are you calling this phone?" She sounded annoyed. Then her voice changed. "Is something wrong?"

Is something wrong.

“Where’s your cell?” I said, after struggling with a few possible answers.

“Oh,” Natalie said, but she didn’t elaborate.

I wondered what she was doing right at that moment. If Ethan had come up behind her, sliding his hands over her bare stomach. Maybe she was naked... maybe he had his fingers in her cunt.

“Damn,” Natalie said. “Sorry. I completely forgot about that.”

“What?” I said, idiotically confused.

“I’ve just been *really busy* all morning.”

I stared at the wall of my office. My brain was slowly making its way to what she was telling me, and why she was telling me like this.

Slowly.

“In the shed.”

“Uh...” Now that I was keying in on what I *thought* she was saying, I was having a hard time processing my next thought. “Is Ethan there?”

“Yeah, my next painting is really coming along.”

I felt something snap in my brain. Suddenly the synapses started firing, and I was playing right along.

“So he’s there right now?”

“Mmmm.... Sure.”

Man, she was good. Covering the conversation completely. I was at a loss for what to say for a moment, when I suddenly remembered that Ethan couldn’t hear *me*. “And you haven’t done anything all morning?”

“Uh... well, like I said, I got *really busy*. So... maybe you can just pick it up on your way home? Do you mind?”

I breathed into the phone. “You had sex already?” Jealousy was consuming me.

Natalie giggled. It took me a moment to realize that it wasn’t for me, or in response to me. Ethan was right there. Probably breathing in the scent of the back of her neck.

“I’m really sorry,” Natalie said, and her voice sounded sincere. “I just got carried away. I can’t wait for you to see what I’ve done, though. But listen...” her voice trailed off a little, and I thought I heard her suck in her breath. Was Ethan standing behind her right now, sliding his fingers into her panties, dipping into her welling juices, making her bite her lip?

Maybe not. Natalie’s voice was office-manager efficient when she said: “No problem. So you’ll be home around six?”

“Maybe earlier,” I said, and my voice was low and monotone. I could barely squeeze the air from my chest.

“See you then... oh no, don’t worry. I’m probably going to work until then anyway. Things are going really well.”

“You’re very bad, Natalie.”

“I love you too.”

And then she hung up.

I had almost no thoughts as I gathered my things – and by that I mean the bare minimum necessary to drive my car home. I left my briefcase, and I left the lights and computer on. I had almost no thoughts as I drove home in the early afternoon lull that comes over every town in the South. It was scorching hot and I forgot to turn on the AC for a few blocks. I only realized it when a drop of sweat splashed into my eye and stung so badly I was momentarily shaken from my stupor.

No thoughts. Just a re-play of Natalie’s calm, collected voice on the phone.

I can’t wait for you to see what I’ve done.

I’m probably going to work until then anyway.

I was assuming that by “work” Natalie meant fucking Ethan. And I was assuming that she would show me what she had done by spreading her legs and letting me look at the swollen, gushing mess of her unfaithful pussy.

And I was assuming, or just plain hoping, that Natalie’s final words had been a plea, or a suggestion, to come home early so I could get a glimpse of what she had been working on all day – while she was still working on it.

I parked down the street and around the corner. There was a park there that led down to a bike path that no one used, because it cut through a swampy area and was perpetually swarming with mosquitoes. My convoluted logic told me that I could always pretend I had gone to the park to look out on the wetlands.

Or something.

I had sweated profusely into my shirt, after the fiasco of not turning on the air conditioning. Or maybe it was just nerves. Either way, I prayed silently that none of my neighbors would see me. Then I set out toward our street.

I walked quickly, trying not to skulk around and look more suspicious than I already did, across the main street and into the alleyway that led to our back yard. Natalie's studio formed one part of the boundary of our property, and there was a small window that let out to the alley.

Problem? It was six and a half feet up.

I cursed myself and every bad idea I had ever had as I stomped down the alley, feeling like a total jackass but unable to stop myself. Chances were that Natalie wasn't even in her studio at this moment. Or that she was, but they weren't yet having sex. Or that I wouldn't be able to see it if they were. So many things were likely to go very, very wrong about this idea I had that I would sneak up and look through the window and see them at exactly the right moment.

So many things.

I kept walking.

When I got to the shed, I stopped and listened to the sounds from the yard.

Nothing.

I looked at the window. Even on tip-toe, the best I could do was get my forehead to the glass.

I looked up and down the alley. Then, feeling foolish beyond belief, I jumped.

I'm not proud of this. I'm not proud of the scene I was making, jumping up and down in front of the window to my own shed in the alley behind my house, trying to catch a glimpse of my wife's bare ass in Ethan's hands, or Ethan's ass pumping in and out of Natalie from behind.

What I saw instead was that I couldn't see dick if I was just jumping up and down. Which was somewhat of a relief: at least I hadn't seen Ethan staring at me through the window.

I was panting. I wiped my face on my shirt and sniffed. As I turned my head to the right, I blinked.

Right there was a huge white painter's bucket. Empty. Tossed in my neighbor Joe's grass.

I looked around the alley. Surely I was getting punked or something. *Look at the idiot, climbing on a painter's bucket to watch his wife have sex!*

I had a vision of myself as the complete fool that I was, my hair wild, my armpits soaked through, my eyes darting around the alley looking for

hidden cameras, planted by... who did I think? No matter. The vision was strong and depressing.

But not enough to stop me.

I sighed, both inwardly and outwardly, at myself and at the universe, as I turned the bucket upside down under the window of my own shed. I gave the dead-still alley another glance in both directions. With my luck, Ethan and Natalie would come home this way from a dip in the pool, and I'd be standing there like an idiot, bumbling around for some kind of explanation like a cock-crazed Clark Griswald, just before I slowly tipped over and crashed through Mark Vernon's poorly-repaired fence on the other side of the alley and got eaten alive by what I assumed was a Pitbull growling from the other side.

I put my hands on the ledge of the window and looked down at the bucket.

"Well," I said to myself. "There's nowhere to go but up from here."

I decided, halfway up, that I would peek in from the side of the window, so I had to stop and re-position the bucket. What a clown. I eased my head slowly from one side of the window and into the middle of the glass pane. Of course, the sun was reflecting the neighborhood on the glass, and the only way I was going to see was by putting my hand on the window.

I had a brief vision of myself sliding over the glass, unable to stop my own fall, as I relinquished my hold on the ledge with one of my hands.

I have a fear of heights. It manifests itself in a really strange feeling in my balls. The whole effect was less than pleasant as I sucked my breath in and held a sheltering hand to the window.

Natalie.

Natalie clad in her cutoffs and the top of her bikini. As to what was under her cutoffs, it was anyone's guess (or maybe Ethan's privilege to know). She was moving in her matter-of-fact, deliberate way, side to side, hands together then apart...

Painting.

Or better stated, cleaning up from painting.

My mind still desired to see her doing something else, so I looked around for Ethan as though I knew for certain he was in there. I really expected to see him lounging on some chair she had tucked away in there, naked, stroking his cock while he watched her work.

Stretched out on a blanket on the floor, where they had last made love like animals.

But there was no sign of anyone else in the room.

I pressed my face closer to the glass. I forgot about Ethan and got caught in the pleasurable act of spying on my own wife. Watching her work. It was fun, looking at Natalie and pretending she was some woman I didn't know. Seeing the way she pushed a strand of hair out of her face and tucked it behind her ear. Watching the way she moved her long legs to cross the room from one side to the other.

Wondering if she was wearing the bottom half of her suit, or if the seam of the cutoffs was rubbing over her clit and making her as excited as Ethan's fingers...

I watched her stir some brushes in a jar of turpentine, balancing on one foot and resting her bare foot against her calf. She looked quite young, standing like that. She pulled the brushes out and rubbed a rag along the length of the brush, wiping away the oil medium she painted with. I wondered if she still smelled like Ethan, or if she had showered. Had they fucked here? Where would they have done it?

Natalie, after some short amount of time, and about as you would predict a scene like this would end, looked up when I wobbled on the stool. The motion must have caught her eye.

Our eyes met. She yelled: "Jesus! What... *Jesus!*" And then something else I didn't hear because I was slowly muttering "Oh fuck," as the painter's bucket wobbled, my feet wobbled and over-corrected, and the whole thing went out beneath me.

As Ethan would say, I went ass over teakettle.

I landed sitting up, which was painful for my tail bone but less so for my pride. I had my arms on my knees and looked pretty cool, if such a thing was possible, by the time the gate opened and Natalie looked out. Her face was a little frantic with concern. A flush stained her cheeks.

I lifted a hand in greeting.

Her face changed from concern to surprise to understanding very quickly, and then she laughed. She walked over to where I was, and stopped the still-rolling bucket with her foot. My question about the underwear was answered. Her thigh disappeared into the shadows in only flesh-colored tones.

No red swimsuit.

No panties.

Just her cheating cunt.

“What are you doing?” she said.

I shrugged. “I have no idea.” I dusted my hands together. Truer words I have never spoken.

Natalie offered me a hand. “Ethan isn’t here. He went to run errands.”

I furrowed my brow.

“So I could work,” Natalie said, spreading her hands open as though she had just delivered an explanation of the existence of the universe. When I stared at her stupidly, she smiled. “Because I told you I had done all this work.”

She waited.

I tried to make my face look as confused as possible, which wasn’t hard.

“On the phone? But I didn’t have anything done. Because... you know. So he left so I could get something done and you’d think I was working all day and he wasn’t here?”

The end of her sentence became very fast and impatient, like she was explaining to a toddler.

My mind was slow to get there, because I got caught up in a bunch of dirty thoughts as soon as Natalie said, “But I didn’t have anything done. Because... you know.”

You know. I was fucking your friend.

But as soon as I made my way through the thoughts that were unraveling in my mind, I realized that Natalie was giving me precisely what I needed: some reassurance that she was playing Ethan, and not me. After all, why would Ethan volunteer to help her cover up what she had really been doing all day, if he knew that I knew what was going on?

I started to wonder if that made any sense.

But the thought was complicated, the possible betrayals as mixed-up as a spy novel, and my cock was throbbing, still lingering on the reasons Natalie hadn’t gotten any work done all day.

“So why don’t you show me,” I said.

She folded her arms. “What’s that?”

“What you did all day.”

Natalie laughed. “Hmm... you’ll have to come in the studio for that.”

Natalie turned around and pointed at the door, indicating I should lock it.

There was an old air conditioner humming away in the window. The shed was cool; cooler than outside but slightly warmer than the house. It was all a delicate balance that depended on what she was painting with. “Shed” was really a misnomer that we used deliberately to avoid paying property taxes on that part of the house, a trick that had been handed down from the previous owners and which we were disinclined to clear up. It was insulated and had finished floors and walls, and the previous owner, who was an electrician, had wired it. The only thing it lacked was running water.

I hadn’t been in the shed with Natalie for a long time. I usually went in and out quickly, and now that I sat there thinking about it, it was sort of a metaphor for our marriage. We didn’t really delve into each other’s lives much. Now that I was standing there, the turpentine and the oil in the air, and Natalie with her hand on a table twisting her hips seductively, a beckoning grin on her face – I wondered why that was. I had a flashback of Ethan’s words to me: *“You should pay more attention to your wife than that, man.”*

It reminded me of when we were younger, the smell and the feel of the place. The fact that it was the afternoon and it was just us, alone together.

“So,” I said. I looked around. “What were you working on all day?”

My eyes fell to a painting leaning against the wall, one that was unlike anything I would have said that Natalie painted. But before I could open my mouth to comment on it, I heard the rapid metal scrape of Natalie’s zipper. My eyes jerked back to her. She let the sides of her cutoffs fall open, and her bare skin and her neatly trimmed landing strip peeked out between them.

“So after you left, I told Ethan I had to get some work done.” She paused, and then said mysteriously, “I have a show coming up.”

I vaguely thought about how I had no idea if that was true or not. But because Natalie was running her fingers over the hem of her cutoffs, plunging into the downy “v” and back up again, teasing me, the thought quickly disappeared from my head.

I waited, staring at her. Natalie, new Natalie, was so completely in control of the situation. It was an odd feeling but I wasn’t about to interfere

with it. I just looked at her, letting her guide my eyes wherever she wanted them to go. Down the hem of her jeans again, back up. Over her navel, into the dip of her belly-button, over the Lycra-encased swell of her breast, along her collarbone, into the silky waves of her hair, back down her other arm. I couldn't say anything to interrupt her fingers' journey over her own body. I didn't know if it was part of her story or what she was doing, other than driving me wild.

She brought her fingers to her lips, and tapped the pads lightly on her full lower lip. "Do you know Ethan didn't even wait until you pulled out of the garage to tell me he was going to follow me in here?"

I quivered. I don't know if it was from the image her words painted, or from the fact that she delivered them without so much as a blush. My cock was so hard now that it was pulsing with a painful throb.

She pushed her hair behind her shoulder. "So he followed me right in here, and said he was just going to hang out for a while."

My mouth was dry, but I managed to croak: "But that's not what happened."

Natalie had her fingers near her mouth again. Her eyes met mine when she shook her head. She seemed to think it was great fun, the rise she was getting out of me. She had a gleam in her eyes that I had never seen before.

But she turned, so abruptly it felt like she was crushing my chest, and picked up a paintbrush. She dipped it into a plate-shaped container on the table, and started to draw it along a canvas I hadn't noticed until then. But even the way she drew the brush over the canvas was supercharged with a liquid sexuality. The oil smeared onto the canvas, the curve of the brush twisted, Natalie's jeans slid a little further down her hips. I could now see the very top of the indent between her asscheeks, teasing me.

I was dying to know what she had done, get straight to the dirty kernel of her transgressions. Had Ethan fucked her in the ass, filled her up with his cum, and made her scream as his huge cock stretched her out? Had he tasted her sweet cunt as she spread herself open for him on the floor? Maybe he had stuffed her cheating mouth full of his balls, and she had gargled them in her throat like a grade-A porn star.

I was breathing like an animal at this point. Natalie looked back at me, smiled, and continued to draw the brush over the canvas. It was a

strange way to paint, but I only vaguely thought about it. I moved closer to her, unzipping my pants and getting my cock out as I did.

“So,” I prompted her. “Did he watch you paint?”

I slid her jeans down, and rested my nose on her skin, inhaling the scent that radiated from her neck. It mixed with the turpentine, charged with nostalgia, and made me a little high. I worked my right hand into the valley between her cheeks, and found precisely what I was hoping to find: a hot, sticky wetness. I used my left hand to slide her jeans away. I bit into her skin, pretty hard, enough to make her suck in her breath. It was a question more than a bite.

“He watched me for a while,” she said, and I released her pinched skin from between my teeth. “And then he told me to take my clothes off.”

I closed my eyes. I could just *hear* Ethan, his deep Southern voice. *Take your clothes off, darlin.’*

“And you did?” I growled.

Of course she did. That was why we were here, wasn’t it? It’s why I had abandoned my work in the middle of the day and stood on a paint bucket like an idiot. Because I knew that when Ethan told my wife to take her clothes off, she did. I wondered how she had done that, if she had hesitated at all, or blushed, or told him she couldn’t possibly...

Natalie shrugged. She dipped her brush into some paint and made another sexual streak on the canvas. I stared emptily at the colors blending together, orange and a grayish green. “What else could I do?” she said, almost cheerfully.

I shuddered inwardly, but kept my hand still between her legs. I drew my fingers along her sodden slit, and with my pinkie and thumb I pushed on her thighs so that she stepped her legs apart. I made a circle around her anus, trying to feel if it had recently been stretched open, but it was hard to tell if the slight swell of her sphincter was from just me, or from both of us.

“So he watched you. And then what?” I breathed.

“Then,” she said, and I started to reward her by pinching her swollen clit between my fingers. When she paused too long I stopped pleasuring her, and she breathed heavily against my chest. I could feel her disappointment through my shirt, against my body. I had her back under my control, I could feel it by how wet she was.

But *I* was barely in control. If she didn’t start talking soon I would have to cave. I wanted to put my cock inside of her so much it was all I

could do to wait the second it took her to start her story again. “Then he came up behind me,” she said. I started to stroke her clit, a reward for her to keep going. I felt her body tremble against me, as excited as I was. “And he moved his hand up and down my back...” her voice sort of squeaked away as my fingers pushed against her clit and made her shudder. Her cunt was so wet now that my entire hand was getting coated in her juices. I pictured Ethan’s fingers moving up and down Natalie’s spine, caressing the soft dip in her back, lingering as he fingered the skin over her tail bone, dipping further...

Natalie had stopped talking. I stopped the movement of my fingers, and she exhaled sharply. I saw the flutter of her eyelashes as her eyes flew open.

“Then?”

“Then he pushed me onto the table,” she said, and moved her legs so that her hips ground against me.

“Show me,” I said.

She bent over the table, and it was then that I realized what I had seen in the strange canvas laid out on the table: it was dented, it was smeared, it was abstract and like nothing Natalie ever painted. Because it wasn’t a painting. It was just a bunch of paint that had been dragged over the canvas as Ethan pounded his cum into my wife.

I placed my cock at the oozing hole of her cunt, and started to sink into her pussy.

Natalie put a hand on me. “But first he kissed me, from head to toe,” she said.

I paused, let the image of Ethan licking and nibbling at Natalie’s legs and back and ass and shoulders run through my mind, very quickly. But my cock flexed and my balls ached, and I couldn’t wait any longer. I slammed my dick inside of her and pushed hard against her soft ass, grinding my shaft deep into her.

I wanted to know where Ethan had spewed his cum this time – last time he had showered it all over her body – but I had to grit my teeth just to keep from exploding inside of her right then and there. Her body slid around in the still-fresh paint, and she put her hands on either side of her, where I saw the outline of her palm already printed into the canvas. I grasped her hips and slammed into her, overtaken by my lust.

“Such a bad, bad, girl Natalie,” I seethed. “You’re going to have to make it up to me.”

Natalie’s face was on the canvas, turned to the side, I saw her smile. But she didn’t say anything. She just closed her eyes and opened her mouth as her pussy squeezed around mine and she came. I thrust into her harder than I think I have ever fucked her, until the frame of the canvas snapped and the jars on the table overturned. Then I yelled as I fucked Natalie’s cunt full of cum, never having found out if she was already dripping with Ethan’s.

After a stunned few minutes, while both of us just panted, frozen in our respective positions, I stepped backward and let my cock slip out of Natalie’s cunt. I stared at the scene in front of me: wildly vulgar, messy, disturbing and hot as fuck. Even though I had just come, I felt a twinge of awakening in my dick as I thought about how Ethan had probably stared at this same scene only hours before.

Natalie pushed herself up and adjusted her position, walking her legs gingerly back together. I wanted very much to ask her if she was sore, and very much to hear that she was, but I shut down the urge to say something like that. Natalie’s smile as I told her she had been a bad girl came back to me. What had it meant? What kind of smile was it? It had been almost secretive, like she had some private joke in her mind as I said that.

Natalie was surveying her “painting.” She stood back from it and let her head tip to one side.

I encircled her in my arms, stepping closer to her again. I kissed her neck.

“That’s... very artistic.”

She rolled her eyes and giggled. “It’s pretty crappy. It didn’t look too bad after Ethan... but now it’s just... a mess.”

I could feel paint getting on my hands and arms. “Is this oil?” I said.

“No. Thank god. You’d have to bathe in turpentine,” Natalie murmured.

There was something sort of odd in all of this, though I couldn’t put my finger on what it was.

I turned Natalie toward me. She was covered in paint, but she looked oddly pretty. She pushed a sweaty strand of hair back from her face. “I guess we better clean up before Ethan gets back.”

It was tempting to *not* do that, and see what happened. But I remembered that the car was parked all the way by the bike path, and Natalie had concocted her plan, and I was supposed to be home at 6:00... so I didn't make the suggestion. "I'm going to run and move the car."

Natalie's jaw shifted and she smiled, but she didn't ask.

Ethan strolled into the house in a chipper mood at 6:05. He looked me up and down, whistling. "Oh hey, buddy. Been home long?"

I was about to open my mouth to answer that I had just gotten home. But a bad feeling began to surge inside my throat, the kind I got when I started to lie and realized I hadn't covered all my bases. I decided to stop talking before I got myself into trouble.

Luckily Natalie had the bases covered. *Suspiciously* well-covered, I might add. She glanced up and down at me, reminding me of the hole in my lie: I had changed my clothes already. I was wearing a pair of jeans and a white t-shirt.

"Erik came home a little early," she said.

I noticed that she exchanged a look with Ethan at that point. A look that said, "*Aren't we lucky you were out of the house?*" She bit into a chip and turned back to her guacamole.

In spite of everything that had transpired between me and Natalie, I couldn't help that her little look, the complicity that she seemed to be exchanging with Ethan, sent a jolt of fury through me.

Don't get me wrong. Delightful fury. A very enjoyable dose of rage. After all, I knew whose side she was on.

Didn't I?

Ethan let his eyes take a nice sweep over Natalie's ass before he looked back at me and smiled. If he was unnerved that I was looking at him icily, like a man who knows another man is fucking his wife, he didn't show it. Instead, he lifted a white plastic bag with paper inside of it. "I hope you haven't started cookin' yet darlin'." he announced, still looking at me. His expression was a little strange.

God, maybe it wasn't. Maybe I was just imagining things.

"Because I brought us home some Charlie's B-B-Q!"

Natalie turned to him and sucked some guac off her thumb. "Really?" Natalie put an especially delicious squealing act, jiggling in her fresh black swimsuit, which she had washed and exchanged her red suit for. I saw

Ethan's eyes watch her breasts jiggling, and I thought a mild look of confusion went across his face.

I shivered with a perverse pleasure. Ethan, too, was wondering about Natalie. Why she had changed her clothes. What had transpired before he had come back.

Ethan was jealous.

He lifted the bag proudly, levitating it over Natalie's head, to squeeze past her and set it on the counter. He began to dig into the contents, telling us all about what he had purchased.

But my mind was miles away.

Because when he lifted the bag up, I saw that there was a streak of paint on his underarm. The kind that would be missed in a shower, the color of Natalie's terrible slut painting in the shed, sort of gray-orange. The kind of streak you would get if you wrapped your arms around a paint-covered woman.

I looked at the two of them. Ethan's thigh was against Natalie's.

Not in any kind of obvious way. Not in a way that would make a husband notice. It just looked like two people standing together.

I wondered what else Natalie had done in the shed with Ethan.

What else she was going to do.

What it felt like to be Ethan right now, standing next to another man's wife, having inside of him that knowledge: what the inside of her body felt like, how her ass squeezed tight around his fingers when she came; the way she clawed at the sheets. What it would be like to be him, thinking about how he would keep working on her until he sheathed his cock in her hot, soft ass. Thinking, maybe, he would be the first to get there.

But the moment was over quickly, and we got out the food and put it on plastic outdoor plates. We changed our minds when the muggy summer evening hit us, and we sat in the kitchen. Dinner was fun, light-hearted, uneventful.

But all the time, I was staring at Natalie, wondering what I had gotten myself into.

We hung out at the table for a bit, having beers. The atmosphere was actually friendly, almost normal – like nothing was going on – but after about twenty minutes, it turned tense. Not *really* tense, just... odd. Natalie and Ethan began to exchange looks. I had to pretend I didn't see them. The conversation dragged. My heart was racing in a matter of minutes.

“So... playboy. You going out tonight?” Natalie said to Ethan, to break up a weird silence.

Ethan cleared his throat. “I.. uh.. yeah, I’ll probably do that.”

Natalie gave him a smile. “Gotta get back on the horse,” she said, in a terrible faux Southern accent. (To Natalie, anything south of the Mason-Dixon sounded like Foghorn Leghorn.)

There was another strange pause, and then she stood up, unfolding her legs from beneath the table and climbing out from behind the bench seat. She stretched sinuously and her breasts pressed out against the fabric of her suit, promising to break free but stubbornly refusing to do so. She dropped her hands. “I’m beat,” she said. “I gotta go to bed.”

She trotted away.

I could tell it took everything Ethan had not to turn and watch her leave. I enjoyed the view I had, watching her saunter away. She gave me a wink as she rounded the wall dividing the hallway to our bedroom.

“Another beer man?” Ethan said, more to the wall than to me.

I didn’t feel like I could say no. Not if I was still maintaining this “act.”

We had a few more beers. The whole thing was an act, for both of us. Neither one wanted to just get up and leave: it would reveal his hand, or mine. So we chatted about this and that, what we’d been doing since college. I got some idea of what had led Ethan on his path to Chicago and marriage and hedge-fund managing, but he didn’t shed a lot of light on any of it.

I finally felt the need to press a little. “So... you ‘getting back on the horse,’ as Nat would say?”

I watched Ethan’s face carefully. Something stirred inside of him and lit his eyes up. At the same time I saw a flicker of fear – just a flicker – wash over his face. But he composed himself quickly. He was in the middle of a sip of beer, though, and he coughed a little.

He set the beer down. “Uh... yeah, you know. It’s sort of a tough market in Yorkdale.”

“Everyone’s married,” I said. I couldn’t believe I was looking him right in the eye.

There was a little pause, I think maybe while Ethan considered if this was an actual challenge or not. I hoped it made him squirm, just a little.

“Well,” he said, and he gave his dismissive alpha-male laugh. “That ain’t the kind of thing to stop the ladies lovin’ on Cooke.”

No, it wasn’t.

I took a sip of my beer to avoid having to say anything. I sort of wanted to press him a little, but then I remembered Natalie’s plan, and thought better of it. I wouldn’t want to interfere with her idea, which was generally diplomatic for all.

Sort of.

Ethan stood up and stretched. “I think I better head out,” he said. “If I’m gonna.”

I didn’t ask him where he was going, on a weekday, in Yorkdale, partially drunk. The choices were pretty straightforward: one of two strip clubs or Shoppy’s, which was not exactly a magnet for women.

He gave me a weird look.

“Okay, man,” I said. “Good night. I’m going to go see my wife.”

I felt pretty sure that jealousy burned behind his smile, and I felt like a shit but it was gratifying as hell.

Natalie was pretty much asleep – I saw from the clock that Ethan and I had been chatting it up for over an hour. I kissed her neck and pushed her hair from her face. She purred and mumbled something, and I was tempted to wake her up. But I realized that I was also exhausted, so I took a shower, and by the time I got back to bed she was completely out. I was actually a little relieved. The paranoia, excitement, sex, and beers had taken a toll on me.

I dozed without ever fully giving in to real dreams. But I had a hard time drifting off to real, deep sleep.

At least, that’s what I thought.

I was unsure of the moment when Natalie left. I’m still not sure if I dreamed it, or really felt her weight disappear from beside me. She leaned over me and said: “wait a few minutes.”

If it was a dream, I was paralyzed by sleep. If it was reality, I assumed she’d come back within moments. I wasn’t entirely sure what I had heard.

But time went on, and soon I *was* awake, and Natalie was really gone. I sat up and felt the side of the bed next to me, as if I couldn’t see with my own two eyes that she was gone. I strained into the gray darkness. She was not in the bathroom.

She was not in the room.

"Wait a few minutes."

A cold fear gripped me. Then excitement. Had she really said that?

Wait a few minutes for what?

And then it dawned on me: she was enacting the fantasy I'd confided to her this morning. Wait a few minutes for her to get to Ethan's room, tiptoe across the floor with her fingers pressed to her lips. She had to make it believable for him. Make him think she was coming to him illicitly, a very bad girl who had crept out of her husband's bed in the middle of the night to let him fill her full of his cum.

My cock was hard within seconds. My heart was beating rapidly and hard against the walls of my chest. I could hear it my ears; I could almost see my pulse throbbing in the darkness, turning the blackness green as my blood pressure squeezed on my optic nerve.

I waited. Minutes ticked by until I was no longer sure if I had been there a few minutes or a few hours. A quick look at the clock told me that the eternity I had lived lying paralyzed on my side was all of three minutes.

But I didn't know how long Natalie had been gone before I really woke up.

I sat up and threw the covers off. My ears were ringing. I took a deep breath, trying to steady myself. It was useless. I stood up, and tried to move quietly across the room to the door. Natalie had shut it behind her. I had to stand there unsteadily, turning the doorknob slowly, cursing at myself for never oiling the squeak.

Silver light filled the rest of the house: it was a full moon and we left the curtains open except in the bedrooms. I stepped carefully into the hallway toward the guest bedroom, feeling as though the sound of my feet on the carpet was making a racket. *Scrape, scrape, scrape.*

The hallway turned and led to Ethan's room. I was almost shaking when I reached the turn. I steadied my breath again; I felt like I sounded like a wild boar.

This was a tricky place in the house. If you wanted to listen to your wife fucking another man behind the door, that is. There was absolutely nothing at the end of the short hallway but Ethan's room. Not even a linen closet. No excuse for being there except for the real reason: to creep up to the door and stand by it, ear to the wood. Listening.

I poked my head around the corner. I was hopeful that Natalie had left the door open a crack, but I saw that she had not.

I leaned against the hall wall.

Why hadn't she done that? Was she trying to drive me crazy? Or because she actually didn't want to me watch her with Ethan? Had she even woken me, or was that all a dream, too?

I closed my eyes and took a deep breath.

Maybe she had done it because it would be utterly unbelievable to Ethan if she didn't.

I turned the corner sharply, bravely, and strode toward the door.

I had replaced the ordinary cheap suburban doors, hollow on the inside and a much better option for situations like the one I found myself in at that moment, by heavy, thick wood. For all the bedrooms... except this one. The heavy door was in the basement, half-stained, a project I had been putting off for an eternity.

And now, my laziness was paying off.

I leaned toward the door and pressed my ear against it.

My heart was racing so quickly now that I was practically vibrating from head to toe. If Ethan or Natalie came to the door now, they would open it and find me standing right there. Looking like an idiot, ear cocked to the door, listening for the sounds of them fucking. The humiliation would have no remedy: there was no excuse for being there except this very one. I wanted to hear them fucking.

The hollow door was marvelously thin. With my ear to it, I could make out their voices (though not what they were saying,) and the movements in the room.

As I listened to the sounds, which were mostly shuffles and indistinct voices at first, I imagined what was happening behind that closed door. I wondered what Natalie had worn to walk down the hallway. Had she slipped on a nightie, or a pair of her pajamas? Or had she boldly crept down the hall completely naked?

Had Ethan known she was coming? Had he hoped for it, or had it been such a surprise that he was asleep when she closed the door behind her?

Had they somehow planned this together? Maybe Ethan had told her to do this, and she had concocted a way to plant the idea in my mind, to let

me think that I had suggested it to her, when in fact it was Ethan's fantasy and not my own?

The sounds from behind the door, at first disjointed shuffles, settled into a quiet rhythm.

I pictured them in there. Had she climbed on top of him and started to ride him? Was she atop him like a goddess, bouncing up and down on his dick while he enjoyed fondling her breasts and watching her eyes turn glassy as she neared her orgasm?

I found myself placing my hand on the doorknob. It was a cheap round knob, the kind that promised to squeak with every rotation. I turned it slowly. Behind the door the sounds in the room grew quieter, but the rhythmic throb of whatever they were doing was still under the sounds.

The knob stopped in my hand. Completely turned.

I heard a low sound, maybe Ethan's voice. I held my breath, and pushed on the door.

I was surprised at how delicately I pushed on the door in spite of my excitement. It opened only a millimeter, but the presence of the crack sent my blood pressure soaring. Would they see it? Would I fuck up and throw my weight against the door in a jerky motion and reveal myself? Did I care if either of those things happened?

I felt like my rapid breathing would blow the door in. I held on to the doorknob, and I was glad I had done so for the completely wrong reason. If I let go of the knob, the sound would have alerted them to the fact that I was there. I pushed it open a little more.

Now I could hear them distinctly. The ragged breath, the grunting, the slapping of their skin against each other. That was the sound, in fact, that reached me first: the light slap of sticky flesh against sticky flesh.

It emboldened me. I pushed the door open a couple of inches, not especially caring if they saw me or not. I was too hungry to see what was happening in there, to get a glimpse of what naughty things my wife was up to.

With the door open only a few inches, I got the full scene like a smack in the face. I exhaled: there was no way that Ethan would see the open door. Natalie's body blocked his view of it.

She was sitting on top of him, her torso bare and pale in the moonlight. Her arms were stretched up to her hair, which she had piled up in her hands and held to her head as she bobbed up and down over Ethan's

body. When she rose, the length of Ethan's shaft was exposed between her legs. I stared at his fat cock as she rose up and then sank down, over and over, riding him as he held her hips and stared at her breasts.

It seemed to go on forever. Natalie bouncing and bouncing with another man's cock sliding in and out of her body. Maybe it didn't last forever, maybe that was only my imagination. The feminine panting that I knew came from Natalie grew constricted, turned into a squeal, and she began to fuck him more furiously.

Ethan lifted an arm, and placed it around her neck. The sounds that Natalie was making closed up, turned to choked gurgle. Her breath disappeared, and a very cold, very erotic splinter of pain pierced my heart and my stomach at the same time. She made a noise that was unlike anything I had ever heard before, and her body went rigid for a moment. I could feel the urge to burst into the room uncoiling inside of me, when a sharp yell escaped her body. Ethan dropped his hand to her hips, and dug his fingers into his flesh, pulling her tight against him as he crunched upward and slammed his cock into her. Natalie seemed to be squirming to try and climb off of him, but he gripped her fiercely and pounded his cum into her deep with a groan.

Natalie's breath escaped her mouth with a pop! They were still twitching, the two of them. Natalie was writhing on top of Ethan, and they rocked slightly, panting away the remains of their climaxes. Natalie released her hair, and it fell forward in a curtain of oak that shone with the light from the window.

I knew I needed to close the door. I knew that I needed to creep back to my room and wait for Natalie to come back, Ethan's cum sliding down her thighs as she crept down the hallway. I could extract whatever details I wanted from her there. But I couldn't tear myself away from the image – the real, visual manifestation of my wife's slutdom.

Ethan's body moved again, and Natalie let out a sexy little moan. He was straining upward to get at her mouth. His hand went into her hair as he began to pull her toward him...

I had to close the door.

I slowly pulled it toward me, wishing I could see the end of the scene. What did they say to each other, after they fucked?

I backed away from the door. As I turned the corner I had an awful thought: what if Ethan kissed her, and her mouth was so sweet and

delightful, and the thought of her being such a bad, naughty wife and riding his cock like a whore was so appealing to him that his cock got hard inside of her again, and he fucked another load of cum into her while I sat in my room like a fucking fool?

I stopped. I was facing the side of the hallway that led to the Master Bedroom. My heart kicked at the inside of my chest. My cock was throbbing.

Did I dare go back?

I stood there for another slow eternity, before I heard a slight bump against the door. The rattle of the doorknob. A giggle.

I strode down the hall on tiptoe, darting away from the sound, my heart pounding and adrenaline seizing my chest in a tight grip. I popped into the room (I had left the door open) and swung the door behind me. I still had my own hand on the handle, and I panted with the thrill and fear before it dawned on me that it was only Natalie coming down the hall, after all. And she would have expected me to be there. She knew I had come to listen to her.

An errant thought burned through my mind. Why hadn't she woken me up?

But there was no time to think about that, because I felt the door push against my back. I moved so that Natalie, smiling her new, wicked smile, could slip into the room. I closed the door and slowly released the handle.

Natalie trounced over to the bed and sat down on it, crossing her legs. She was wearing a white silk nightie I had never seen before and, I noticed when she crossed her legs, no underwear. She grabbed the bottom of it, which barely covered her bottom when she was standing, and pulled it over her head.

I was still standing by the door, transfixed. Natalie had such a strange little smile on her face. It wasn't the kind of smile I had ever seen on her. It was more... self-possessed than anything. So foreign on her face. It sent a chill through me, and under any other circumstances I would have wanted to think about it more, trouble myself with it more.

But later.

I crossed the room from the door to the bed. As I did, Natalie stretched out on the bed, kicking herself up so that she lay completely on the width of it. She tipped her head to the side invitingly.

I shimmied out of my boxers, the only thing I'd had on out there.

I started at her feet, and moved my hand over her ankle and up to her knee. About midway up the calf of her left leg, my palm stuck to her skin. A rivulet of cum had traveled all the way down her thighs, past her knee, to her calf, as she had walked back to our room full of her lover's seed.

I put my finger on the slightly-dried spot, and followed it with the end of my finger, up along her inner thigh, where it was still wet and warm. Her eyes were lit up with the same elements as her smile: secrecy? Lust? Enjoyment of my pain? Or enjoyment of my pleasure?

I kept going, all the way to her gash, where Ethan's cum overflowed. I crawled on top of her and took her hands in mine. Then I pushed them into her pussy, and used her fingers to massage her swollen and sensitive clit. I wanted her fingers coated in the dirty juices of her pussy when she put them in her mouth, which was the next thing I was going to get her to do. Right after I made her tell me all the very bad things she had done.

"Did you see?" she said, her eyes locked on mine. Her lids closed partially as I used her pointer finger to rub horizontally on the darting hard knob of her clit. I pushed the fingers of her other hand (she helped me, willingly) into her slit.

I didn't answer. Who even knows what I did? Probably I just sat there with my mouth hanging open like a slob. I must have nodded, because she smiled and her eyes lit up even more, as though she had seen something.

"Ethan thought I was a very, *very* bad wife. Sneaking away in the middle of the night to fuck him? His cock got hard in just a second in my mouth."

I couldn't say anything, even if I had known what to say. She was holding me hypnotized, leaving no lull in the conversation, giving me no way to take control of what she would do, even if I was lying on top of her and holding her hands.

"He was so surprised to see me that for a moment his whole cock fit inside my mouth," she said, and she opened her mouth as if to show me the exact dimensions of Ethan's soft cock, curled up in there.

"But then it just grew and grew, and pretty soon it popped out of my mouth. I was just going there to suck his cock... I like the way it feels in my mouth. Oh!"

She squirmed as I started to rub her clit with the tip of my cock. Her hands were freed, and she brought her fingers to her mouth. She licked her pointer finger from the web to the tip, looking at me the whole time. Then

she sucked the sticky juice – Ethan’s cum and her own – from it with a wet pop. She trailed her tongue down to the base of her middle finger and repeated the action.

“But Ethan told me to get on his cock and ride him like a little slut,” she said, and then licked the length of her ring finger. “So I did.”

She sucked her ring finger all the way to our gold wedding band. The diamond of her engagement ring clicked on her teeth, and then she sucked off the cum-juice from that finger as well. She bit the tips of her fingers and rested her palm against her chin. Her eyes dropped... she was getting close to coming again. Her cunt was so wet that every movement of my dick was making a sucking sound.

“It was good,” she purred. “But I was sort of disappointed... after all this practice... that he didn’t... he didn’t want to fill my ass up with his cock...”

I moved like lightning. My own cock was about to burst. I pushed her legs up beside her face, and I slid my hand from her pussy to her ass as I did so. She had oozed so much of Ethan’s cum and her own excitement and cum down between her legs that my fingers slipped right into her hole. I had to push hard against her for only a moment, then she opened up.

Practice makes perfect.

I finger-fucked her quickly; first one finger, then a second, then a third.

Then I guided my cock to her ass, and pushed her legs down to the bed to sink my cock into her.

She pushed up against me to grind herself to her own orgasm. She was there in a matter of seconds. When she came her legs pushed up against my grip and her ass clamped around my cock, squeezing my boiling cum from my shaft and enclosing me in her hot flesh as I pounded my seed into her.

It felt like I was climaxing forever. I didn’t even yell, the force of my orgasm was so strong it just gripped me like an iron fist.

I let go of her legs, and they flopped down, resting on either side of me, then closing around my back. For a while, I was inside of her as she shifted around me, but finally my cock slipped out. The sheets were soaked beneath her ass, I could feel it on my thigh.

I kissed her, and she moved her mouth beneath mine, purring a little. When I finally lifted my head, I saw that her eyes were heavy with sleep. I

rolled off of her and scooted us to a diagonal so that my legs were on the bed. I pulled her to me and rolled her up in my right arm, her head on my shoulder.

By the time I found words, she was asleep. “Natalie,” I said, and I looked down at her. I could see from her slightly parted lips and her peacefully closed eyes, twitching lightly with the first stages of REM sleep, that she was out cold.

CHAPTER 3: ETHAN'S PLANS

I went out to the kitchen first the next morning. Natalie was sleepy. She yawned and stretched before turning on her side and pulling the covers over her head. "I think I'll sleep in this morning," she said.

I was actually looking forward to being out there when Ethan got up. I was curious about what he would say and do. How he would react to the husband of the woman he fucked when I made him coffee. Would he be smug? Would he feel some sense of remorse?

Natalie had gone to sleep and slept like a log, but I had not slept well at all. At some point in the early morning I had dozed off, but even that small sleep was fitful and dogged by all of the disturbing thoughts I had set aside to have sex with Natalie. They welled back up as soon as my heartbeat returned to normal.

There was her smile, and all of the unknown secrets beneath it. What had Natalie become? She had changed (and scarily, in such a short time) from a woman who was essentially submissive – though our sex life had in recent ears become so dull I doubted the term "submissive" really described it – to a woman who seemed to relish having this particular kind of control over me. Even if I held her hands captive and forced her to dip them into her own cheating cunt, Natalie's face revealed that I was doing exactly what she wanted. Her expression said that she was in control. It was like she was watching a carefully laid plan fall into place, piece by piece by piece, all according to her own design.

I took a sip of coffee and shivered.

That was hot as hell (Natalie, not the coffee), but it was also disturbing. Where was this coming from?

A coldness crept into my abdomen.

And where would it stop?

If Natalie could turn this quickly from a suburban soccer-mom to the woman who last night had sucked on her cum-stained fingers and let my friend Ethan asphyxiate her while she came after riding his cock down the hall from her husband's bed – what would she be in a month? What was she capable of?

And then there was the ever-present unsettling idea: maybe things were not playing out the way I thought they were. Maybe Ethan was the manipulator of Natalie and not the other way around. Maybe all of this hotwifing was just a lie for me, to make me believe that her infidelity was under my control.

And then the strange things. Like why hadn't Natalie made sure she had woken me up?

I supposed I could just ask her. I knew I would get a vague answer, though.. and it would lead me right back to the same unforgiving circle I had just been through: who was seducing who... was seducing who?

I sipped my coffee again and looked to the side to see if there was any movement from the t-shape where the hallways joined: Ethan's to the right and ours to the left.

I looked at the clock. I had to get to work. I had to get to work and actually do work. I had meetings with clients that day.

Not sure what I was feeling that Ethan never came out to the kitchen, I started back to the master bedroom. I was having a pleasant daydream as I went, that I would leave Natalie all snuggled up in our bed, and no sooner than I had backed out of the garage, Ethan would rise from his own bed and walk down the hallway to climb on top of my wife.

So I almost jumped when Ethan was to my right as I walked around the wall of the hallway. "Jesus!" I said, involuntarily.

Ethan was tightening a tie around his collar. He shifted his scruffy jaw from side to side and looked at me without saying anything.

It was typical Ethan: his expression conveyed nothing and was dominating in that way. I looked at him as he adjusted his tie.

"Going somewhere?" I said, finally.

He smoothed the tie. "Do you think I need to shave?" he said, bringing his hand to the significant scruff on his jaw.

I stared some more. This guy's cock was probably crusted over with my wife's pussy juices, and he was asking me if he needed to shave?

"I have to conference in with Moira," he said. "From my lawyer's office. You know Jake Merion is my lawyer? I don't want to look desperate. Like my life is falling apart? But I also don't want to look like I give a fuck." He rubbed under his chin. "What do you think?"

His voice indicated that he *didn't* give a fuck. Not about fucking my wife, and not about Moira, and not about whether or not Moira thought he

gave a fuck or not.

I stared at him for a moment or two.

“Do you?” I found myself saying, and the words surprised even me when they came out of my mouth. I meant, *so you give a fuck*, and I meant it as a question about all of those things.

Ethan paused with his tie between his fingers and leveled his head to look me straight in the eye.

It seemed at that moment – and this made me feel like someone had tossed me out of an airplane in a sack – that we both knew exactly what I was referring to. Like we were having one of those friendly enemy moments, where everyone nods sagely at each other, because they all know what’s really going on.

It was a short moment, though. Ethan’s face changed suddenly, and he looked genuinely confused.

“Do I what?”

“Give a fuck,” I said slowly. *Give a fuck about your marriage, your divorce, fucking my wife.*

Ethan looked down. It sent a wave of feelings through me that I didn’t understand at the time. Only later when I thought about it would I realize that I had never seen Ethan look away from any kind of confrontation, or really anything at all. That wasn’t Ethan. He was the kind of guy to always look everyone and everything right in the eye.

He shrugged, and then his eyes were back on mine, locked, same old Ethan. “It’s not important. How do I *look*?”

He was smiling now. Back on his game.

“Leave the stubble,” Natalie’s voice came from behind me. Her voice was slightly froggy, very sleepy. I turned to watch her as she slipped past me and headed to the kitchen. Her hair was a beautiful mess, a visual representation of how naughty she’d been. The back of her normally silky-smooth hair was knotted a little.

I felt a little rush of pleasure, because it was the sort of knotted mess that women only got from sliding back and forth on a bed or another surface, on their backs, and I knew that Ethan would see it and know immediately that he was not the only one who’d enjoyed Natalie’s delights last night.

I looked back at him. The sight of Natalie was doing something to his expression. It might have been undetectable to the average person, but I

could see that he had clenched his jaw. It pulsed slightly under his skin.

Natalie was taking a sip of water from a teacup she had put under the tap. “If you want to look like you don’t give a fuck, I mean. Women love stubble, deep down inside. Don’t get a beard going, just... you know. A sexy shadow, like the one you have... it says...” she lifted her eyes to the ceiling, as though she really wanted to come up with a good slogan for Ethan’s “sexy stubble.” “It says, ‘I’ve moved on, and now I’m like the Marlboro man.’” Natalie lifted the glass to her lips. “Mmm,” she said. “It also kind of says you haven’t started dating or anything. That way you kind of have your feet in both worlds.”

She looked down at the plate where I had left the crust of my toast, picked it up, and crunched into it. “God,” she said. “I’m so hungry. But I’m so tired. I’m going back to bed.” She trotted past us again.

Both Ethan and I were staring at her, though I imagine our reasons for doing so were very unlike.

“Good luck,” she said to Ethan, with a smile, and then she kissed me on the cheek as she passed. “Want to go out to dinner or something tonight?”

She didn’t wait for the answer, she just disappeared into the bedroom.

Ethan was walking into the bathroom when I turned back to him.

“Bye,” I said.

“Yeah. See you. Hey I’ll be in Columbia tonight, got a few other things to do.”

“Oh. Yeah. Okay. Well, good luck.” And then louder: “Bye, honey!”

I was in the car before I realized what had transpired. Natalie had already known that Ethan was going to stay in Columbia that evening. That’s why she had asked if I wanted to go to dinner.

But that was neither here nor there, I told myself. Who cared if Natalie had known that? It was absurd to think that she’d spend the whole day with Ethan around and never get to talking about what was going in either of their lives.

This argument was logical and convincing.

But I still had a bad feeling as I backed out of the garage and drove to work.

There was no time for daydreaming about Ethan and Natalie that day. I had a few clients coming in, and for once I was thankful for the meetings.

(Ordinarily I dreaded speaking to clients. Something I'd learned about people in general is that no matter what your profession, they seemed to want you to be a therapist. People loved to go on and on. Sure, I was billing them for the hours, but that kind of inefficiency drove me nuts.)

With Sandy gone for one more day, it was pretty hectic handling everything. But it was good. It kept my mind off Natalie and Ethan. I realized halfway through the day that I had never turned off the automatic voicemail to the office. It had peeved a few clients, but on the bright side it caused just the right amount of chaos for me, personally. To take my mind off them.

Natalie and Ethan. Ethan and Natalie.

I had no right to feel as... upset, I guess would be the right word, as I did. My wife was doing this all for me, and she had said so, and she was doing a marvelous job. It was exciting, hot, incredible.

Why couldn't I just enjoy it?

But every time there was a lull in the day, even for a few seconds, I found the bad feeling creeping in on me. The feeling that there was something bad in all of this, something off, some element I didn't quite get.

I started packing up at five, relieved to be going home. I was a little bit relieved that Ethan wasn't at my house that evening. I could just get back to having an ordinary relationship with my wife. It seemed sort of contradictory, but I could use a vacation from my fantasy for one night.

The phone rang.

A client needed to drop something off. I cringed inwardly, because I geared up to tell her she would just have to do it tomorrow, I realized that her file was one of those I'd dropped the ball on in the past week and that I was actually really lucky she had called and wanted to drop her papers off.

I sat down in the office chair in a huff. There were a lot of things I could have done to keep myself occupied while I waited, but I had already switched to off-work mode.

I absentmindedly took out my private phone.

There were several text messages and a voicemail. My heart skipped a beat. How had I missed this all day?

I opened the text messages first.

[Natalie 10:01 AM]: *u wnt believe who jst clld me and told me to come see him in Columbia*

[Natalie 10:10 AM]: *hey. hello? should I go*

[Natalie 10:12 AM]: *im cllng u*

[Natalie 10:13 AM]: *turn phone on at office*

I almost dropped the phone as I fumbled to get to my voicemail. I pressed the phone to my ear with such excitement that I craned my own head. The monotone voice of the answering service advised me the message was left at 10:18. Natalie's voice, still a little froggy, low and sultry from the mid-summer allergies, purred in my ear.

Hey. I don't know... I'm not sure if you got my messages, I tried your office but just kept going to voicemail. I, uh... Ethan's asked me to spend the day with him in Columbia. I wanted to check it out with you. So... I guess I'm just going to go, you know, if I don't hear back from you. I can't really think of any reason not to. He, like, left some papers here so there's an excuse for me to go and everything in case... okay. Just call me back please.

My blood throbbed in my ears. I was sure I was about to have a heart attack.

I stared at the phone. Then I moved around, knocking papers off my desk, picking up the landline phone, swiping at the screen, doing about ten things at once. I had no idea what I was trying to do. I was adrift. Finally I settled on calling Natalie back from my cell phone.

As the phone rang in my ear, I realized that I had a crucial problem: What was I going to say?

Her voicemail answered.

At that moment there was a knock on the door and a click in the outer room of the small office. I stood up, a look of horror on my face.

Mrs. Norwood, my client. I ended the call and staggered into the outer office. The only thing I could think about to completion was Natalie's message: *I guess I'm just going to go, you know, if I don't hear back from you.*

Mrs. Norwood, a cut-and-dry divorce case, stared at me. I probably looked like a madman. I barely even recognized her, or understood what she was doing there. Maybe somewhere in the back of my mind I did, because I

heard myself saying “Kelly, come in,” and I felt my body moving around the desk, shaking her hand, holding a file folder, smiling.

My mind, though, was miles away. Miles away, where Natalie had gone to “see” Ethan for the day. We exchanged pleasantries. I’m sure I told her everything was moving smoothly. Inside, I was willing her to wrap it up and leave, but like all clients she had a desire to say more than she needed to, tell me the narrative she’d been rehearsing to make herself feel better.

Finally she left, and I jumped behind my desk and grabbed the phone to call Natalie again.

I paused with my finger over the call button.

Natalie was with Ethan already.

Natalie had gone to see Ethan in Columbia. They were spending the day together, holed up in some hotel surely.

Or worse.

What if it was worse? What if they were going to lunch and talking? What if Ethan was confiding all of his feelings about his divorce to her? What if they were...

I had a vision in my head of Natalie and Ethan, naked and pressed against each other, not *fucking*, but doing something far worse. *Making love*.

My thumb was still hovering over the receiver-shaped icon to make the call.

I collapsed into the chair.

What was I going to say? It was probably too late. Far too late.

There was also a terrible question, one that I knew the answer to but didn’t really want to face:

Would I have stopped her from going, even if I had gotten her messages in time?

I pressed my fingertips to my eyelids.

Think, Erik. Would you? Would you have stopped her?

The truth, if I had the courage to face it, was: Probably not.

But *why* not? What was it inside of me that wanted to gamble everything in our marriage for this particular, painful thrill?

And this led me to another question: if I wouldn’t have told her not to go, why did I feel... *this way*... just because she *had* gone?

This way. I knew what the feeling was. It was the cold, dark slime of betrayal.

I had no right to feel betrayed. Especially not if Natalie had only done what I had encouraged her to do. I couldn't be angry that she had gone a little further now, and done something I knew – I *knew* – I would have told her to go ahead and do anyway.

My thoughts shifted to Ethan. That guy. Such a fucking slimeball. “Left some papers behind.”

But I was back on Natalie within seconds.

She did call you. She did try to tell you before she went.

I swiped the message app open on my phone again and stared at the time stamps on the messages.

Why the rush, Natalie?

And the other thing that bothered me: there was nothing after that. No more messages or attempts to call me.

I set the phone face down on my desk. I tapped Mrs. Norwood's file until the papers were even more inordinately organized than before. I set the folder down.

Did my wife have implied permission from me to go meet Ethan and have sex with him all day?

The question filled the room. I looked out the windows. The sky was blue, the early evening looked pleasant. I felt my heart drop a little: I had been looking forward to having dinner with Natalie, maybe on the open porch at *The Bayou*.

I don't know how long I sat there, feeling bad for myself. It must have been a while, because when my cell rang it was 6:24.

Natalie.

I stared at the phone, considering not answering it. I had no idea what I would say to her.

But a flicker of excitement prompted me to move my arm. After all, there *was* the other part of me, the part of me that wanted to hear all about how she had spent the day rolling around in bed with Ethan at some hotel in Columbia.

I held the phone to my ear.

“Erik?” Natalie said, after a pause. “Are you there?”

“Hey,” I said.

“Hey yourself. Are you ever coming home?”

Her question lingered in the air while I did quick math. Columbia was only about an hour away. I suppose it could have all happened by now, and

she could be back.

“I...”

“I thought we were going out to dinner?”

My heart was beating faster again. “I thought you...”

A silence again.

“Where have you *been* all day? Did you get my messages?”

Natalie didn’t sound especially annoyed. Or repentant. Or unsure of herself. Or especially like a woman who had spent the whole day fucking her husband’s houseguest.

“I just got them,” I said evenly.

“O... kay. Well... are you coming home soon? I thought we could go to *The Bayou*. ”

Was she serious? Was she actually going to be this casual about having run off to spend the day with Ethan?

“Erik! Are you there?”

I mumbled a sound into the phone.

“Uh... do you want me to meet you there?”

I lifted Mrs. Norwood’s folder. “I just had to get a file,” I said lamely.

“So... when will you be home? I’m starving, is why I ask.”

Was she starving because she had burnt off so much energy with Ethan? Hadn’t had time to take a break and order room service?

“I’m... leaving right now,” I said.

“Okay,” Natalie said, and her voice was sultry. “I can’t wait.”

I fumbled around in my office, gathering up things that I wasn’t even sure I needed and probably leaving things that I did. I had a vague sense that I was going to run my practice into the ground at this rate. Thank God Sandy would be back tomorrow.

I was in the car, my mind swirling, when I realized I might have forgotten to lock the door to my office.

I actually sat there in my car, contemplating not checking on that.

I ran back to double-check, found it locked, and cursed myself. I was slightly relieved that I hadn’t completely lost my grip on reality because of my wife’s sexcapades with Ethan Cooke. I ran back down the stairs two at a time to my still-running car, and I drove home like a bit of a zombie. My mind, as always, completely on Natalie.

Natalie was dressed in a new dress, and this wasn't the kind of thing I'd ordinarily notice, but this dress *was*... insane. It was not the kind of dress that if your wife had worn it before, you would have overlooked. She was leaning over the kitchen island, fanning through the pages of an advertising flier.

She stood up when I came through the door.

The dress was white, with a tiny red pattern of flowers, and cut so deeply between her breasts that it looked more like two independent slices of fabric than one halter. The strips parted at her waist, stretched wide to show the swell of her plump curves, and then came together around her neck. It was a "casual" dress, long and flowy from the waist down, and it shouldn't have been quite so sexy as it was, because it covered her legs. But it was. Incredibly sexy.

She tucked a strand of hair behind her ear. Her hair was piled up in some kind of loose and sexy up-do with lots of it falling out and kissing her shoulders in the most tantalizing way.

I realized, looking at her, that she probably didn't even intend to be particularly sexy with the dress. But she was.

And then the cold feeling started falling over me, a curtain of doubts and disturbing thoughts:

Where did she get that dress? Had she gone shopping with Ethan? Had the dress been Ethan's suggestion? Was Ethan dressing my wife up like a doll?

Had she fucked Ethan while wearing that dress?

"New dress," I said. I sounded like a maniac.

She looked confused for a moment. She looked down. "Oh. Yeah. You like?"

She gave me a little twirl. At the back of the dress, the long skirt flared out at the hips, making a delightful round bulb of material where her ass was, before narrowing where her slender legs stretched down to the floor. I was dying to know what kind of shoes she had on, because she seemed taller than usual and I could only guess that some kind of strappy delight awaited me.

For what seemed like the hundredth time in recent history, I was wired.

"Bayou's?" she said. She lowered her chin to look at me, indicating that I was being weird.

I don't know if this has ever happened to you – it had never happened to me until then – but my thoughts seemed to be like three heavy columns that were crashing around in my head. Every time one of those sets of thoughts – lust, jealousy, or just plain old me – took the forefront of my mind, it felt like the whole room shifted. I felt body-slammed.

I, Erik Ossington, was coming the fuck apart like a Rolex knock-off. “What did you do with Ethan?” I said. My own abruptness startled me.

It made Natalie smile, and fold up her hands, leaning on the counter. What sort of smile was it? Again, I had the hot-cold feeling twist inside of me: I didn't really know my wife.

“Ethan...” she said, as though she couldn't place the name.

I felt myself burning up.

Natalie looked up at me quickly and smiled a new and different smile. “Oh come on,” she said. “You never got back to me.” She flipped a page of the flier with a little crinkling sound.

She straightened up when I didn't answer. “What did you think?” she said coyly. “I just popped over there anyway?”

She put her hand on her hip.

If it hadn't been clear to me up until then that I was losing control, this was the moment. The illuminating moment. I stared at Natalie.

Who was this woman I had created?

“But you... your message...”

She furrowed her brow a little, and seemed to really be searching her mind. Then her eyes lit up. “Oh yeah. That. I think I just wanted to get your attention. Sorry. It was only a little later I realized you were probably slammed, with Sandy being out and all.”

I stared at her as she drummed her fingers on the counter. She didn't *seem* like she was lying. But then, she was also a beautiful woman, and men had a tendency to believe the stupidest shit that pretty women told them. I'd seen it with my own two eyes more than once.

Was she lying to me now?

“I am *starving* Erik,” she said, suddenly cross. “Can we go, or what?” So we went.

Natalie's dress, as an added benefit, had surprise slits in it. When she sat down in the car they opened up, and her legs were exposed, tan and long

and beautiful.

It was hard to keep my eyes on the road. Luckily for me, The Bayou was the next town over and a straight shot down a little-used highway.

Her phone buzzed as we drove. We hadn't said anything in the car, but there was an undeniable, luridly sexual excitement between us. I wanted to pull the car over and fuck her right here on the side of the road. But she did seem genuinely hungry, and when Natalie goes sour from lack of food there's no coming back from it, at least not that same day.

She held the phone up after fishing it out of her matching purse, also new-looking. I had a vaguely disturbing thought again about Natalie's shopping – when she did it, and with whom, and why I didn't know about it. But the thought was pushed out of my head immediately by Natalie's next words: "Oh," she said. She was touching her mouth. "Speak of the devil."

The devil could only be Ethan, but I played dumb anyway. "Who?"

She looked at me, said nothing, and dropped the phone in her purse. "I have to eat before we do *anything*," she said, stretching in the seat and scooting her butt to the side in a gesture that said less: "I'm hungry," than "I want to get fucked until I can't walk."

But I wasn't about to take a chance.

I kept driving.

We ended up in a little corner of the inside the restaurant instead of the porch. I don't remember why. I think it was Natalie's suggestion. The porch seemed pleasant, but because of that, there were a lot of people out there. I liked that we were tucked away. I would end up grateful for the choice.

She ordered fried pickles and devoured two strawberry daiquiris while she waited for them. Most of what I remember about that time was staring at her tits in that fantastic dress. She ate the pickle spears by nibbling on them with her teeth, and if you think there's no way for someone to eat fried pickle spears in dirtily seductive manner, then you are all wrong. At one point, a dribble of ranch dressing fell into the bare valley between her breasts and she swept it up with her finger and sucked it off.

Then she pushed the plate away and rested her arms on the table.

At that moment I felt that I was sitting next to someone I had never met before in my life. She was holding her phone, and she swept her fingers

across it quickly. "Ethan was *so* disappointed that I didn't come to see him," she said.

My cock was already hard, but I felt like it inflated to twice its size at that moment.

"I've been telling him I think you're suspecting us," she said. "And that you wanted to go out to dinner, and that I got all dressed up for it."

I stared. She looked at me and smiled, running her hand into her hair. She knew this was driving me wild.

"What did he text you just now?" I stuttered. "In the car?"

She turned the phone around to me.

[Steve]: *I miss u I need more pictures*

"Steve," I said.

She shrugged. "He put his number in that way. You know. So it would be a secret."

I plowed ahead. "More pictures?"

She shrugged again. "Oh, I don't know." As in, *I don't know anything about the pictures*. But she sounded not entirely truthful.

The back of my neck burned. "He doesn't have any pictures of you, does he?" I spat.

Natalie leaned back. "He's on Facebook, maybe that's what he has." She was amused.

I looked at her. I was completely unsure of what I was feeling.

"I could send him some," she said, leaning back toward me. She leaned forward and brought her face close to mine. She smelled like strawberry daiquiri, and I could make out the scent of her soap. And maybe, I thought, the scent of her excitement. Her lips were painted a cherry-pink color that matched the red of her dress. "I could take them right here at the table."

My mind was addled, and it's almost embarrassing to narrate where I went with this. Was she going to take a selfie of us together and send it to Ethan? How was that sexy? Unless Ethan, like me, got a special kind of thrill from seeing her douse another man with affection. Maybe she wanted to get her great breasts into the picture -

But she interrupted my thoughts to whisper, very close to my mouth: "I'm not wearing any underwear."

Her words turned into a serum, and it made its way through my body slowly, paralyzing me. I sat there transfixed, amazed at everything – how much control I’d lost, my wild wife, the sea change in our marriage – as she leaned back in the booth and smiled.

Her hand spun the phone around on the table, and her fingers played with the screen. Then she dragged the phone across the table, past her empty plate, and under the booth.

She squirmed a little in her seat. I watched her, hoping her rocking back and forth would jostle the material of her dress from its precarious perch on her breasts and give me a quick peek at her pink nipple. I was trying to sort out what she might be doing, but I admit I was utterly clueless. I knew it was sexual, I knew it involved Ethan, but even when the bright white of the flash lit up the edges of her body from below the table, I still didn’t get it. She wiggled and brought the phone up to look at the screen.

I was itching, as I have never itched before, to see what was on that screen.

She crinkled up her nose. “It’s not very good,” she said.

I held out my hand, my mouth watering and the blood pounding in my ears.

She placed the phone in my hand and I drew it up toward my face.

It wasn’t very good, if you were looking for professional quality photos of your... your...

Completely shaved pussy?

My eyes went wide. I looked over the top edge of the phone at Natalie.

One side of her mouth turned up in a wry little grin. “What?” she said, pressing her straw between her lips and sucking some sweet strawberry daiquiri into her mouth. She drew her teeth along the plastic as she released the straw, sending a shudder through me. “I had nothing else to do today,” she said.

My eyes moved back to the photo.

In all the time I had known Natalie, she had always kept her bush trimmed neatly in the summer, and pretty nice in the winter (though less meticulous). I had no complaints about that.

But this...

This was a whole new ball game. I could barely stop staring at what she had done. She had waxed herself completely bare.

I wanted to feel her bare lips on my palm, smooth and silky. I wanted to hold and fondle her and then let my fingers sink in and get wet. My cock was throbbing. I was almost ready to fuck her right in the booth.

She took the phone from my hands. "I'll have to get a better shot," she said.

I was unable to speak. There was nothing wrong with that shot, I wanted to tell her. Ethan would like it just fine. In fact, the stark, amateur quality of it almost made it better. The fact that it took a few seconds to realize that the pale and pink shapes you were looking at were Natalie's waxed cunt almost made it that much more of a thrill to look at.

"Send it," I said. I was surprised by how commanding my voice was.

Natalie was holding the phone, and her eyes fluttered up to meet my gaze. "Really?" she said.

I nodded. "He'll like it. Just the way it is. Send it."

She shrugged, and her fingers slid over the screen. Then she set the phone down.

I desperately wanted to look at the picture again, but I also didn't quite believe what she had done. I slid closer to her, and put my hand on her bare leg where the slit of her long dress had fallen open.

"Here we are!" Our waitress materialized out of nowhere and plopped our Cajun combo plates in front of us.

We both looked at her, and the stares must have been terrifying. We were both off in our own world, thinking about one carnal thing.

The waitress smiled, the way you would at crazy people, and backed away without asking us if we needed anything.

The food disappeared from my thoughts. I slid my hand over Natalie's thigh, and she helpfully pulled her legs apart so that as my hand traveled further beneath her skirt, it had a clear and easy path to her pussy.

I dove in, and placed the whole of my hand on her slippery, silky-smooth slit. There was nothing there but her soft skin, and the bursting, already-wet silk of her inner lips. I drew a finger along the center of her and found her clit. It wiggled away in the slippery pool of her excitement.

The phone buzzed on the table. As I stroked Natalie's newly bare pussy, she lifted her hand absently and opened the message from Ethan.

[Steve]: *i want to b the first to taste that*

A flare of pride went through me. *Too late, Ethan*, I thought. Natalie's mouth fell open a little as I stroked her firmly, making her squirm. She smiled at Ethan's message and her eyes went to mine. The phone buzzed again.

[Steve]: *give me more*

I raised my eyebrows. He *was* a greedy Gus.

But I guess I would be, too.

I was.

Natalie started to pick up the phone, but I grabbed her hand and pressed it into the table. I leaned over her, pinning her into the booth, not caring who saw us or what they thought. I nuzzled her neck. "Wait," I whispered. I stroked her clit rhythmically, quickly, and her body shuddered and struggle beneath me as she tried to stay calm and not make a scene. Her mouth fell open and she gasped when she finally went over the edge, and her leg jerked and bumped the table.

But I didn't stop there. By now I could feel precum gushing out of my won cock, and I wasn't entirely sure that it would be impossible for me to just burst without even touching my cock. But an animalistic urge came over me, a perverse desire to make Natalie really suffer, and I pushed my pinkie and thumb against the pressure of her thighs to close and get me to stop. I plunged my fingers into her quivering cunt and clawed forward at her g-spot.

Natalie wrenched her hand from under mine and the phone fell with a thud onto the booth. She grabbed a napkin and brought it to her mouth, almost as if she were going to have a coughing fit. Her thighs squeezed closed but it no longer mattered; I was already inside of her, rubbing her on that patch of nerves that drove her wild.

Like all women, she was ultra-sensitive after she came, and so for a minute she squirmed to get away from my touch. It was too intense for her, and she could barely stand it. But we were in a public place, and she didn't want to make a scene, so she pressed the napkin to her mouth and her eyes watered slightly. Valiantly, she made it look like she had eaten some of the much-too-hot sauce.

But around my fingers, her liquid pussy pulsed and shuddered. Then she slowly relaxed, and finally I could feel her own desire winding up again inside of her. Now she was ripe again, ready to go over the edge. She began to rock slightly with my fingers, helping me along.

Sweat beaded next to her hairline; sweet little drops that threatened to but never pooled enough to slide down her skin.

I stopped, and she mewled. She ground her ass against my hand and the seat.

I breathed in the scent of her neck. The smell of her pussy had traveled up and mixed with her sweat. She was panting, shifting her weight slightly to get my fingers to rub where she needed it most.

I slowly slid my fingers from her, and she let out a very quiet, disappointed moan.

“Send a picture of that,” I whispered. “And then maybe, if you’re very good, I’ll let you come again.”

Natalie dropped her hand to the seat next to her, staring straight ahead. Her smile was gone and she now had a look of desperation, which sent a thrill of triumph through me. Natalie was now out of control, and I would be lying if I said it didn’t thrill me to have turned the tables on her finally. Her chest was rising and falling quickly.

She held the phone up to get the camera ready, and I felt her thighs press back out again as she slipped the phone beneath the table to get another picture of her bare pussy. Only now, it would be dripping wet.

She lifted the phone and showed me the picture.

Her pink lips were engorged, flared open and glistening wet. Creamy cum was pooled at the base of her dark hole, sliding down, ready to coat her anus. My cock pulsed again, painfully now. I could feel the teeth of my zipper against my shaft. “It’s good,” I whispered, leaning in toward her. “But spread your legs wider.”

Natalie looked around the restaurant. I followed her eyes, mildly intrigued. I was so saturated in lust that I didn’t care who saw us, but I was mildly relieved that we were in the dark corner and there were few patrons.

Natalie arched her back a little and made a noise of protest, but she did what I asked. Her thighs spread open more, I felt the pressure of her leg against mine, and the flash illuminated the underside of the table.

She held her new picture up for me. It was filthy. Lewd. Her cunt was a gushing mess. “Send it,” I said.

She did.

I slid my hand back between her legs, which she left wide open for me. Above the table, we both looked remarkably un-slutty – if a little strange and stiff. If anyone had been at the very far end of the restaurant on the opposite side, they would have probably been able to see the whole show.

It was obscene.

I curled my fingers against her g-spot after I dipped them in, and then I turned to her and kissed her mouth as I pressed my thumb against her clit. I worked her to a froth, and then just for fun I paused, letting her squirm against my hand. A slight whimper came from her chest. “Please,” she said.

The explosion was almost immediate when I pinched her clit and g-spot between my fingers and made them slip sideways from the pressure. Her pussy gushed around my fingers and I felt the walls of her cunt squeeze and spasm rapidly. Her eyes rolled back in her head and she let her head fall backward. It took a moment for me to realize that she was digging her fingernails into the flesh of my arm so hard that she drew a little blood on my right forearm.

I slid my hand from between her legs smiling. But very quickly, my own needs throbbed between my legs. I surveyed the room and my mind went to thinking about how I could get away with fucking my wife on this table.

During the commotion, Ethan had sent her a message. I picked it up and read it, Natalie was still mildly useless, her head spinning. I could tell from the vacant stare on her face.

[Steve]: *hot. U can do better. Want to see you play with yourself*

The waitress approached us with a look of caution on her face.

“Everything okay?” She swept her eyes over the uneaten, untouched food.

I looked at Natalie. “I think she just had too much hot sauce,” I said, picking up a napkin and dabbing Natalie’s forehead.

The waitress wasn’t buying it, but she also didn’t know what else to say, so she just looked at me. “Can I... get you something?”

“You know,” I said, “We’re just going to step outside for some fresh air,” I said. “Let me leave my credit card, so you don’t think we’re walking

out on you.”

My mind amazed me sometimes. My fingers were already working through my wallet, slapping a piece of plastic on the table. Smiling at the waitress, who had no idea what was going on there, but also didn't want to think about it and was just realizing that she didn't care as long as she wasn't going to get stiffed. She picked up the card and smiled stiffly. “Okay, I.. let me know if you need anything.”

She backed away again.

I pulled Natalie with me by the hand as I scooted out from the booth. I headed straight for the bathrooms, behind the bar, close to where we were sitting. This was not the way to fresh air, but I didn't care and I knew the waitress wouldn't either. I pulled Natalie behind me and stepped into one of the three bathrooms. I was grateful that The Bayou's bathrooms were single, locking spaces.

“Send your picture to Ethan,” I said, putting the phone in her hand. We were in the family bathroom, and a wicker chair was pressed to the corner. Natalie fell into it and spread her legs open, looking at me as she did. I watched her eyes for a moment and then my gaze fell to her fingers, sliding between the folds of her engorged pussy, playing with her cunt.

She struggled to hold the phone and take the picture, so I took it from her hand and knelt in front of her.

She sipped her fingers into her gushing petals, but I saw that she was avoiding touching her sensitive clit. She must have still been reeling from her second orgasm.

“Natalie,” I said. “Make it good.”

Her fingers trembled as she placed a fingertip on her clit. Her body rippled with her own touch. A wave of cum squeezed from her pussy. “I can't,” she said.

“Do it,” I told her. “Pull on it so it's raw and slide your fingers over your clit. Make it look real.”

Natalie moaned, and she bit her lips and sucked in her breath as she used one finger to tug on the hood of her clit and then another to touch her raw, sensitive button.

She whimpered again.

My cock gushed precum. I took a photo. It was a beautiful, perfect shot, but I felt like cruelly making her do it again, and so I breathed: “No good. Do it again.”

Natalie whimpered again but she obediently swirled her fingers over her clit. I took another snap of her fingers in her pussy.

I sent the photo to Ethan while she panted in the chair, staring at me.

I couldn't take any more. I stood up, and unbuckled my pants with hurried, frantic fingers. My cock burst out of the confines of my underwear and Natalie, who had been lying on the wicker chair like a crumpled flower, staring at what I was doing, rose and leaned forward, her eyes suddenly interested. I put my hand on the back of her head, and she opened her mouth for me.

There was no teasing and no foreplay. By now my cock ached so badly and I was so wound up that I could feel myself going over the edge almost the moment my shaft entered her hot mouth. I pushed her onto my cock, and she accepted me all the way in. I felt myself completely enclosed by her mouth, the tip of my shaft pressing against the back of her throat. Her body spasmed as she gagged, but I was beyond any courtesy about this. I held her head, my fingers in her hair, and I fucked her in the mouth. Three quick thrusts were all it really took, and then I was boiling over. I pressed her head against me and exploded in her throat, clutching her hard against my pubic bone.

Natalie trailed her tongue along the barely flaccid length of my cock as she released me from her mouth. In doing so, she sucked up every last dribble of my cum. She smiled a little, and darted quickly down to the base of my shaft, making my entire abdomen seize up with the too-painful pleasure of it. Then she released my cock from her mouth and into her hand. She tucked me back into my boxers.

She looked up at me and grinned. "Did you send it?"

The phone was still, miraculously, clenched in my hand. I released it into her palm, and she swiped at the screen, an amused look on her face.

I watched her as her eyes lit up. "Oh, that really got to him," she said. Her fingers were moving quickly over the screen.

"What'd he say?" I asked.

I held my hand out for the phone. She looked up at me again as she deposited it in my hand. "Oh, sorry," she said. "I deleted it all. He was just like, 'oooh that's hot, give me more.'"

I gave her a funny look.

"I didn't want those pictures on my phone," she laughed. She stood up with a guiltless hop and crossed the room to the sink to wash her hands.

“I really am starving now,” she said.

I looked down at the phone. “But what... what are you going to do? Did you write him back?”

Natalie laughed as she went through the door. “Oh, make him wait.”

A woman gave me a very displeased look as I exited the bathroom after Natalie.

We wolfed down our dinner without talking too much. It wasn't an awkward atmosphere, just a tired, contented one.

In the back of my mind, though, my unease was simmering away. The further I got from one of the mind-blowing escapades with Natalie, the more disturbing my thoughts became. I knew I had no good reason for it, but I couldn't help feeling suspicious about Natalie and Ethan. Like there was something else there, like somehow I was missing something.

Take that thing with the deleted messages. I couldn't help but let it burn through my mind, stir up my suspicious side. I couldn't help but think Ethan had sent her some message she wanted to hide from me, and that's why she had deleted it.

It made no sense, of course. Natalie's explanation for deleting the messages was perfectly reasonable: she didn't want those photos lying around in her messenger or on her phone. And what did I think would have been more intimate, more unsharable, more... whatever I thought it was... than the pictures I had encouraged Natalie to send? What message could be more vulgar or more intimate than that?

But still, it bugged me. It bugged me that Natalie had gone and waxed her pussy bare, without saying anything. Her explanation for that added up, too, and I could hardly argue that it didn't drive me wild and it hadn't been an incredible surprise. I just couldn't help feeling there was something nefarious to it.

And all the shopping. When had she done all of this?

It was all so perfect. That, I think, was what really bothered me. Natalie seemed to know exactly how to wrap me around her little finger, exactly what to say to make me jealous, exactly what I wanted.

I looked over at her while we drove home. Our bathroom escapades had destroyed her hair, so she had freed it at the table. It was cool night, so we had the windows down and a breeze was lifting her hair and blowing it around her face. She had stretched a leg out to the dashboard, with her shoe

off, and the slit of her dress had fallen away so that the length of her thigh was exposed and it was possible to make out the contours of her shaved cunt in the shadows between her legs.

I shivered just thinking about the feel of her, perfectly smooth, slippery in the middle like a treat in a candy. My palms itched to touch her again.

“That was fun,” I said, finally, after we had driven almost all the way home in silence. I wondered what she was thinking about, with her mysterious and pleased smile on her lips. Was she thinking about how great she was at manipulating the two of us? Was she imagining how much fun it would be to tell Ethan all about this, to give Ethan exactly what she had given to me just now? Was she comparing the size of Ethan’s cock, imagining how he would feel when she finally got his huge cock inside her ass? What *was* she thinking?

She smiled and nodded, but her look of reverie remained unbroken. I felt the back of my neck itching.

“So... when are you going to implement this plan of yours?” I said. I was talking about her long-ago promised plan to end things on a high note for everyone. The plan she had told me I was going to love. The plan that we seemed to have abandoned.

She turned toward me, and leaned her head on the frame of the window, pulling her fingers through her hair. “You still want to do that?” she said.

A knife of pain plunged through me. The way she said it was sort of wistful, like she had second thoughts about calling it off with Ethan.

“What, you don’t?” I said. My voice came across as angry, snappy. I regretted the tone as soon as I heard it, but there was no taking it back.

If Natalie was miffed about it, she didn’t really indicate it. “I don’t know,” she said. She ran her hand down her bare leg. “I thought we were having fun.”

Her voice was taking on the sexual purr to it again, and she fluttered her eyelashes at me. “I’m having fun. Aren’t you?”

My cock was having fun. My cock was having fun and it certainly responded in the affirmative to the little show Natalie was putting on in the car right now.

But was *I* having fun?

I stared at the windshield, unsure of what to say. I could feel Natalie's eyes burning through me, and I felt like I could see every detail of her smile. Her smug, self-assured smile. She had it all figured out, she had everything under her control. And I was the one that couldn't keep it together.

But when I turned to her, she wasn't smiling that way at all. She looked worried.

"Look," she said. "I thought you were into this."

I looked back at the windshield. My insides twisted again. "I *am*..."

Oh fuck, It was so hopeless trying to explain this. I was. I wasn't. What was I?

"I just... it's complicated," I said finally, exasperated. I stole a quick glance at her. She had leaned her head back on the headrest and was looking up at the ceiling. She seemed exasperated with me.

"Of course it's complicated," she said. "I thought that's what you liked about it."

It's what I loved about it.

It's also what I hated about it.

Why couldn't I just say that to her?

"I think -"

Natalie was already interrupting me, which was fine because I had no idea what I thought I was going to say. "The only reason I keep taking things further is because you seem to be really into it," she said.

I looked over at her. She was trailing a finger along the edge of her plunging dress. "If you're not, that's cool, we can get that plan going tomorrow, if you want."

Was that what I wanted?

I gripped the steering wheel.

At this moment, I had a fairly clear head and I could say that I wanted exactly that. I wanted this all wrapped up, and my wife to go back to being... well, my wife.

I looked over at her again. My wife, with just a few subtle changes.

The person in the car with me was... frightening.

Hot. Incredibly, unbelievably hot. But almost – and I couldn't believe I was thinking this – too much so.

"I think that's what we should do," I said.

Natalie smiled, gave one of her indifferent shrugs, and pursed her lips to say, “okay.”

She slid a hand over my thigh and brushed her fingers over my cock. Then she left her hand on my thigh and leaned back in the seat, her eyes closed, her mouth in a very neutral expression.

Just one little corner almost unnoticeably turned up.

We'll see about that, her face said.

Even though I could have still had some energy in me, I told Natalie I was really sleepy and lay down in bed. She must have been exhausted, too, because she showered and slid into the bed to cuddle, but turned over languidly after a few minutes, and soon I felt the slow rhythmic sounds of her sleeping breath.

I tried to sleep, I really did, but my mind wouldn't turn off. As much as my rational mind had convinced itself that everything between Natalie and Ethan had panned out exactly as I had planned it with her, and that there was nothing more going on between them than the very thing I had urged her to do, – namely, a lurid physical relationship – there was still a large, emotional part of my brain that wouldn't let go of the conspiracy theories.

It got worse the longer I lay there in the darkness, until I was spinning up nonsensical fantasies of Natalie's betrayal that really exceeded both the boundaries of the physically possible and of good taste.

I sat up. I did it loudly, half-hoping to wake Natalie. Maybe I wanted to talk. But Natalie remained undisturbed, asleep, and her body didn't respond to anything I did. She didn't even reach for the covers that slid away from her when I sat up.

I went to the kitchen. I told myself I was there to make a cup of tea, but that was a lie and a pretty poor one: Natalie had converted to a full-on Southerner and probably didn't even know how to make a cup of hot tea anymore. There certainly weren't any teabags around.

No, the real reason I was in the kitchen was because Natalie's purse was in the kitchen and so was her phone. I shuffled around, putting on a show (for myself) of looking for tea bags and doing something else in the kitchen besides making a beeline for her purse. But after five minutes I found myself standing over it. It was unzipped, and the phone was practically sticking out of it.

We shared the same unlock pattern on our phones, so it was easy to open it up and start digging around in it. Sure enough, Ethan had sent two new messages as “Steve.”

But there was a curious thing about Steve. Natalie had not only deleted the pictures and the messages from dinner – she had deleted everything. For all time, up to the two new messages.

Almost as if she was trying to keep her real conversations with Steve a secret.

I opened the messenger app and stared at the messages.

[Steve]: *dont keep me waiting*

[Steve]: *I cant stop thinking about u. U must be with e but if u get away call me I just want to hear your voice*

I just want to hear your voice?

A new kind of jealousy, and anger, twisted inside of me.

It was one thing if Ethan and my wife were having a fling, based purely on sex. But it was quite another if someone “just wanted to hear someone else’s voice.” I felt a wave of heat creeping over my face. The phone was shaking in my hand.

For a few seconds, I considered deleting the messages.

How could she? How could Natalie play this kind of game?

I paced the kitchen. I needed to calm down.

After a few minutes I could reason with myself. Natalie, after all, hadn’t sent this message. Ethan had.

Natalie was sleeping in the other room. She hadn’t even taken the phone with her. She was, in fact, blissfully and cruelly unaware of these messages and indifferent to the fact that Ethan might have sent them.

That was true. She had just gone to bed, leaving her phone here. She hadn’t been compulsively checking it. She didn’t even care what happened to Ethan after she sent him those messages.

I had a wave of sympathy – it was temporary, believe me – for Ethan. I pictured him sitting in a hotel room, swiping through his collection of photos of Natalie, hoping she would call him. He was just as wrapped around Natalie’s finger as I was.

But like I said, the sympathy was short-lived. Especially when I thought about the fact that the pictures he was swooning over were pictures of my wife playing with her own shaved pussy.

The thrill of the more familiar, hot jealousy went through me.

I dropped the phone back into Natalie's purse. I didn't bother trying to hack a way to make the messages look unread: I planned on telling her that I had looked at them. Honesty, after all, was a two-way street.

For some reason, I felt better. Natalie had her plan, and I had no reason not to believe her that she would get it going tomorrow if that's what I wanted.

And after reading Ethan's texts, if there was any hesitation about whether or not I needed to get Ethan out of my house, it was gone.

It was time to wrap all of this up.

CHAPTER 4: TURNED TABLES

Natalie slept through the night without even once turning, and I'd be a liar if I didn't find that extremely unsettling. Especially since after I went back to bed, I wasn't able to sleep very well.

She rose at six on the dot, almost like a vampire waking. There was no stirring or stretching, she just sat up.

Then she looked over at me.

Then she stretched, a long and seductive stretch. She yawned. "How'd you sleep?" she asked me.

I shook my head.

She leaned over and kissed me. "Oh, I'm sorry. Why not?"

Somewhere in the wee hours of the night – maybe in the kitchen and maybe as I lay there trying to sleep for the rest of the night – I had decided to just cut to the chase with Natalie.

"I had a lot on my mind," I said. "I went and got into your phone. I read some messages from Ethan. Then I still couldn't sleep. I think we need to get this plan going."

Natalie seemed utterly unaffected by the fact that I had broken into her phone.

She blinked. "Yeah," she said. "I told you. I'll get it going today when he gets back. Then you leave this weekend, and... there we go. Unless... you want to just skip that part of it?"

I did.

I didn't.

I waited too long and Natalie plowed ahead. "So what'd they say?" she asked carelessly.

I was lost. "What?"

She threw the covers away dramatically and stood up. "The messages," she said as she trotted into the bathroom. "From Ethan. What'd they say?"

I stared at her as she slipped her nightie – the same silky white one she had worn to fuck Ethan in the middle of the night – away, and I got a great, gulping view of her body and her shaved snatch. In spite of myself, I started having some truly dirty thoughts. My palms felt hot as I remembered

the feel of her bare cunt beneath my hand, the pleasure of sipping into her slit where it was hot and wet...

She looked over at me. "Erik? Hello?"

I blinked.

She shook her head and opened the shower door to run the water. This was a habit Natalie had brought with her from her brief tenure as a rural Illinois denizen (which had ended when she was 5). She seemed to believe that her hot water heater was still in an uninsulated basement in Illinois in the grip of a terrible winter, and that it was necessary to run the water for 20 minutes before she took a shower.

She looked over at me, and smiled, because she knew what I was fuming about. "Anyway," she said. "The messages? Were they sappy? He sends really sappy messages when he gets drunk."

I sat up and spun on the bed to seated, facing the bathroom. Natalie was brushing her teeth now. She found my habit of doing so in the shower as repugnant as her pre-shower heat-up was to me. "You aren't mad I broke into your phone?" I said.

She scraped her front teeth and shrugged. "It's not like you don't know any of this stuff."

She spat.

"He said he wanted you to call him if you were awake," I advised her.

She rolled her eyes as she made a turn to the shower that included showing me the full front of her body. There were faint bikini lines over her snatch, and even fainter ones up where her top would have been. She looked incredible, especially with her tan. Her hair was lighter, nearing a dark blond. With her shaved snatch she looked almost too youthful to be my wife.

"I'm glad I just went to bed," she said.

It took me a second to realize she was talking about Ethan. Again, I felt that peculiar sensation of sympathy roll over me. Almost defensively, I said: "I thought you felt sorry for him? He was so sad about Moira?"

Natalie turned in the shower and held her hands near her shoulder. She looked at me plainly. "Are *you* feeling sorry for him now?"

"Deja vu," I said crossly. We seemed to be back in the same conversation from two days ago, just taking opposite sides of the same absurdities.

She leaned back into the water. “I feel sorry for him, like... I don’t want him to know we’ve been gaming him all this time, but at the same time... *it is* a game.”

I stared at her.

“I thought that’s what you wanted,” she said.

It was.

It was what I wanted.

I just couldn’t believe my wife had turned into such a... such a... slutty little vixen.

“Look, do you want me to spend the weekend with him or not?” she said.

“I want you to wrap things up,” I said. As soon as I said it, I realized it was the most clear-cut, honest thing I’d said in a while.

She opened her eyes. “I know *that*. I’m saying, weekend or no weekend?”

She stepped out of the shower while I mulled this over. I must have had a contemplative look on my face, because she gave me plenty of time to think about it. She placed her foot on the bathtub and dried herself off, a towel wrapped around her hair. Then she wrapped it around herself and faced me, her arms folded.

I suddenly had a finger on what I wanted. On what was upsetting me.

I slid to the edge of the bed. “What do you want to do?” I said.

Natalie got it. What “it” is I couldn’t quite tell you. But she got it. Her eyes lit up, her mouth twitched. She walked over to me and unfolded the towel. Her damp skin smelled like citrus and flowers. I could smell her pussy beneath those sharp, fake tones. Real and sweet. Her bare cunt was almost at eye-level, the red slit shiny with excitement. I looked up, taking in the smooth, tan skin that swelled at her breasts and ended in a pink, perfect nipple. Hard, ready to be bitten lightly.

“*I*,” she said, “Want to spend the weekend with Ethan, while you watch.”

A shiver traveled through me.

This was what I actually craved.

I pulled her toward me, placing my hands on the back of her knees and gently tugging until her left knee came to rest on the bed and her bare slit was directly in front of my face. I didn’t get into much foreplay, aside from stroking the back of her knee. I pressed my face to her silky-soft skin,

and her cunt opened up beneath my mouth, breaking open into a wet, sweet fruit. I dove in with my tongue, sliding along the hard ridge of her clit until I reached the center of her nub. Her body shook when I stroked it with the blade of my tongue. I moved my hands up to hold her to my face by her ass, dipping my fingers wantonly into the now-soaked part between her buttocks as my tongue massaged her clit. I looked up at her face: she had her head tipped slightly back and her eyes closed. I willed her to look at me, but I also enjoyed the idea that she might be imagining someone else eating her alive. Her abdomen rippled and she began to breathe raggedly. I pulled away and felt her body shake with tension. Her head dropped to watch me flick at her clit with my tongue, teasing her. “What are you going to do with Ethan all weekend?” I said.

I slid my fingers over her ass, playing with the clean, rubbery circle of her anus. I drew some of her juices up and used them to slide my finger over her quickly and lightly.

“I thought I’d try something new with him,” she said. Her hand came up to my head and grasped my hair. She pushed me against her pussy, and started to grind against my face. Her juices were slopping all over me now, and I moved my mouth against her whole cunt. The sensation was delightful, with all of her bare and silk-smooth. I could feel her body getting stiff, tensing up, and then she exploded in my mouth and let out a high-pitched wail.

I pulled on her knees to get her propped up over my cock, and I fumbled with my boxers to free myself. She rose up, still shuddering with her climax, and let me guide myself to her pulsing pussy. Then I grabbed her and jerked her body over my cock. It was incredibly vulgar – Natalie was lost in her own draining orgasm, and she was limp like a doll as I pumped her over my cock until I filled her up again.

She leaned against my shoulder and laughed lightly. Then she bit me, and the small nip sent a shudder through me that almost felt like a second orgasm. My cock throbbed inside of her cunt. “Now I have to shower again,” she whispered into me ear.

She placed her lips on mine, and gave me a kiss. “So is that a ‘yes?’” she said.

Who even knew what the fuck I was agreeing to anymore?

I nodded.

Of course it was a yes. At this point I was going to do whatever Natalie wanted.

She smiled and slipped off of me. My cock flopped out, still semi-hard, wet and almost raw from all of this extreme sex.

Natalie went back to the shower.

I was still ready for more.

I talked myself into a cheery mood after the morning.

The plan was being laid: Natalie was going to put on a final, weekend-long performance, and then Ethan was going to go home. And we could all get back to our regularly scheduled lives.

After having a great deal of very dirty fun.

It was for the best. The kids were coming home in a few weeks; friends from high school couldn't live with you forever; everything was on the verge of getting too emotional... this was a good plan, one in which I could at least pretend I got to have my cake and eat it, too.

Right?

Right.

I actually made it through half of the day without losing the thread at work. Sandy was back, and supremely displeased with the state of the office. Her desk was piled with things I'd let go too long, letters that needed responses within 30 days and had languished there until their 29th day. Her phone was ringing off the hook. I had the presence of mind, halfway down the hall, to turn around and go to the coffee shop to get her a croissant. I asked her about her trip, and actually listened to her reply. I could tell it didn't smooth things over completely with her, and to tell the truth I couldn't blame her, so I retreated to my office and steered clear of her eye-rolling. Which I deserved.

But at about 2:00 my phone rumbled, and I knew it was from Natalie. I was on the phone with a client, and I shouldn't have checked the message. I waited for all of thirty seconds, but I couldn't stop myself.

[Natalie]: *alls fair in love and war*

I stared at the text, and my body ran hot and cold with fear and excitement. I didn't know which one to feel.

The phone shook in my hand again.

A picture materialized on my screen.

For a moment I thought it was Natalie's picture from the night before. It was her bare snatch, pulled open by her own fingers, her ring finger dipped deep into her flesh all the way to her wedding ring.

I stared at it.

Then I realized that the picture was not from last night, but from – I guessed – today. What did she mean by all of that? I stopped listening to my client, who was engaged in having a self-directed therapy session while telling me what he wanted to change in his will and why (I had it all in writing), and my mind started racing to all the possibilities, all the lurid ways that this photo might have come about.

The phone buzzed again.

[Natalie]: *having lunch with Ethan*

My heart fell through my body, or maybe it burned its way out of my chest, passing right through my cock as it went. My hand jerked with the force of my feelings.

Was she there with Ethan right now, as she had been with me? Maybe she was at The Bayou, nibbling on her pickles in the same dirty way, sliding her phone beneath the table just as she had with me. Was she also sharing that she was sending the picture to me? Were she and Ethan having the same kind of laugh that we had the night before?

I waited, breathless.

Into the phone I said: "Greg. I have to call you back. I'm... I'm having a sudden thing."

I didn't listen to his answer, I just hung up the phone. I was sweating. Sandy frowned at me through the window but went back to typing, probably bitterly.

[Natalie]: *im planting t seeds of or plan*

A chill traveled along my spine.

[Natalie] *but im goi ng to put my finger in hs mouth*

Jesus.

I exhaled sharply.

I had to loosen my tie. Sweat was beading on my head.

I had no idea what to write, or whether to write. Did Natalie care?

Surely she knew how things would be received on my end. She seemed to know how everything would be received, by each of us, and she seemed to enjoy – scratch that, *relish* – having such power over the two of us.

[Natalie]: *that was before*

The message was cryptic, and I set the phone down and looked at it for fifteen minutes, waiting for an explanation to come through. But none did. I eventually had to start working again, to avoid spending the whole day staring at the phone.

Waiting.

At about 3:30 it buzzed again, and my hands shot out faster than a reflex to grasp it and open her message.

[Natalie]: *after*

Above the text was another picture. This was also of her pussy, but now it was distended, clearly violated. The lips of her cunt were spread open, engorged and wet. Her clit was fat and swollen in the center of her reddened petals, and she had her legs spread much more widely, so there was a clear view of her dark hole – distended – and the white cum trickling out of it.

Another shaky exhale.

I looked up at the glass window with shitty metal blinds that divided my office from the foyer where Sandy worked and glared at her. My cock was throbbing. If Sandy weren't here...

Your practice would fall the fuck apart, I reminded myself.

I had to stay until 5:00 and make it look like I cared that I had stiffed Sandy all week long by doing next to nothing. I spun in my chair and stared at the wall. I took some calming breaths. I had all weekend to enjoy this very kind of thing. *Fuck*. What the hell was Natalie doing to me.

When I was sufficiently calm, I spun back in my chair and buzzed Sandy.

“Sandy bring in some of those late responses, I’ll take care of them before I leave.”

Sandy was there in an instant with her inbox, which she dumped unceremoniously on my desk. “Thanks,” she said coldly. “Appreciate anything you can do.”

I said nothing and began to fish through them for the worst. I deserved it.

For the next hour I dedicated myself to mail.

I had no idea what I was coming home to. I parked the car on the street and came in through the front. I shut the door behind me and listened.

Natalie's glittery laugh sparkled in the backyard, right through the closed porch door.

My heart started to race: could it be a sexy-time laugh, a laugh as she had an orgasm, or maybe an afterward-laugh? Was I walking in on them, writhing together for the second- maybe even the third – time?

But almost as soon as I thought this, the back door opened and Natalie popped in.

She was clad in her red bikini. And only her red bikini. My eyes did an uncontrolled fall to where her cheating, bare cunt was beneath the fabric.

“Oh, hey!” She set a beer on the counter and came toward me as I walked through the house to the kitchen. Ethan was right behind her. He smiled at me and lifted his beer, but the smile seemed off. A little forced. A little... something.

His eyes dropped down as he looked away. In that time, he took a good drink of Natalie's ass. He went back outside. He made an exaggerated gesture that I took to mean: *I'm faking having forgotten something*.

Natalie looked behind her and then looked back at me. “Oh, shoot. I wanted him to overhear this.” She kissed me on the cheek and whispered in my ear. “To make it sound more authentic.” Then she giggled. “Well, your flight's all booked and so's your hotel, and then... you didn't forget I have that class to teach tonight?” She lowered her chin. “Because *I* did. So you guys are on your own tonight.”

I looked at her.

“I suggested you go out somewhere,” she said. She had a little glint in her eye. Then she practically shouted. “Okay! Gotta get ready.”

“So wait,” I said, grabbing her wrist, “did you book me a -”

The glass and screen doors scraped open again and I cut myself off as Ethan came back into the kitchen.

"I have to get ready," Natalie said, and she trotted off to the master bedroom.

Ethan leaned against the counter, and he didn't make a very big show of not watching my wife as she trotted away. He bit into a sandwich and looked over at me. "Looks like it's you and me tonight," he said.

I set my briefcase down. It wasn't the greatest news. I was having trouble picking up on whether this was part of Natalie's plan, or just a real class she had forgotten about (I certainly didn't remember it, but that didn't necessarily mean it wasn't real).

Ethan took a beer out of the fridge and opened it, setting it down on the counter for me as I approached the opening between the dining room and the kitchen, the little nook beneath it where I had spied on them that first night.

I took a sip of the beer.

"So where you headed off to?" Ethan said. "Charleston?"

I hoped that was the right answer. "Yup," I said.

"Easier to just drive," he said.

I drew a blank.

He munched on some more sandwich. "You know, than to go through security and all that. It'll take you about the same amount of time when all's said and done. Flyin' out of Greenville?"

I nodded.

I was feeling two things. One was, like an asshole. And not why you might think. I'm a lawyer, I don't know anyone who is a lawyer, even a contract lawyer, who doesn't feel like the truth is... well, what you make of it. Which is to say, I don't know anyone smart enough to get into law school who isn't smart enough to lie, and I never met a lawyer who was particularly uncomfortable with it, either.

So the lies? Well, they only bugged me because I wasn't the one who'd made them up, and that was putting me at a disadvantage. And maybe I felt a little bit... dickish telling them.

Then – and this was definitely the stronger pull – I was also feeling excitement.

I was about to leave my wife alone with Ethan for the weekend. And Natalie was going to give him a real ride, and then drop the bomb on him

that he needed to move out.

Well, that's what I was pretty sure she had said. I didn't think much past the part where I left her alone with Ethan for the whole weekend, him believing I was all the way in Charleston, and she gave him the ride of his life.

Her words.

My fantasy.

Natalie reappeared. She was dressed in capri-length jeans and a tight black shirt that clung to her curves. She seemed much more dressed-up than seemed possible for the amount of time she had spent in there. Her hair was swept up in a ponytail and swung behind her as she bobbed to the door.

“Toodles. Behave, boys.”

She bent over at the door, and I watched her ass as she slipped on some high wedges – the same ones she had been wearing the day Ethan moved in. It occurred to me to look back at Ethan after a moment of gazing at her shapely ass, and sure enough, he was staring lustily at her rear. He looked away quickly and took a swig of his beer when I turned, but I saw it.

Natalie opened the door. “Hey!” I called. “What time’ll you be back?”

Natalie looked back at us and swung her foot playfully back and forth in the doorway. “Late,” she said, and her voice was dripping with all kinds of implications, for me and for Ethan.

Even if we didn't know what they were. Looking at Ethan's face, I saw that the guy was just as on the hook as I was. Just as wrapped around Natalie's finger.

“So don't wait up,” she said.

I felt sorry for us both at that moment.

The next ten minutes were utterly awkward.

I had arrived home kind of late, because I had indeed left a gigantic mess for Sandy and once I got started I felt pretty lousy not seeing it through. It was almost seven. I looked at my phone, curious as to whether Natalie had messaged me any kind of clue as to which parts of the act she'd just put on were true, and which parts not. Or anything at all.

She hadn't.

I looked at Ethan.

He had the kind of scowl on your face that you get when your advances at a woman have been thwarted. How greedy could this guy get? I

was “leaving” tomorrow morning, and he’d have my wife all to himself.

That Natalie, though. What a piece of work, leaving the two of us here to mull over what we were missing out on. Building anticipation. She really had it all figured out.

A flicker of nervous pain went through me.

“So,” I said, to break up the silence. “Uh... you have any plans tonight?”

Ethan's eyes got wider, as though he had just remembered a really elaborate plan he had made for that night. He popped the beer out of his mouth and pointed it at me. “You know what? Let's go meet up with Charlie and those guys at The Sapphire.”

Oh god.

But there wasn't much else to do.

I shrugged. I was, at the end of the day, looking for a decent excuse to see what was inside The Sapphire, even if it wasn't really my thing. “Yeah, okay,” I said.

“Great. I'll make some calls. You... wear something else, man,” Ethan looked me up and down, and shook his head. He popped off with his phone in his hand.

I finished my beer and debated the virtues of changing out of my suit, before sliding myself off the bench seat and heading for my bedroom. It was going to be a long night.

CHAPTER 5: THE SAPPHIRE

The Sapphire Lounge was a new addition to Yorkdale's strip club scene, which had been pretty impressive as a per-capita calculation even back in the day when it was just a small town. The Sapphire was the newest club, and had come in when Yorkdale was absorbed as part of the "city," in an attempt to maybe be a little more upscale.

I had never been there.

In the end, only Pete Smith showed up. "Charlie and the guys" were all busy. Pete was another one of those guys who had been in Ethan's orbit. I suspected he was a lot like me, sort of uneasy with it but unable to escape.

Still, he was here. Just as sure as I was.

We exchanged the usual fist-bumpy manly-man intros and stepped inside. I noticed that Ethan didn't do any of his usual hand rubbing or grotesque jeering. Maybe he really was a changed man. There was something almost sad about it, even though I should have just felt relieved that he had managed to become a normal person in his life.

Like most strip clubs (not that I had been to many), The Sapphire was dark except for the stages, but the general atmosphere was classy. The tables and booths were all clean, the place shone like it had just been polished. The stages were backlit by a sapphire-colored hue, and the girls onstage were quite beautiful. They were also extremely acrobatic.

"For Yorkdale," Pete said solemnly, "this is a high-class joint."

Even I had to stare at the women on stage. One was particularly striking: she had raven-black hair down to the middle of her back and was doing the splits toward the audience and expertly sliding her finger under the fabric to tease us with the possibility of her ripping the whole thing off (which she couldn't do, legally).

But Ethan was barely looking at the girls. He seemed to be staring right through them.

We downed a few shots and didn't say much. In short, the scene was a disaster, especially with Ethan's vacant stares at the girls on stage. I wondered what he could be thinking, and if his sappy need from the other evening, to speak to Natalie, was creeping up on him again.

I wasn't in the mood to sit at a strip club and feel sorry for Ethan while smiling awkwardly every ten minutes at Pete Smith. I was thinking of an excuse to get out of there, when Pete beat me to it and said he had to be up early. Ethan held up a shot glass for him, but didn't try to get him to stay.

Great. I was stuck.

We watched Pete leave, and then Ethan swung around – away from the stage! - and leaned on his arms to drink the next shot with me.

I clinked my glass together with him and cleared my throat.

“Uh... how'd it go then, with Moira?” I said. I figured I had to ask about his conference call.

Ethan came back to planet earth. “Oh... fine. Yeah. Sort of sad. I'm getting over it.”

This seemed like a perfectly well-adjusted response.

Great, I envisioned myself saying. *So when are you moving out and when'll you stop fucking my wife?*

But if Ethan had any doubts about what he was doing, or any remorse, it didn't show on his face. His mind was elsewhere, but it was a very distinct kind of elsewhere.

I snapped my fingers in front of his eyes. “Hey man,” I said. “You aren't even looking at the girls.”

Ethan shifted his vacant gaze to the stage, where a very pretty – and extremely athletic – blond was spinning upside-down in nothing more than a silver-g-string. Her flawless and very young body undulated and bounced in a way that even a married and obsessed man like myself could find delightful.

Ethan seemed to look right through her like she wasn't there.

We had another round of drinks and watched the next set of dancers. Don't get me wrong: my mind was on Natalie, but some of these girls were really something. I had an erection and it wasn't being helped by the strange, vacant stare on Ethan's face.

Emboldened by my fourth shot and second full beer, I leaned my arms on the table. Over the loud music, I yelled into Ethan's ear. “So seriously man. What's with you?”

Ethan snapped his eyes at me. “Whadya mean?”

“You're barely looking at these girls. You *love* girls.”

At such a provocation, the Ethan I had known before would have jumped up and lured one of the dancers off the stage and carried her around

the club. He would have gotten us kicked out within five minutes and laughed the whole time.

Instead, Ethan stared at me and played with the corner of his coaster. A habit of his, perhaps the only tell that he was nervous, was to fold the corner of something sturdy, like a dollar bill or a coaster, and begin to flick it rapidly back and forth so it clicked. He said nothing.

It was then that it dawned on me. He was not looking at dancers because he was thinking about Natalie. The poor guy was so wrapped around Natalie's finger that he was barely enjoying one of his favorite pastimes, strippers.

I was about to lean over and ask him if he wanted to get out of there, even though it was early and we'd have essentially wasted our cover charge. But at that moment, he fished his phone out of his pocket and greedily delved into the text message. He smiled at the screen, and tucked the phone back into his pocket.

His mood was noticeably improved. "Want to order another beer?" he screamed at me. The music was deafening. He reached out and pulled a waitress toward us by her bare thighs – the sort of thing that was obviously off-limits and definitely would have gotten anyone else tossed out, but also the sort of thing that Ethan did with such panache that neither the waitress nor the bouncers got ruffled, and she plopped down in his lap to take his drink order with a smile.

Old Ethan was back.

My head was pretty foggy from all the drinks, so I spent the next minute trying to sort out what was going on and got nowhere.

Ethan slammed his hands on the table. "Gotta hit the john!" he yelled.

I watched him go and rubbed my eyes. I decided to text Natalie, though what I planned to say, I have no idea. I took my phone out.

There was a message from Natalie, and a missed call. My heart fluttered.

I looked at the time.

She had just called.

She had just messaged.

[Natalie]: *coming to meet u*

I stared at the message. I typed back:

[Me]: *what, here?*

I stared at the screen.

Everything that had transpired in the past few minutes started to swirl around in my head. Ethan's changed mood. His text -

- had he gotten it before or after mine? -

his vacant stare, his loss of love for strippers, his re-ignited libido, his text message

His text message.

His rejuvenating, invigorating text message.

The terrible, cold feeling I had been getting so often began to slide over me from head to toe. I stared at the dancers on stage without seeing them.

Ethan plopped into a chair next to me. He slapped me on the arm and I looked over at him. The waitress was back, setting two beers on the table. I was about to order Natalie a drink, get it in there that I knew she was coming, that she had texted me as well, that I was still her husband and she didn't just send messages to Ethan.

But Ethan had me beat. "Whoa, darlin'!" he yelled. "Better make that three!" He clapped his hands together.

He was looking over my head, at the entrance. I turned, beer in hand, and for a moment I didn't see what he had seen.

And then I did.

It was Natalie, all right. But Natalie 2.0.

She was encased – for really, there was no other word for it – in a black dress that clung to her body and barely even managed to do that. The fabric was some kind of strange material that let a hint of her skin peek through it. I scanned her body, and noted that the sheerness of the fabric seemed to halt at her crotch.

But not really at her tits. The color of her flesh was very clearly the layer beneath the gauzy fabric, and I could distinctly see two dark pebbles where her nipples were.

Her hair was down and she had straightened it. She also seemed to have done something much different with her face – make-up, though I couldn't really say what it was about it that looked so much different. Maybe a lot of mascara, or some eyeliner. Her eyes looked slutty, smokey,

enticing. I could see them from across the room, however she had accomplished the effect. They popped, sultry and enticing.

She slinked over to us as I stared at her.

“Look what the cat dragged in,” Ethan said.

Natalie smiled at me. “Surprise!”

“What are *you* doin’ here?” Ethan said, as Natalie slid into my lap.

The dress was very, very sheer, and I knew that both Ethan and I were looking at the same thing: the swell of her breasts and the visible aureole that we both longed to bite into at that moment. Natalie was warm, freshly showered, and soft on my lap. She kicked her feet and turned to me. “I got done early,” she said. “And I’ve never been to a stripclub. So I thought I’d surprise you.” She slid her arms around my neck. Then she looked around, her eyes wide, a faint smile on her lips.

Playfully, she kept leaning back until her head was hanging upside down, and then she popped back up to look at us both. From Ethan to me, and back again.

The question that should have hung in the air, had anyone had the presence of mind to think about it, was this: how did Natalie know we were at a strip club?

Ethan was staring. He couldn’t hide that he was staring any more than I could have hidden it. He also couldn’t hide that since Natalie had arrived, the vacant stare had washed away from his face, and a light was illuminating him. An inner light. He was fucking thrilled that Natalie was there. And his attention was riveted to her.

Natalie put one hand on her leg and ran it down her shin. She extended her long leg and twisted her ankle. She was wearing a black-patent leather shoe that was about three inches high. “What do you think of my shoes?” she said softly, close to my mouth.

“You’re really bad,” I said. Her shoes were really bad, too. Beautifully shiny, slutty-bad shoes that I had no idea where she had gotten them. I had no idea if she had ever gone to teach a class, or where she had gotten this get-up from, or how much of this scene had been planned out way in advance by her, or by her and Ethan together, or not at all. I knew nothing, nothing at all, about my wife.

And I didn’t really care.

Natalie smiled her increasingly unnerving smile, which also seemed to have a direct, wired connection to my cock. “I know.”

Oh sure, I wanted to ask her if she'd told Ethan she was coming. If the text that had so changed his mood was from her. And if she had told him, why? Had she done it just to tease him? Or to make him feel like he was special and she just wanted to see him?

Or was she was just putting on an act, for me, and in reality Ethan was the one she really wanted to see to begin with?

But instead of asking any of these questions, I just ran my hands over the shape of her body until the waitress brought the drink Ethan had ordered for her.

"Shots," she said, as the waitress set a beer and a shot on the table for her. She looked at Ethan.

It should be noted that this entire time, Ethan had just sat there looking at Natalie. And while it was true that Natalie was my wife, and Natalie was sitting on my lap, I couldn't help but feel perturbed by what felt like a connection between the two of them.

Ethan raised another shot glass (I had no idea where it had materialized from, and I didn't have one). "Down the hatch, darlin'."

Natalie is not a big drinker. Certainly not a drinker of shots. She looked at the vodka skeptically, then rolled the glass between her fingers. The gesture was obscene somehow. Her fingertips moved over the smooth glass and there was nothing to think about the way that she did it except that it was the way you wanted her to massage your cock. My cock flexed against her, and I knew she felt it. Her mouth twitched with a little grin, which was for me, but her eyes went back to Ethan.

He was egging her on with his eyes to down the shot. Maybe he just wanted to watch her do it, to do something he wanted her to do and exert some kind of power over her. Possibly he liked the sight of Natalie's throat tipped back, watching her swallow, thinking about how he would have something for her to drink up later. Maybe the bulge in her neck as she gulped the liquid made him think of the way his fat cock puffed her throat up when he shoved his dick in there.

My cock bounced against Natalie again. Jesus. What was wrong with me?

Or maybe Ethan just wanted to get her drunk. Maybe he thought that if she was such a bad little girl when she was relatively sober, a few more shots would turn her into a super-slut.

Come to think of it, I didn't entirely mind this idea.

Jesus.

I was a sick man. I knew that. I knew that it was slightly demented, that the things I was thinking were very twisted and wrong.

But it didn't stop me from raising my hand and ordering another round. For me, for Ethan.

And for my wife, whose dark makeup and straightened hair and see-through dress made her seem like the kind of naughty girl who just needed a little nudge to get going in a truly filthy direction.

Also, I think I should point out: my judgment was impaired.

Natalie swallowed the shot and wiped her eye when she was done. She made an adorable face of distaste. "Whoa," she said. Then she touched her throat, and we both watched as she flitted her fingers over it. "Burns."

She slipped off of my lap and into the booth so that she was seated between me and Ethan. Clever little slut. She winked at me and I felt her legs adjusting to her new position, moving under the table. She was slipping out of her shoes, and she was going to find Ethan's leg with her foot right there.

She looked straight ahead, at the stage. Her eyes grew wide as she watched the raven-haired girl from earlier perform her incredible athletic feats. "That's... incredible," she said.

I wondered where her hands were. They weren't on me, but they were under the table. I wondered if she was feeling around for Ethan's cock. She leaned forward a little until she impacted the table, all the while staring at the stripper as though she were fascinated. I bet she had her fingers tracing the shape of Ethan's huge cock.

Ethan, for his part, was not doing a very good job of covering up his fascination with my wife. He was staring at the table in front of him, ignoring the strippers and the waitresses, his mind obviously on whatever Natalie was doing to him under the table.

I reached into her lap and found her free hand. I guided it to my cock.

"This girl's really good," Natalie said. "Are they all this good?" she looked from me to Ethan, and her arms were spread away from her body in the most obvious way. If you knew what you were looking at. I supposed it might have just looked like she was resting her arms on the booth.

But *I* knew she was drumming her fingers on both of our cocks. At the same time. While staring at a flexible and stunning stripper.

More drinks came, and Natalie slid her hands back to the center of the booth to have a second shot. Then she let her left hand crawl back to Ethan, who had continued to stare at the stage this whole time, as though there were nothing of interest to him in his own booth.

I was good and drunk at this point, so I leaned over to Natalie and started to kiss her. I noticed that she didn't move her hand from Ethan's lap – instead she let it stretch out so she could keep her grip on whatever it was she was holding. Ethan's gaze turned to the stage, and it was clear that he didn't want to see me kissing Natalie. I grasped her head and dug my tongue into her mouth, claiming it for myself. All the while I knew, from the motion of her hand, that my wife – the wife I was kissing – was stroking Ethan's cock, probably playing with the dribble of precum on the crown of it.

I pulled Natalie's hair tightly in my fist and tipped her head so I could look past her and see Ethan's clenched jaw and vacant stare, directed at the stage. He was getting closer and trying not to give anything away.

"Who are you going to fuck tonight, Natalie?" I whispered in her ear. "Me or Ethan?"

She smiled and moved her mouth close to my ear. "Well, you're the one going out of town tomorrow."

She looked down, and sideways, at her extended arm that was pumping Ethan's cock. If we hadn't all been drunk the whole thing would have seemed so ludicrous, but for some reason it had a sheen of verisimilitude – that I didn't know that my wife was pumping another man's cock while I kissed her. "I'm just teasing him."

She was evil, this one.

I slid my hand up and under her dress. I think I would have given anything to, at that moment, bump into Ethan's fingers.

It was easy to get to Natalie's gash because "new Natalie" wasn't wearing any underwear at all. She was wet, as I expected, and I slid my fingertips over her throbbing clit with ease. She squirmed. Her hand seemed to stop moving next to her, though she clearly still had a handful of whatever she had been pumping under the table. Ethan's face went a shade paler, probably with disappointment, and I perversely enjoyed the sight of him struggling through his disappointment while I fingered Natalie.

Natalie withdrew her hand from Ethan's side of the table and grasped a cold beer that had somehow arrived with her shot. She shuddered when I

made her come, and I knew that the effect of her climax hit Ethan like a shockwave. He nobly pretended to be absorbed in what he was looking at on stage.

Natalie's cheeks were flushed. For a moment she simply panted, trying to maintain her calm.

She leaned over to Ethan and said something in his ear. It took her a long time to say it, and he lowered his gaze as she did. At first his expression was angry, then disappointed. Then, at the very end, whatever it was that she told him made him brighten slightly.

He put a toothpick between his teeth and chewed it lightly. "Hey man, I think I'm gonna stay awhile," he yelled across the table at me.

Natalie gently nudged me to the left, indicating that I should get out of the booth. I scooted, still wondering what she had said to him. He was looking at me, shifting the toothpick around in his mouth, giving me an icy-cold stare.

A challenging stare?

I glared back.

Natalie pushed me and leaned toward me. "Let's go home," she said. "I'll explain to you on the way."

On the way, Natalie, I thought, you're going to suck my cock. And then you'll tell me what you whispered in Ethan's ear, and then I'll take you home and fuck you again.

"How you gettin' home?" I yelled at Ethan, over the music.

"Same as you, man, probably cab," he answered.

But he was looking at Natalie.

I was too slow to get my eyes to her face and see what kind of look she was giving back to him. They seemed to be sharing something, some secret, and it made anger flare up inside of me. But Natalie took my hand and slinked through the club. There was nothing to do but follow her.

Now that I was up close to her dress and she was walking, I could see that she did indeed only have a very narrow piece of fabric blocking out the area where her pussy would have been visible, and it only barely covered the crack of her ass. The beginning of the dip between her cheeks was visible, like cleavage poking out of a shirt. As she walked she swayed her hips seductively, the walk of a high-class slut, I would have said, if I hadn't known it was my wife.

The evening was hot and muggy. Natalie took out her phone and said something about calling a cab. But I had other business on my mind. I pulled her by the wrist to the end of the strip of stores the club was located in (XXX Videos, and a convenience store). At the end of the strip there was an embankment, and steppe of brick that tucked away into the shadows. I pushed her against the wall and kissed her, sliding my hand under the filmy dress in search of her silky-soft pussy.

The insides of her thighs were sticky with her own cum, and her pussy was soaked. I slid my fingers through it, enjoyed the feel of her hot liquid and bare skin. But I didn't feel I could wait for any further foreplay, I was so wound up. I began to unbuckle my belt, and in a frantic motion I turned her around at the same time.

She resisted the turn and dropped her hands to my belt to help me get out of my pants. She gave her hair a defiant toss. "Don't you want to know what I promised Ethan?"

She had that smile on her face, the one that so enraged me and turned me on. I fought the urge to grab her jaw and squeeze it, and instead traced my fingertips over her dirty mouth. My cock pulsed, feeling like it was going to tear open, but I felt like torturing myself a little longer. And so, evidently, did Natalie.

"What did you *promise* Ethan, you little slut?"

Natalie began to slide down the front of my body. She grabbed my cock with her right hand and squeezed it. Then she guided me to her lips, and rubbed the crown of my cock over her mouth. Her lips were dry and warm, but soon the precum oozing from my cock had smeared them with its sticky, creamy coat.

"Ethan doesn't like sloppy seconds," she said. "So I promised him I'd keep your cum out of my pussy."

She opened her mouth, looking up at me, and slowly took my cock into her mouth. She went deep, all the while meeting my eyes.

Her mouth was so hot and wet, and I was so near the edge, that I could barely think about the challenge inherent in what she had said. I closed my eyes and tried to will myself to take my cock out of her mouth and defy her promise to Ethan anyway. But she was pumping her face over my cock now, and when I opened my eyes and saw that she was still looking at me, her hands sliding up my chest in a gesture of utter

submission (that strangely, still placed me subordinate to Ethan), I almost went over the edge.

I felt my body moving ahead of my mind next. My hands reached down into her hair and tilted her head back violently, eliciting a shocked expression and a loud pop as my cock was pulled from her mouth. She froze, unsure of what I would do, a trace of fear creeping into her eyes.

I brought her to standing by pulling on her hair and turned her around so her back was against me. I pushed up on her skirt, which was made of such a flimsy material that it rolled up to above her breasts without even bunching much at all, and then she was bare and soft and I could grab her however I wanted. I didn't care where we were, or how many people leaving The Sapphire might be watching – though she was facing the embankment so maybe no one would see her. I fondled everything I could get my hands on while slid my shaft between her legs – just into the wet mess of her pussy lips, not inside of her. I used my cock to draw her cum and lubrication back and up to her ass. I pressed my mouth next to her ear. “Well, if we can't have Ethan sloshing around in my cum, we'll just have to fill you up somewhere else.” I grabbed her hair fiercely with one hand and pushed her toward the brick steps with the other, until she was bending over and pressed to the rough brick with her arms on either side of her.

But make no mistake: Natalie, my dear sweet and semi-conservative wife and lover, did not fight this rough treatment at all. NO, she seemed to very much want to be pushed over, to have me kick her feet gently to part her legs, and then to feel me press my cock against the pucker of her ass for a moment before I slowly slid inside of her.

This time there was little resistance. Natalie seemed to be not only a natural at anal but an aficionado. I wrapped her hair in my hand and pulled on it until her head tilted back. This arched her back and tilted her ass up, and then I was free to slam my cock into her as she moaned and squealed.

It didn't take long for my cum to spurt out of my cock, but the orgasm was incredibly long and drawn out. I continued to fuck her long after my cum had exploded inside of her ass. The creamy liquid sloshed and squirted out of the sides of my cock, and I pounded her mercilessly with my still-stiff cock for a full few minutes after I came. The whole time my body was racked with the high of my climax, and it wasn't until I fell doubled over onto her back that I realized I had probably been yelling.

Someone whistled in the parking lot, and I was suddenly aware of how obscene – and dangerous – this whole scene was. I slid out of her and pulled her dress down to its skimpy longest. The sheen of my cum was visible through the material, having splurged up and into the crack of her butt and smeared to the top when I lay over her.

Natalie pushed her hair behind her and turned toward me. I was fastening my pants. She looked over my shoulder as she placed her hands on my shoulders. Then she smiled. “There’s a fan club back there,” she said. “Don’t look,” she added quickly, as I began to turn around.

The back of my neck burned with a new kind of heat, this one was more fearful than anything. Especially when I saw the gleam in Natalie’s eyes. She looked from whatever she saw in the parking lot to my eyes. “I wonder...”

My heart thumped against my chest. I looked at Natalie, figuring she was *of course* joking, but reading her face for signs that she was not. Because there was no telling anymore.

“Natalie,” I said, my voice heavy with warning. And a hint of a plea, which I didn’t like at all.

But it was one thing to fuck Ethan, and another to take on a bunch of men in the parking lot of a strip club.

She laughed and kissed me. “I’m not *crazy*,” she said. She said this to me but at that moment her eyes went to the parking lot and I felt her hand move. Almost like she was waving.

I tried to turn around, but she stopped me by applying gentle pressure on my shoulder, while her free hand produced her phone and brought it up to dial between our torsos.

For a moment I felt another stab of jealousy. Was she calling Ethan?

She looked at me and grinned, her ear to the phone. I felt like the energy from behind me, from the parking lot where person(s) unknown might be ogling my wife, planning to gangbang her (who knew?) was making the hairs on my back rise.

“Yes, hi. I need a cab,” she purred into the phone. Her mouth moved silently, asking me a question, but I was too... muddled to make it out. Natalie widened her eyes. “Yes, it’s...?”

When I didn’t respond she said, “Outside The Sapphire, you know where that is? In Yorkdale, yes.”

She grinned and mouthed: “He knows where it is.”

“Oh, thank you so much,” she said, and she made her voice warm and sexy.

She sat down on the embankment, and we waited for a cab. I was relieved to see that whatever rednecks she had waved to or who had spotted us in the parking lot had abandoned their hopes of picking up where I left off and seemed to have left the area. There was a couple pressed up against a truck in the far corner of the lot, but no one else in sight.

“So what’s the plan, then?” I said, sitting down next to her. She crossed her legs, and her dress rode up to just below her ass. As she lifted one leg to cross it over the other, I saw that her inner thigh was a sticky mess.

My wife was such a *slut*.

She tapped her lips lightly with the fingers of her left hand. It was the hand she had been stroking Ethan’s cock with, and when she caught me staring at her she seemed to realize it herself. She smiled and sucked the tips of her fingers into her mouth. “He’s pretty worked up,” she said. “I was thinking of maybe sneaking into his room later, when he gets home.”

“What’d you say to him?”

She grinned. “I don’t want to ruin the surprise.”

This sent a shiver through me, and I could feel my cock getting hard again (it had never really gone completely soft). My head was spinning. “Tell me,” I said.

She gave her hair a toss and leaned back, placing her elbows on the wall behind her and kicking her foot playfully. “It’ll be so much more fun if it’s a surprise.”

I stared at her.

This woman was *not* my wife. She didn’t even look like her anymore, and she was far too confident and coy to *be* her. I felt a pang of regret, almost like buyer’s remorse. I never should have opened up this box.

I felt that. And then my cock started thinking and feeling for me, imagining what kind of demented, perverted, slutty surprise this woman would come up with that would exceed the things she’d already done.

“Okay,” she said. “I actually probably should tell you, so you don’t get too shocked when it happens.”

“Or maybe,” I countered, “to make sure it’s okay with me.”

The corner of her mouth twitched up, and the expression was one that both turned me on and made me want to slap her. “Oh, you’ll want to do it,”

she said. Her eyes shifted to the distance. “That’s us.”

She stood up and shimmied a little to get her dress down. “Now. This is Yorkdale, so let’s keep it clean in the cab. People know us here.”

I looked over at her in disbelief, given what had just happened – was she serious? I had just had anal sex with her against a wall in a strip mall? - and she was already smiling. She winked.

It was a joke.

We kept the cab ride clean anyway – it was only about five minutes to get home at that time of day.

Well, largely clean.

“What did you say to Ethan, anyway?” I said abruptly.

She looked over at me, and I thought for a moment she was going to demure. But she smiled and leaned close to my ear. As she whispered to me what she had told Ethan, my cock almost burst. She leaned back, bouncing a little as she rested on the seat. “Is that okay?”

I wasn’t able to answer, which she took for a “yes.”

And so we went home, to get the setting just right.

CHAPTER 6: TOO FAR?

“I told him: ‘Erik’s going to pass out if he has this much booze, so just stay a while and then when you come home you can have me all to yourself.’ But here’s the thing I was thinking of doing...”

Natalie’s voice burned through my mind as I lay in the darkness on my side, pretending to be asleep. There was no way I was going to be able to fake it, I realized. My heart was pounding and I was sure I was sweating. I couldn’t steady my nerves, or my breathing, or make my mind stop replaying Natalie’s dirty little plan, in her sultry little voice, as clear and perfect as though she were leaning over me and whispering in my ear.

Maybe Ethan wouldn’t take the bait.

After all – he wouldn’t be that fucking brazen, would he?

I *was* pretty drunk, though. I could feel myself starting to doze off after a while, but all it took was one little sliver of Natalie’s voice to echo in my mind, and I was wide awake again, heart exploding in my chest.

I wanted to roll over and see what Natalie was doing. The sounds of her breathing and the lack of movement on her side of the bed made it seem like she had actually fallen asleep. For real.

This was a big step. I had considered nixing it, because it was just so... out there. Over the line, Crude. Filthy. In a way, humiliating, except not, because... well, in the end, I didn’t exercise my veto power.

I couldn’t.

I couldn’t control myself.

I breathed deeply and tried to doze off. I was getting into a lull, and I was probably about three seconds from actually passing out, when a sound cut through my sleep and my eyes flew open.

I never heard Ethan come through the front door or walk through the house, but I heard him now, clear as a bell. Even though he wasn’t making a peep, I felt the weight of his body in the room, heard the movement of his hands as he slid the covers off Natalie’s body, and *heard* his fingers go through her hair.

The bed shifted behind me, as Natalie turned and placed an arm over me. For a moment I thought I had imagined Ethan’s presence, but then she ran her fingers through my hair, and whispered in my ear.

“Are you awake, honey?” My eyes were open, surely she could see that I was from where she was. She moved her hand down my body, and I stayed very, very still. I had a moment of thinking I wanted out of this plan, but I was helpless to actually extricate myself. She patted me on the crotch, and then I felt her body move. She snapped her fingers over my face and then said, sharply: “Honey!”

“See,” she said to Ethan. “Dead to the world.”

And then I felt the bed sink, as Ethan's full weight was transferred to it.

“Not here,” Natalie’s voice said sharply. She giggled. “Oh my God, Ethan!” she whispered.

His voice sounded like a half-human growl. “You said he’s passed out.”

“But-” Natalie cut herself short, and a little puff of air escaped her.

My eyes were closed now, and I concentrated on breathing normally. There were only sounds of skin sliding on skin, of clothing being pulled out of the way. The sound of a zipper. The bed shifted and moved as Ethan climbed on top of my wife, just behind me.

“Ethan we can’t,” Natalie said, and for a moment it was almost believable that she was protesting for real, that she hadn’t been the twisted mind who invented this little tableau to begin with. I felt her leg fall open against me, and the two of them froze. I heard Natalie’s hair sliding on the pillow, and I wondered if she looked convincingly panicked as she looked over to “see” if they had woken me up. But of course I was dead to the world. “Passed out.”

“You have me all weekend,” she hissed.

Natalie’s ability to predict exactly what would reel Ethan in the most was incredible. It was like she had written the script herself.

“But I can’t wait,” Ethan purred in his most Southern-charmy accent.

No further protest from Natalie, at least not a verbal one. The next sounds were quiet but they seemed as loud as thunder to me: Ethan’s lips against her skin. I could tell by the way that his weight shifted he was moving down her body. The kisses began dry, I could barely hear them. Probably he grazed her neck with his lips and maybe trailed his mouth along her neck, then her collarbone. But when he reached her breasts, the sounds grew wet. Now he had his tongue in it, making swirls around her nipple, sucking it into his mouth and playing with it in the heat of his

mouth. Natalie's body shifted, and she drew a hand to her side, between her body and mine. I could feel it ball into a fist as she grasped at the sheets. Then I heard her moan into the pillow, right next to my ear.

The sounds of Ethan's mouth on her body became sloppier and sloppier. His weight edged down, and with it I knew that his mouth was traveling down Natalie's body. I could feel her chest heaving behind me – my whole back was tingling with an electrifying hum. By now my cock was painfully hard, and I had to clench my own fists to keep from bursting out of my skin.

Natalie's leg moved again, against my back. I felt her body stiffen and her head tossed back and forth on the pillow. "You were so wet," Ethan whispered. "Did you break your promise?" Strands of her hair whipped against my skin, and I heard the unmistakable sound of Ethan's mouth and tongue plunging into her gushing pussy.

The sound began randomly and then turned to a steady rhythm of sloppy squelches as Ethan began to lap at her cunt. Natalie moved her hand, the one she had placed next to my back, to my skin, and she dug her nails into me and raked her fingers down my back. Her breath disappeared into the pillow next to my head in moans. I felt her body jerk as Ethan evidently hit a very sensitive place, and then I felt Natalie's hot breath through my hair, against the back of my head. Her mouth was against my head briefly and she panted, very low – almost inaudibly, especially over the mucking sounds of Ethan's attention to her cunt - "He's eating my pussy raw." Or something like that.

The pain that this caused is indescribable. A jolt of concentrated pleasure went through me, but it swelled suddenly, and because there was nowhere for it to go, no way for it to get out,. I felt like a tidal wave slammed against my skin, against the contours of my balls. My cock felt like it was going to actually explode.

I squeezed my eyes closed. And then there was another shift on the bed behind me: Natalie returned to biting the pillow and her moans and squeals became muffled again. Ethan's weight shifted on the bed, and I heard the squelch of her pussy as Ethan sank his cock into her.

Natalie's breath caught in her throat as the bed jerked with the force of Ethan thrusting himself deep inside of her.

And then there was more squelching, more movement, more of me fighting to keep my heart rate down as Ethan fucked my wife right behind

my back -literally – in my own bed. I heard Natalie gasp, and then the slap of Ethan's hand over her mouth, and then the whole bed shook for a full minute as he pummeled her hard. I felt Natalie's body stiffen and heard her stifled scream into Ethan's hand as she came. Then she fell silent. Her leg jerked against my back, and Ethan slowly threw a few more thrusts into her pussy, and the sound of her sodden cunt filled the otherwise silent room.

I had the urge, a violent urge, to roll over and scare the fuck out of the two of them. I wondered if this was Natalie's plan, because this was really too far. It was too far and yet... it wasn't. It obviously wasn't. I was obviously letting it happen. My stomach churned, bouncing between getting ill, spitting out bile, and feeling the sweet pain of my wife being a dirty slut right next to me.

I was paralyzed.

I was certain it was over, that Ethan had come silently in his manly way, filling Natalie's cunt up. But I was wrong, I realized, when I felt Ethan's weight shifting yet again. There was a great deal of commotion behind me, all of it plunging through my soul like a knife. I felt their bodies shifting next to me, brushing up against me. And then it stopped, and the bed was still.

I tried to make sense of what was happening behind me from the feel of the bodies next to me. It seemed that Natalie's arms was still lying along the length of my back. So what had changed?

And then I smelled the unmistakable scent of Natalie's sweet cunt. Just before Ethan said something in a low voice, something I couldn't quite make out. I strained to see what was happening, and in my peripheral vision I saw that Ethan was looming over her somehow.

And then I heard the sound of Natalie's mouth on Ethan's cock. "That's it," he whispered. "Taste your own sweet cunt."

The sounds, which like Ethan's kisses, began sort of "clean," turned rapidly into sloppy, wet sounds as Ethan shoved all of his meat into Natalie's mouth. I heard distinctly the wet stickiness as he stretched her jaw open wide and plunged into her throat. The bed shook lightly as he fucked her in the mouth.

And then very suddenly, he shifted his position again. Natalie's hair struck my back, and and I heard his cock plunging into her pussy. He gave her a few violent thrusts, and then he stifled a sharp yell as he unloaded inside of her.

For a moment there was nothing but the dank smell of sex, the darkness of the room, and the feel of their animal breathing behind me. I couldn't hear anything: my ears were ringing so loudly. I felt like I was going to rip apart if I moved an inch.

I heard him kiss her. "You better get up early and take a shower, darlin'"

Natalie said nothing – at least nothing I could hear – and kissed him again. The bed shifted as his weight rose off of it, and I waited, holding my breath, until I felt he was gone.

Natalie shifted in the bed next to me, and then I felt her fingers walking along my leg.

I turned violently and pinned her to the bed. She was naked, and she smelled like sex. I felt a puff of warm, moist air from between her legs – acrid with Ethan's cum. Their mingled juices sloshed onto my legs as I pushed her legs open beneath me with my knee. I could smell her sweet scent, adulterated by his salty seed. Her cunt was gushing, the sheets were cold and wet. Natalie had that little smile on her face, and I could see it clear as day even in the dim light.

"You little slut," I said, shifting my body so that my swollen cock found her engorged, soaked hole.

She spread her legs by sliding her hands down her thighs and then up along her calves, holding herself open for me. I buried my cock in her overflowing cunt, and it was so full of cum that it squelched as I plunged inside of her. My back tingled with the delightful fear of Ethan coming back through the door, though what there was to fear about that I had no idea. This was *my wife*, after all.

Natalie's pussy was still throbbing with the climax Ethan had given her. In almost no time, I could feel myself going past the point of no return, and she didn't help by stroking her spread legs and grinning at me, her mouth turned up in a smile of total victory. Natalie had everyone wrapped up and completely under her control, and she was loving it. I pummeled my cum into her without any regard for making her come again, and she didn't seem to care. She kept her eyes on mine, her delight unwavering, as I filled up her already-full cunt.

I collapsed on top of her, and she breathed under me, her eyes getting sleepy.

"That was very, very bad," I said.

Natalie's eyes were drooping closed. Her smile was unwavering, though. "I know," she whispered.

I rolled off of her, and she snuggled up against me.

I was almost drifting to sleep, when she shook me back to a violent wakefulness:

"There's still more to come."

But Natalie? She murmured this, and then she was off to dreamland.

CHAPTER 7: THE HOTEL

I felt like shit the next morning. Not really because of Natalie, but I had a hangover. Sleep had come to me much later, thanks to her little comment, which had set me down the path of envisioning “more to come” and double-guessing whether or not we had gotten in way, way too deep. In the end, though, I reassured myself that Natalie’s plan was to wrap things up, and the truth was, I didn’t really want to stop it.

I couldn’t help but be nagged, though, by the idea that Natalie was so... *high* on her sexual powers that she might never come back. There was nothing to really do but wait and see.

Natalie rose fresh as a daisy, and her carefree attitude burned me a little. She rolled over and kissed me. “Why the long face?” she said. Then she looked taken aback. “Don’t tell me you’re having second thoughts?”

I sighed. I played out the possibilities for this conversation, really quickly in my head. And then I decided there was nowhere good for them to go. This was the plan, and we had agreed to it, and I didn’t even know myself whether I had second thoughts or not. If I said to Natalie that I was worried she had become *too much* of a slut, I couldn’t see any good reaction coming out of it.

And was it really too much? Yes and no.

Sometimes you just have to let the other side play their full hand and see where that leaves you.

“No,” I lied. “I just have a mad hangover. Why don’t you?”

She stood up and walked to the bathroom. “I didn’t drink as much?” She turned on the water. “You better get ready. Pack your suitcase and all that. The show must go on.”

My wife was terrifying. But I really did have a hangover, and I needed to get “this show” on the road. I threw on some temporary clothes and went to the kitchen to make coffee.

I was not surprised but slightly disappointed that Ethan didn’t come out to say goodbye to me. The man who had been kind enough to let him into his house, and whose wife he had fucked in his own bed while he believed I was passed out.

Natalie came out to the kitchen decked out in some running gear: a pair of tight, short Lycra pants that barely covered her ass, and a tight gray tank. She popped an earbud into her ear and winked at me. “I’m going for a run while you get ready,” she said. “I told Ethan your flight leaves at 10:30,” she added in a whisper.

I said nothing, just stared at her as she slipped out the back door.

I packed my suitcase, and waited for Natalie to come back. She was cutting it pretty close. It was 9:07. If my flight did leave at 10:30, we should be in Greenville by 9:30 at the latest, and so we should leave at the latest by 9:15...

I stopped myself short. Why was I overthinking this? Ethan wasn’t about to check up on any of this shit. This was all just an elaborate fabrication so that it looked semi-plausible that Natalie was home with Ethan all weekend because I’d had a surprise... a surprise what? What had she even told him I was doing in Charleston on the weekend?

Natalie popped back in the door. “Shit!” she said, looking at the clock. “Let’s just roll.”

“You don’t want to change?” I said, looking at her tight, skimpy outfit.

Old Natalie would never have even gone running in that getup, let alone drive me to “the airport.”

She smiled her mischievous smile. “All part of the plan,” she mouthed. Then she cocked her head to the door. “Come on. We have to get rolling.”

She infused the situation with so much urgency I actually hurried, like I was actually catching a flight, and we left.

Natalie wanted, very bizarrely, to drive through McDonald’s on the way there. She wolfed down an Egg McMuffin, which was startling all by itself. “God,” she said, wiping her lips with her fingers, “I’m just so hungry.”

I suppose that made sense, after her multiple performances, but it was discomforting somehow.

I had one too, but that wasn’t the point. Natalie normally didn’t touch McDonald’s with a ten-foot pole.

She directed me to the hotel between mouthfuls of her sandwich. It was a Travelodge on the outskirts of Yorkdale, partway between there and

the beginnings of Greenville.

I looked out the window at the hotel she had booked for me. Pretty un-glamorous, but then, it was a Travelodge. “Come on up,” I said, turning off the engine. “Check out my... high-speed internet and... whirlpool in every room?” I squinted.

Natalie smiled and rolled up the paper from her sandwich. “It was short notice. It was this or slow-speed internet and hot tubs on every floor.”

I put my hand on her knee. “Come on,” I said. I started to push my hand under her shorts. I got as far as the silky feel of her outer lips before she pushed me away. “I have to go,” she said, slapping my hand. “Ethan knows it's only like ten minutes to the airport.” She opened the door and moved to get out.

“Say you got a coffee with me,” I urged, sliding my hand along her thigh again.

She moved her leg. “Do you want this plan to work or not?”

I could hardly see Ethan watching Natalie come through that door in that get-up, having made the implicit promise to fuck him all weekend, and doing some kind of complicated math about the airport drive before deciding that, nah, he didn't really want to sink his cock in her ass for two days... but I knew when to shut up.

Besides, the anticipation was going to make it all that much better.

“So... I guess that's it,” I said, getting out of the car with her. She was already coming around to the driver's side. “You'll text me. If anything... you know. Goes wrong?”

Natalie sighed. It wasn't an impatient sigh, just a plain old sigh. “It might be hard to always get where the Nanny-cam is,” she said. “I'll do my best. And I'll make sure to... you know... *tell* you all about it.”

I screwed my face up.

Natalie laughed and dropped into the car. Man, was she in a hurry to get rid of me. My heart felt squeezed. “I'm kidding. I'm kidding. I already have a plan for moving it around. Don't worry. You have to trust me.” She leaned her head on her hand, which was hanging on the wheel of the car. Her face looked particularly beautiful at that moment, her eyes especially mischievous but also loving, and her smile unreadable.

I was already getting a hard on just thinking about it.

I opened the back door and took out my hastily-packed wheely suitcase.

I leaned down and kissed her. I tried for her pants again, but I failed. She slapped me playfully. “Now go. Get that internet set up. I have a feeling things are going to happen pretty quickly.”

I kissed her again and then let her close the door. Natalie backed out, and then rolled down the passenger window to call out, one last time: “I’ll be home in ten... better hurry...”

And then she was gone.

And it was a done deal.

My heart plummeted.

The fucking hotel clerk was literally the slowest person on Earth. He walked slowly, he wrote slowly, he asked questions slowly but also using the maximum number of words possible. There was an incredibly large line of people standing in front of the desk for a Saturday. I was boiling inside of my own skin, sweating under my collar, and trying desperately to stand still and be patient as he even clicked his mouse slowly.

Finally, it was my turn.

A dot printer began its machine-gun squeal, as my receipt traveled in time from the eighties.

I looked at the clock. *And my wife’s arrived at home.* I felt the weight of the bag in my hand. If I had forgotten my laptop, well... it was over.

“Heeeeeeeeeeeeeeeere,” the man said. “You arrrrrrre.”

I snatched the receipt and thanked him. I walked calmly to the hallway and once I turned, I ran toward the number of my room.

Such a fumbling mess as I inserted the keycard and it stoically stared at me with a red eye.

My stomach twisted. By now, Natalie was stepping into the house.

Would Ethan be there, waiting for her? Had he the arrogance to go lie down in his bed naked and wait for her to come into his room? Or was he a little classier, waiting with a mimosa, suggesting they go back to bed and sleep in a little... right after he sank his dick into her cunt.

Finally the door clicked and the light turned green. “Jesus fucking *fuck*,” I hissed and threw the door open so hard it bounced back and nearly flattened me. I threw it again and kicked out a foot, my bag slipped out of my hand, the crumpled and apparently sweaty receipt went to the floor, and I dragged my bag to the desk to get started...

When the lights went out completely because the door closed and the blackout curtains were drawn.

Like I said, classy place.

My phone buzzed.

[Natalie]: *home now*

I tripped on the chair as I fumbled to the window and jerked open the curtains.

“Oh my fucking god,” I said. I was all craziness and unhinged movements as I unzipped my briefcase and jerked out my laptop, set it on the desk, opened it and began the painful process of connecting to the hotel's internet.

High-speed.

I pictured her getting home, Ethan enveloping her with his muscled biceps and kissing her neck, telling her how glad he was that I had left, so he could have her all to himself.

Over and over and over again.

I typed the password in and the internet rejected me. I tried again.

“Fuck!”

I called the front desk.

He asked me to try again.

By now Ethan would be sliding his fingers over the soft skin beneath Natalie's clean white bra. Thinking about how nice it would be if she had on the same kind of wholesome panties, thinking about how he would peel them from her hips and maybe bend her over right there...

Still nothing.

I looked at myself in the mirror. I looked wild. I looked like another man, and maybe I was.

I stood up and went wildly for the door of the room, planning to storm down to the front desk with my laptop and yell at the clerk, when the phone rang.

I stared at it. I shuffled things into one hand. I answered.

“Sorry about that, Mr. Ossington. As soon as I hung up I realized I gave you last week's password.”

My eyes went involuntarily skyward and around the aging and run-down hotel. Leave it to a place like this to change their password weekly

and something like the Marriott to leave it for years.

He gave me the new password and I held him on the line while I checked it.

Okay. Thank god.

I clicked open the Nanny-cam app.

And I froze.

My heart sank to the floor.

There they were. Already going at it.

My eyes were flooded with the image in front of me: my wife's back, bare and smooth, the shallow valley of her spine shadowed nicely in the black and white of the Nanny-cam, disappearing into the valley between her buttocks. Her ass was suspended over a man's legs – Ethan's, of course – and held on the left side by Ethan's hand. His thick, veined fingers were dipping into the crack of her ass, all the way to her cunt, and then moving back up with the motions of her rapid bobbing.

I stared. I looked at the time.

She had barely gotten home. How was it even possible that she was already bouncing on Ethan's cock?

But then I realized: they weren't fucking just yet. Ethan wasn't even fully undressed. The dark gray of a pair of boxers peeked out from under Natalie's bottom.

I stared at his hands all over my wife's splendid flesh. His hands were large and they nearly covered her ass. He pushed her hair from her neck and ran his tongue from her neck to her earlobe. Natalie let her head fall back in a gesture of rapture, and I felt a thrilling stab of pain. If she was faking things, she was a brilliant actress, and if she was not – she was really, truly enjoying whatever Ethan was doing to her.

They kissed, their lips meeting out of sight of the angle of the camera, but the way that their faces melted together and they moved, I could easily imagine their mouths trying to suck each other up.

The excitement that was stirring in my lower region, watching Ethan's hands sliding into the crack of her ass and dipping into her drenched pussy, mixed violently with the pain that spread through my chest watching the way they were kissing.

I had been standing, and I felt my knees actually weaken. I sank to the floor and leaned against the edge of the table, staring into the screen, my

face close to it so that I could absorb every pixel of Natalie's body, slick and writhing in Ethan's hands.

Ethan leaned back, keeping his hands on Natalie's ass until he was reclined, and she tugged at the boxers that confined his cock. She had to rise up on her knees to do it, and so I had a good view when Ethan's dick sprang loose, pointing straight up at Natalie's exposed pussy. Just inches from being inside of her.

Ethan moved his hands and grasped her thighs, his fingers pressing into the muscle at the back and his thumbs, it seemed, pulling her lips apart so that the flower of her cunt burst open. He had a firm grip on her like that and moved her easily, like a doll, until she was positioned right over the tip of his cock. He pushed her gently back and forth, a manhandling variation of rubbing the crown of his cock over her clit. Natalie's torso squirmed but her lower body was confined by his grip to doing what he wanted her to do. He moved her body to point his swollen head where he wanted to, and Natalie's chest heaved and her head lolled in ecstasy. I was able to clearly see the moment when her body stiffened with her climax, and she dug her fingernails into the meaty flesh of Ethan's arms.

I stared at Ethan's cock, because I knew what would happen next. He plunged inside of Natalie, and all the many inches of his fat prick disappeared into the dripping flesh of her pussy. He pulled her all the way to his legs, and her ass pressed on his balls until they bulged. Natalie's body began to bounce on Ethan's legs, the thick column of his shaft appearing and disappearing inside of my wife.

I leaned on the table in my despaired arousal, holding myself up while I unbuckled my pants. Natalie bounced and bounced on Ethan's cock. But just as soon as I was rising to my furious climax, sure that the moment was nearly over, Ethan pushed Natalie all the way off his dick, and she climbed off and onto the floor.

I stared as she fell to her knees and Ethan cradled her head in his hands, gripping her hair to control her head. I couldn't see her lips around his cock, but it was clear that she was taking him deep into her throat. As he had with her hips, he clutched her head and pushed it up and down on his prick, using her body as he pleased to pleasure himself.

Natalie reached her hand up and took him by the base of his shaft, then turned her head slightly and ran her tongue from his balls to the crown of his dick, then back down again. She turned her head even more, coming

around his shaft so that she could flutter her eyes at the camera as her open mouth and wet, dripping tongue slid from bottom to top on Ethan's cock.

Her gaze, very brief, was still so intense that it burned through me. She knew where the camera was, so there was no mistake that she had intended for me to see her stare.

Ethan had other plans for her, though; he grabbed her hair and pushed her head back onto his cock. His hips thrust upward as he pressed her down to the base of his dick, and he shook her head a little from side to side as he held her there with her mouth and throat full of his cock. A ripple went through his body and his jaw dropped open: his cum was surging from his cock and into Natalie's throat. There was no doubt that she was swallowing it all. There was nothing else she could do.

I jerked on my own shaft and came soon after, yelling as I did. I looked down at my hand and the mess I'd made, and then back up at the screen.

Natalie was licking Ethan's shaft clean, lapping at his cock in a way that reminded me of cat lapping up milk. She lapped every last, slimy rivulet of his cum as he watched her, shaking a little at the sensation of her tongue.

He leaned back, pulling her by the hand still immersed in her hair, so that she rested with her head on his chest. She curled up her legs, draping them over Ethan's.

It was a brilliant move. Her just-fucked cunt, glistening with her juices, was visible between the slender columns of her legs, folded up over Ethan's. His dick was still semi-hard, flopping onto his thigh.

I fell back on my heels, unable to tear my eyes from the screen.

Natalie dropped her hand to Ethan's thigh, grazing his balls. His body jerked, and lifted: I realized he was laughing. He caught Natalie's hand with his and brought it to his lips.

It was a bad angle, but I saw Natalie nuzzle up to his ear. It looked like she was whispering something to him. I saw his cock twitch – not hard yet, but something she had said to him was definitely inspiring him.

His body shifted, and his hand appeared, pressed down Natalie's back and slid into her cunt from her ass, forward. Ethan used his middle finger to stroke her slit, right in the center, in slow caresses at first, that made Natalie's body quiver. He picked up the pace as her body shook more and

she tossed her head to the side. Then even more rapidly, until at last I saw her pussy overflow with juices and her whole body jerk in a second orgasm.

During this time, Ethan's cock had – almost incredibly – risen to the occasion once more.

He tossed Natalie's legs to the side, and she flopped like a doll onto her back. He pushed her legs open and drove his hand between her legs to rub her cunt some more. Her legs jerked violently and she rose up from the bed. He pushed her back down and squeezed her flailing body between his legs as he rubbed her sore pussy some more, driving her wild. But she was unable to move.

I would have given anything for audio.

Ethan then sank to the floor, but as he did he turned Natalie's body with him, flipping her over onto her stomach. I couldn't see for a moment what was happening, but then Natalie's ass rose so that she was bent over onto the bed with her ankles at the edge and her ass in the air.

Ethan adjusted her lower back until her ass was right at the level of his mouth, and then he moved in.

I couldn't see what he was doing, just as I hadn't seen the details of Natalie's blowjob. But I could imagine. Whatever he was doing, Natalie's ankles were twisting in circles; she could barely stand it. Maybe because he was sliding his tongue over the bundled nerves of her clit, or maybe because he had gone further up, making a circle around the pucker of her ass, letting her know where he was headed next.

Whatever it was, it proved too much for Natalie to take lying down, and she rose onto her hands and knees and threw her head back. Ethan rose to his full kneeling height, and brought a hand between her legs to finger-fuck her.

It was only obvious that his fingers were plunging in and out of her, not where, until he stood up, leaving his hand where it was.

He was plunging his fingers in and out of my wife. He lifted his hand a little, and Natalie's ass went with it, almost as though he was raising her by lifting her ass up. Then he pushed his hand forward and walked Natalie forward onto the bed so that he could kneel behind her.

By now my own cock was hard again. The lewd image of Natalie being walked forward with Ethan's hand up her ass was burning through my mind, even though now I could only see Ethan's bare ass between her legs.

My chest burned. Was he going to fuck her in the ass? I wanted to see the details, and all I would see were her twisting feet and Ethan's ass rocking back and forth.

But Natalie had another plan, and that's when I felt another wave of total pleasure roll through me: she was doing this for me, putting on a show for me. She proved it by turning back to Ethan and saying something – who knows what? - that convinced him to move with her so that she was sideways on the bed. Sideways, so I would have a nice view of Ethan's cock disappearing into her ass.

She lowered herself back onto her chest and slid her hands along her front, until they were between her legs. She splayed her ass open with her hands, and used her fingers to push her juices up to her hole. I watched her fingers as they made playful circles around her anus.

Then she plunged her pointer finger in.

And then another.

Ethan was watching, holding his cock and slowly stroking it. I imagined his view: Natalie's long legs folded, her round bottom spread open, her long fingers pumping her own ass.

Finally, he pushed her hands away, and she dropped them to the bedclothes between her legs and gripped the sheets. Ethan walked his knees onto her hands and pressed them down with his weight, immobilizing her in the most submissive, filthy position I could imagine.

And then, he guided his cock to the opening of her ass.

Natalie's face was turned to face the camera, and her eyes were on it, locked on mine through the magic of the internet. As Ethan's cock penetrated her hole, she squeezed her eyes shut and opened her mouth, letting out what I hope was a silent scream, as the first few inches of Ethan's cock sank into her ass.

She twisted against him, but it was no use. She was pinned down. Ethan went slowly, and Natalie tossed her face the other direction and then back as more and more of his dick spread her open, filling her up. All the way in, until Ethan ground his balls and his pubic bone against her ass. He was completely inside of my wife.

Natalie's eyes were on the camera again, but they seemed a little duller, more confused, maybe even somewhat vacant. I wondered if it was because she was in a lot of pain: Ethan's cock was much bigger than mine. He held her like this for a while, her ass full of his cock and her hands

pressed beneath her on the bed. I supposed he was letting her relax, feeling her ass unclench around him, feeling her muscles sink into the bed. Waiting until she gave up on all resistance and he could pump her full of cum.

When Natalie finally relented – even I could see the resignation in her as her body slumped a little – he began to fuck her.

There was no slow buildup here, as with the night before. Ethan pulled his cock out and then slammed it into her, hard, all the way to the base, before doing it again and again in rapid, violent progression. Natalie's body was scooting along the bed, propelled by blow after blow from his dick. He grabbed her hips and held on to her as he rammed himself deep, until Natalie, it would seem, had started screaming. What kind of scream it was I didn't know, nor did I care; all I cared about was seeing Ethan's cock pump in and out of my wife as hard as he could.

Natalie reached her hand up between her legs, and though I couldn't see it clearly I knew she was sliding her long fingers along the swollen lump of her clit. I also knew that her fingertips were grazing Ethan's fat balls as they crashed into her with each thrust. The memory of the feel of Natalie's fingers as they scraped my sack, while her ass squeezed hard around my dick – and the knowledge that Ethan was feeling exactly what I had felt – burned inside of me.

Finally, Ethan's body went stiff and his mouth opened, his jaw muscles twitching as his cum burst from inside of him, deep into Natalie. He leaned forward, much like I had the night I had fucked her, and grabbed her waist to steady himself as his body convulsed with the violence of his orgasm.

He stayed like that for a long time, and that's when I realized that Natalie was still bringing herself to orgasm. Her eyes squeezed shut as she came, and Ethan gave a few more thrusts into her body. I finally let myself cum

Then he rose up to his knees and let his cock flop out of my wife's ass. He put a hand to her cheek, and I could see that he was playing with the distended gape of her anus with his thumb, perhaps watching his cum ooze from inside of her. His look was possessive, like that of any animal who'd just marked his territory.

At last, he fell to the side.

Natalie pushed up and stretched out, catlike, before lying down on the bed on her stomach. She turned to face Ethan, away from the camera, and

rested her arm over her chest. She lifted a leg and ran it along his shin before letting her leg come to rest on his.

Her hands were moving over his chest. The grainy resolution of the Nanny-cam left much to my imagination – which was vivid and rampant, but still, it was a disappointment over the real thing – as I stared at the shape of her body, the dip of her waist and the rise of her hips, the length of her thigh stretching over Ethan, and between her legs the places where Ethan had been, and left her wet and sticky with their mingled cum.

What were they talking about now, I wondered? I could see the faintest movement on Natalie's jawline, as her mouth opened and closed. Was she whispering into Ethan's ear? Was she feeding him some kind of romantic nonsense, or was she talking pure filth?

It was impossible to tell what Ethan was doing, or how he was reacting. His breath, still wild and panting when he had rolled over onto his back, was slowing, and his cock was still half-hard and flopped off to the side, pointed at Natalie.

I jerked myself off again to this image, and then I stood shakily and moved back to the edge of the bed, where I sat, unsteadily. I couldn't tear my eyes away from the scene in front of me, nor could I redirect my thoughts. I stared, letting myself dissolve into paranoia as Natalie's hand continued to make delicate swirls over Ethan's chest.

A lot of time passed – how much? I could never say – and my feet fell asleep because of the awkward way I was crouching on the edge of the bed, before I realized that the two of them had dozed off. Ethan's chest moved with a reptilian slowness, and Natalie's hand had stopped making circles. Her own breathing was sleepy and slow.

I blinked, and the burn in my eyes made me think I had been staring without even blinking my eyes.

There was something that burned me, as ridiculous as it may sound, about Natalie falling asleep with Ethan like that. In my guest bedroom, in the late morning, with my so-called friend. I knew I had no right to be angry about it, and that it made next to no sense to be angry about her falling asleep like that, when I had asked her to what she had done, and when I wasn't troubled by the fact that she had let Ethan pump her ass full of cum.

I stood up and headed to the shower. I took one in a hurry, not even waiting for hot water to jump in. I almost slipped and fell in my hurry to step out and get back to the computer.

And of course, as my luck would have it, they were gone.

CHAPTER 8: THE PHONE CALL

I stared at the screen, almost unable to believe what I was seeing. Then I started to scramble. I scrambled to unpack, to find my phone, which I had tossed away in my hurry, without thinking where I was leaving it, to “settle in.” I was doing all of this without any real purpose, zipping and unzipping things, setting my clothes on the dresser and then opening drawers and putting them away, deciding that was stupid and taking them out again. The whole time my mind was overflowing with images of my wife being a filthy whore for me, and a filthy whore for Ethan.

That, and creating imaginary, betrayal-laden words to have come out of her mouth as she lay there stroking his chest with her soft fingers.

I decided I was hungry. The hotel, as expected, did not have room service, but they helpfully provided a list of delivery places. After scanning the list several times in my state of distraction and still not understanding what I was looking at, I discarded it and decided I wasn’t actually hungry.

I looked back at the screen. Nothing.

Where had they gone? What were they doing right now together? I wondered if they had taken a shower together, if Natalie had let Ethan soap her up and rub his hands all over her wet and slippery body (something that surely would have ended in them fucking in the shower or on the bathroom floor.

I picked up my phone and tried to compose a text that would not give anything away if Ethan were to read it.

Or maybe I *wanted* to give the whole game away. Maybe I couldn’t stand another minute of Ethan believing that he was fucking my wife and that I was some kind of fool.

They had just *gone right to it* the moment she had gotten home, too. No guilt, no seduction. Just.. what? Natalie had just shown up in his room and stripped off her clothes, obviously. It was obvious she couldn’t wait to get back to Ethan, by the hurried way she’d blown me off, gone for a run, dropped me off her like a sack of potatoes.

No. Don’t be stupid.

My heart lifted for a moment remembering all the ways Natalie had chosen me over Ethan, kept me in the loop, planned this whole thing... she

had never lied to me, after all.

Then it sank. Maybe Ethan *did* know, and this was some kind of double, triple-agent game on Natalie's part. It wasn't impossible.

The possibilities were endless, and the longer I sat there, staring at the empty room, the crazier I went and the more ludicrous the things I imagined became.

I don't know how long I sat there, staring (I had moved myself and the laptop onto the bed. This had the added advantage of me being able to look up and see myself in the mirror, looking a bit deranged with the laptop glowing onto my face and my eyes beady with hunger and paranoia.)

I had the phone in my hand, and its rumble came to me through a haze. I looked at it as though it were an artifact from space for a moment, before I recognized what I was staring at.

[Natalie]: *call me whn we com iinto the rm an ill tlk t u during*

What?

I stared at the phone. One thing, unrelated: I wondered when and how Natalie had become such a text-savvy junkie.

The other: what the *fuck* did that message say?

I had some time to ponder it, and when I did finally figure it out (a few moments after the event I'm about to describe), of course it was obvious and I knew that. But at the time I found it perplexing.

Then Ethan came back into the room. He opened the closet and began to look through it.

A few moments passed, and then Natalie appeared in the doorway. She stretched an arm up and leaned against the frame. Her mouth was moving, her eyes and face seductive. She placed her other hand on her hip. Ethan froze, a shirt on a hanger in his hand.

Natalie moved toward him, and he turned his body to face her as she kept talking. She reached toward him and placed her hands on his body, under his t-shirt, her mouth moving all the while and evidently spinning Ethan into a trace. He dropped the shirt and pushed Natalie on to the bed.

I was so transfixed by the scene as it unfolded that I forgot all about Natalie's text. I forgot while Ethan fell to his knees, and I forgot while I watched him pull her underwear down and push her legs open.

Ethan's mouth closed around Natalie's mound and he looked up at her, and Natalie tipped her head back on the bed and looked into the Nanny-cam.

Her mouth opened and closed.

Call me.

I stared at the screen. She mouthed the words again, clear as day, and to me, not Ethan.

The cryptic text message made sense suddenly, and I fumbled to get to messages on my phone. Then I realized I needed to call, and I felt like my fingers were moving through molasses as I pressed on Natalie's icon and held the phone to my ear.

She *wouldn't*.

I hoped she would.

Natalie sat up pressing herself up on her elbows, and Ethan froze as well. Her hand reached into her shirt, and fished her phone out from her bra.

I wondered what lie she would tell Ethan about this: that she didn't want me to suspect anything, so she had made sure to keep her phone on her at all times? Or perhaps Ethan was in on the plan?

Whatever it was, Ethan looked at her as she pressed on the screen.

"Hey honey," her voice said through the phone.

I closed my eyes, and imagined myself as a cuckold, actually checking into a hotel in Charleston and calling my wife. Her voice sounded so convincingly normal as she spoke.

"Oh great," she said, and I realized I hadn't said anything.

I opened my eyes. Ethan was giving her a simmering look, and she was lying back slowly on the bed. He was going to go ahead and eat my wife out while she talked to me on the phone.

"How was your flight?"

"How is Ethan's tongue on your clit?" I breathed.

"Oh fine, yeah.." Natalie's voice cut off in a breathless gasp, and she almost didn't even try to pretend she was hiding it. "He's... uh... I don't know exactly where he is... right now."

Her hand flew down to grasp Ethan's hair. She dug her fingers into it. He must be enjoying himself so much right now, I thought. Sliding his tongue over Natalie's buttery folds, pressing down on her little knob and making her body jolt,

I wondered how much he was enjoying himself, enjoying the thrill of listening to Natalie talk to me while he tried to work her up – not too much, just a little – as she lied to her husband.

“I really enjoyed the show you put on for me,” I said.

Natalie tipped her head again, not enough to make eye contact with the camera, but enough to smile so that I could see it. “Oh yeah?” she said, and her voice was distant, disinterested.

“Have you done anything else in the meantime?”

Natalie was rocking her hips now, and Ethan was deep into her pussy. I wondered if his tongue was inside of her cunt, or if he was sliding the blade of it over her clit, making her rise to a climax as quickly as he could, hoping she would have to bite into her hand to stop herself from screaming. “I just... did some yoga... took a nap...”

A whole number of things occurred to me to say. I wanted to ask her if her ass was sore, if Ethan had fucked her again, if he was any good down there with his tongue. But the words caught in my mouth because of the image of her hand in his hair. The low pants of her breath.

“Oh,” she said, “I’m just... walking to the mailbox.”

It took me a moment to realize that she was taunting me, or taunting Ethan, or taunting us both.

“Do me a favor, Natalie,” I said, in a low voice, to make sure than I wouldn’t be heard. “Keep me on the phone until you come.”

There was a pause, while she panted. “I... yeah... I think so. I think I can do that. I’m almost there.”

I breathed into the phone. The cool ease with which she was handling this fake conversation was terrifying.

And sexy.

My cock was out of my boxers already, in my hand, and I stared at the bead of precum that was welling from the tip. I stopped myself from touching it, because who knows what Ethan would have in mind after this...

“So no problems with your flight?” her voice said, almost as normal as pie.

“No, no problems. Are you almost there? Do you like knowing that I’m watching Ethan eat your pussy out?”

A pause.

“It’s... yeah, I’m just... looking in here...”

She lifted her body, and made a strange sound into the phone at the same time. By the way her arms and her torso were trembling with tension I knew she was very close. “Do you want me to... um, open it and see what it...”

Her voice trailed off.

“Oh, *fuck!*” she yelled into the phone.

Her body shook on the screen.

“Something wrong, Natalie?” I murmured. My cock twitched violently in the air.

She panted into the phone.

For a moment I thought she would be unable to recuperate.

Ethan sat back, his mouth wet, and wiped his smirk with his fingers. He sucked his fingertips, grinning.

The air was dead for a second.

“Natalie?” I prompted.

“Oh god,” she said. “I just... I stubbed my toe. Really, really hard...”

Ethan smiled, the smug shit. He started to climb up toward her. She shook her head and held a hand up to him. He paused, holding himself up over her body with one arm and tracing his fingers up and down her body with a devilish look on his face.

What an asshole.

My blood was boiling.

“Oh, baby,” I cooed. “I’m so sorry. Really bad?”

“It... really hurts...” Natalie said. “Can I...? I’ll just call you back okay?”

“Please do,” I said dryly.

Natalie dropped the phone next to herself on the bed, and I let mine start to drop from my hand, when it occurred to me...

I held it to my ear.

Ethan’s low laugh.

“That was a terrible idea,” Natalie’s voice.

Ethan, on the screen, slid his hand between her legs.

“You didn’t seem to mind,” his low voice rumbled indistinctly in the phone.

Their mouths met, and Ethan’s body covered hers. The microphone of Natalie’s cell picked up the rustling against the sheets as he sank on top of her body. I heard Natalie gasp.

“Mmm,” Ethan’s voice purred, close to the phone. “You sore?”

But he rose up so that he could look down at her as he entered her body – and I knew that he was by the low moan that Natalie let out. He wasn’t waiting to find out if she was sore; he just began to fuck her. Slowly at first; his hips rose and fell sweetly in and out of Natalie’s spread legs. Natalie began to pant, and then she moaned as he picked up the speed.

Ethan took her hands and pushed them onto the bed on either side of her. He started to drive himself into her, and Natalie began to moan in a high-pitched wail. He thrust harder, and her moans broke into a staccato rhythm, synchronized with his thrusting. “Ohhhhh-oh-oh-oh-uh-ah”

“Spread your legs for me, you dirty little girl,” Ethan growled.

I watched Natalie spread her legs wide and imagined how her cunt stretched and opened for Ethan’s dick. Her feet bounced as he hammered himself into her harder. “You ready?” he growled.

But I could see by his face that he was already spilling his cum into her pussy.

Natalie’s voice panted to a crescendo of moans and wails, none of which seemed fake at all, and I listened to the disturbing erotic sound in my ears long after she flung her hand back and the phone turned off.

I stared in horror as they slid onto the floor, much like Natalie and I had done back in that hotel in Chicago, that first night she had met Ethan – so long ago - laughing and kissing each other.

I closed the laptop and wallowed in my pain and ecstasy.

The day dragged on.

It was only about two o’clock by the time Ethan and Natalie had fucked each other twice. They were so unable to keep their hands off each other.

I corrected myself: Ethan was unable to keep his hands off Natalie.

Natalie was just doing this for me.

Wasn’t she?

It was silly to let doubt creep into my mind. After all, she had arranged things so that I could have this weekend of watching her. She had moved the Nanny-cam into Ethan’s room. She had a plan and she was following it. She was being faithful.

But...

I couldn't help but let myself get caught up in intrigue in my own mind. Maybe her plan was different than it appeared. Or maybe Ethan would charm her, or be so good in bed that she would accidentally fall for him.

When I had a thought like that, the pain that washed through me was almost unbearable.

What if I had my wife taken away, swept up off her feet by Ethan? I'd have no one to blame but myself.

I re-opened the laptop and arranged my phone on the bed so I would see it if Natalie messaged me.

What was the plan from here? I don't think we'd even clarified it.

I decided, after about an hour of staring into space, that I really was hungry. I ordered food using the landline. I didn't have any cash, I realized after hanging up. I turned in circles for a minute, panicking, and then I ran to the hotel lobby, where thankfully, there was an ATM. I ran into the pizza guy, but he insisted on following up to my room before giving me the pizza.

This ordinarily would have been great fodder for me to crack some jokes or something, but I didn't.

I checked the phone again. Nothing.

I ate the pizza and stared at the TV for a long time, trying to take my mind off what Natalie and Ethan were doing. What did you do with another man's wife after you fucked her twice and you only had a weekend with her left?

Of course, Ethan didn't know that. She probably hadn't revealed that to him yet.

Maybe they were just laughing together in the kitchen, making dinner, his arms around her and his lips on her neck.

Maybe they had ordered a pizza. Maybe they were curled up on the couch and watching a movie.

Or maybe they were fucking on the kitchen floor and I was missing it.

After a few hours of this, I realized I was staring at an Evangelical Christian program. I flipped the channel and stared at the new program, but just as little of the new show made its way through the deep mud of my thoughts.

I looked at my phone again.

Maybe it was broken? Maybe there was no reception here.

Should I send a text? Should I try to call her?

There was something... not demeaning, but just... not what I wanted to do... about the idea of calling her. Something about being too needy, too un-trusting. I felt like it would make the whole house of cards crumble.

This was the special torture I had designed for myself. And the truth was, *I* had designed it this way. I would be an idiot to say I didn't see this pain coming. I would be a liar to say that I wasn't enjoying it.

Another hour ticked by.

I had been thinking about drinks on and off the whole time. I didn't even know where the closest liquor store was. For a moment the whole ludicrous lie I had told myself was made real in my imagination and I thought to myself that it was too bad I wasn't back in Greenville, where I knew there were a lot of dial-a-bottle companies.

I laughed out loud when it finally occurred to me that I was not actually in Charleston.

I did a very unprofessional thing and accessed my emails to get the number of a dial-a-bottle, from a client's emails about a small claims suit I had handled years before.

They answered when I dialed, and I ordered myself a bottle of Jack Daniels.

Which... I will never do again.

I went down to the lobby to take out more cash.

Still nothing, when I returned to the room.

I paced until the whiskey arrived, and it seemed like an eternity before it got there but who knew? I eyed the clock. It was nearing eight. The Nanny-cam was still in Ethan's room but now it was dark. Only a solitary gray-green line told me where the hallway was, beyond the door that was mostly closed. Unless...

I squinted into the darkness of the screen. Had they come in, while I was out, and were they in there now, where I couldn't see them?

I slammed a few drinks and felt much better. I slammed a few more and felt brave.

I texted Natalie.

[Me]: *long time no see*

"What an idiot!" I said out loud, as soon as I had sent the message. I dropped the phone on the bed and took a swig of whiskey.

But there was no reply from Natalie.

I let more time pass. I toyed with the idea of texting her again.

I imagined everything that anyone could possibly imagine their wife doing with another man, and then some things that are too freakish to recount here. I downed more booze. I typed and deleted more texts. I stared into the computer.

And finally, I called.

Nothing.

I waited another hour. By then I was good and trashed.

When Natalie picked up the phone, her voice was a hushed whisper.

“Hey,” she said.

My own vice caught in my throat. “What... where have you been?!” I demanded.

Natalie whispered. “I can’t talk now. I’ll tell you all about it, okay?”

“Did you fuck him again?”

I was needy, hungry, desperate, and I didn’t care what I sounded like.

There was a pause.

Was she deciding whether or not to tell me the truth?

“Yes,” she hissed. “I’ll tell you all about it. I have to go. I love you.”

“I love you, Natalie.”

But I knew that the phone had already gone dead by the time the words left my lips.

There were a lot of other things I had wanted to ask Natalie, like why they weren’t in Ethan’s room, and where were they, and was she going to fuck him again tonight, or maybe all night, and was she going to do it where I could see or it or could I fall asleep and not worry about it?

Somewhere in all of this thinking, and because fully half of the whiskey was gone when I woke up, I fell asleep.

I had terrible dreams, dreams that Natalie was leaving me. She was walking out to the car with only her panties on, heaving a carpet bag into Ethan’s car.

I had amazing dreams. Dreams that Natalie was sucking my cock while Ethan fucked her, or that I was fucking her while Ethan rubbed his cock over her lips and she smiled at me.

I woke up once, when I spilled a glass of whiskey on my lap.

I closed my laptop and rolled over, horribly drunk.

It wasn't until late the next morning, when I rubbed my bleary eyes and opened my laptop with my heart pounding that I realized:

Most of the drink must have gone on the laptop. I tapped at the mouse, infuriated. I yelled. I looked at my phone compulsively.

There were a few choices here, but none of the options set very well with me.

I didn't want to appear desperate, and send another text to Natalie. She might have been fucking Ethan right then, in his room, the Nanny-cam on her ass, and I was missing it.

I also didn't want to look like an incompetent fool.

I didn't want to tell her what had happened, because I didn't really want her to stop (though the idea of having a test like this was appealing: would Natalie stop fucking Ethan if I told her I wasn't watching her, that I couldn't watch her?)

And there was also this other thing, this ember of jealousy that was under my skin. There was the way that they kissed, the way that they laughed together. I didn't like it. I didn't like it at all.

My thumb hovered over the phone.

I went downstairs for the free breakfast, but I ended up only taking one bite out of a bagel and chewing it to mush while I contemplated my predicament.

Then, I went upstairs and grabbed the phone, stuffed my wallet and keys in my pockets, and I left.

CHAPTER 9: MY PLAN

I had the taxi drop me off by the grocery store a few blocks away from our house. I had no idea what I thought I was doing – whether I was going to storm the castle, and “catch” them in the act, or sneak into my own house to watch them, or just lurk and let Natalie know I was there so I could come clean to her about my laptop. A sort of haze descended on me in the cab, and I didn't have a single coherent thought the whole way across town. Just a montage of images, some I had actually seen and others I had imagined as I lay waiting for Natalie to contact me the night before. I was a mess by the time the cab driver propped an arm on the back of the seat and looked at me. “Buddy,” he said, awakening me from my stupor. “This it?”

It was a sweltering day and now almost noon. I got out of the cab and sweat began to pour down my back immediately. I stood in the extra-bright sunlight, still in a daze, and sweat for a minute until it occurred to me, with a jolt, that someone might see me there, looking a little like a madman. I was horribly thirsty. It vaguely occurred to me that I had a hangover.

I bought a refrigerated Gatorade from the supermarket, sort of slinking through the aisles like a guy avoiding shrapnel, hoping not to run into someone I knew. Or worse yet, horror of horrors, turn the corner and run into Ethan and Natalie, shopping for dinner ingredients. I knew what I must look like, and I couldn't imagine what I would say to someone who had no business in my fantasy (say, Ms. Kruger down the street) appeared and asked me how I was.

But that didn't happen, and I downed the Gatorade on the side of the building in a patch of shade that was doing very little to cut the heat. Then I headed toward my house, my mind on fire with all of the things I might see.

And what was I going to do when I got there? My heart sped up again, increasing with every step I took toward the house. As I neared our block I had a choice: cut into the system of alleys (built by the division to keep the garages off the streets) and go through the back door, or go around the front. There weren't as many windows in the back of the house, but the two of them would see me coming if they were in the kitchen. The front of the house had more windows – in fact Ethan's guest bedroom looked out

onto the street - but the blinds (I sincerely hoped) would be closed if they were in that room.

I hesitated, looking from the alley to the street corner, totally unable to make a decision. I was breathing quickly now, and it wasn't from the heat. Neither was the sweat pouring down the sides of my face or my ludicrous heart rate. All of these symptoms were burning from the inside out.

Natalie would not have done all of this, and then just betrayed me at the end by doing something... what? What could she even do, what was I so worried about her having done, that I would be driven here to do whatever it was *I* was doing?

There had to be some explanation for her silence that wasn't the betrayal I so feared. And I didn't even know what that betrayal would look like, except that she was maybe writhing on the kitchen floor with Ethan's cock inside of her, having not even tried to get to the Nanny-cam.

And really... how was that any more or less a betrayal than everything that had happened so far?

I started down the alley.

No, the thing I feared most was something else. A different kind of betrayal, one that wasn't physical. One in which the person being played here was not Ethan, but me. One in which Natalie had kissed Ethan with his cock slowly pulsing away to semi-hard inside of her cum-filled pussy, and said: "Well, that ought to keep him satisfied, now let's get on with our weekend."

I wiped a stinging river of sweat from its path into my eyes. The gravel of the alley pavement crunched beneath my feet. I felt like the sound was so loud they would hear me coming, but that was as silly as anything else I was allowing myself to think.

Surely they wouldn't be in the backyard?

My heart rose up with buoyed hope (tinged with disappointment): maybe Natalie hadn't written back or called because they were deep in the conversation. The one in which Natalie told Ethan he had to leave, that things wouldn't work out.

Or maybe, I thought, my heart plunging, the conversation had started that way, and Ethan with his boyish charms had nuzzled her neck and begged her not to cut him loose. Maybe he had promised to move out and then told her they could keep seeing each other somehow...

I was at my garage and the gate to my backyard. I leaned toward the gaps in the fence and perked up my ears. The only sound anywhere in the neighborhood was the low hum of air conditioners. Everyone was inside, avoiding the sweltering heat.

My heartbeat dropped to a strange, slow thump as I opened the gate and stepped into my own backyard, feeling like a burglar yet again. The sense that I was out of place, that I was being pushed out of my own house, was heightened by the fact that I had never entered my house from this direction until Ethan had arrived and made me sneak around like a burglar.

I crept across the yard, my eyes on the dark windows of the kitchen and our own bedroom. I had to restrain myself from staring at the blinds that covered the bedroom window, expecting at any moment to see a hand press through the fabric covering, the blinds rising and falling rhythmically with the thrusts of Ethan's cock. It was a preposterous image, but I imagined it until I was watching the window in expectation of actually seeing it.

I tripped on the porch steps, and it knocked me out of my reverie. I crossed the porch, bumping into the patio furniture and scraping a chair loudly on the dry wood. No matter. I was locked on the house now, going in, no matter what was in there. I was going to open the door to my house and go inside. I had a right to do that; it was my own fucking house.

And if they were there in the kitchen? If Natalie was bent over the counter?

Or maybe they had spotted me crossing the yard and scrambled to get dressed and plop onto a couch and a chair with magazines, looking innocent. Maybe I would walk in and they would look up and say, "Oh hey, Erik," as though nothing had transpired. As though Ethan had not just buried his cock in my wife's pussy and ass over and over again, as though his cum was not dripping from inside of her and into her black bikini or her new lingerie or whatever it was she was (or wasn't) wearing.

I tugged on the sliding door.

The door broke the air-conditioned seal of the house with a loud crack. The cold air hit me in the face, and I listened.

Nothing.

I stepped inside, my stomach churning in turmoil. I strained to hear into the bedrooms, the loft, the living room. The house was dark and still as a tomb.

I left the door open and crept into the kitchen. I thought I heard Natalie's voice, a low moan, a little gasp, but with every step I took the silence only deepened and I realized these were just auditory illusions. Tricks played by my desperate mind.

I wanted to find them in the guest room, as much as I did not. Part of my emotions slowed to a state of relief as I delved further into the house and heard nothing: I would not have to confront them.

The other part screamed in desperation: I wouldn't *get to* confront them.

Or see them.

When it was clear that no one was home, a new panic set in: where were they?

I stormed into the master bedroom, looking for evidence that Natalie had perhaps packed hastily and run off with Ethan. But I saw nothing more damning than a wet towel crumpled on the bed.

I hung it up.

I ran my hands over the bed covering and leaned down to sniff it. There was no evidence, and I was thankful and slightly disappointed, that Ethan and Natalie had *not* come in here to do the many naughty things they had done.

I moved stealthily to the guest bedroom. Now my ears were perked for the sound of them returning.

In Ethan's room, the bed covers were strewn about. They had the used and sodden look of sheets that had been soaked through with sweat and other fluids. And they had. I pressed my hand to them and recoiled when I felt that it was slightly damp, like it had been abandoned not long ago by the people who had sweat into it as they fucked.

But that wasn't possible.

Was it?

I had seen with my own eyes, that no one was home, no one had left the house for the past fifteen minutes...

I pressed my hand to the sheet again.

It was dry. It was cold, and that had created the illusion of dampness.

I leaned down and smelled the sheets. *This* was not my imagination: I could smell Natalie's scent, so distinctive, so sweet with a single astringent note that floated above the flavor of honey.

The smell of her cut through my gut; standing there and seeing the rumpled sheets and actually smelling that they had been so used made the whole thing painfully *real*.

I let the pain absorb into me for a moment, sweet and awful. Then I turned abruptly and looked around.

So where were they?

I paced the house, not really caring if they came home, or one of them came home, or what would happen next. If that happened, it would be a sign, give me direction.

But it didn't.

And then, after pacing like a caged animal and smelling the sheets like a filthy one several more times than I'd like to admit... it dawned on me.

I went back out the still-open porch door, and turned left when I got into the alley. I closed nothing behind me.

I wasn't in a rage. It was as invigorating as being in a rage (or so I guess, I'm not really a rager).. but there was a layer of elation beneath it.

I headed to the pool.

I saw Natalie first. She was halfway in the pool, lying on the cement, her breasts spreading out side to side and pushing her bikini open, her chest glowing. Her lean torso was half out of the water, and her hair was dark and wet, spread on on the concrete behind her. She had sunglasses on and looked very glamorous. Her arms were stretched out on either side of her.

I scanned the area for Ethan.

No Ethan.

Wait.

Cutting under the water, the dark hair and the tanned muscles of Ethan's body shimmered up to the surface and stopped in front of Natalie.

He stood up and shook his head. Little drops of water sprayed across Natalie's breasts and she smiled. She dipped her hand into the water and flicked some at him. "Don't," she said.

With a grin.

The scene of familiarity between them, this kind of mild camaraderie, was far worse for me than any of the sexual things I had seen. Was she even going to cut him off at the end of this weekend? Was she ever going to tell him? Or was she just going to lie to me and *say* that she did?

And why did she have to be so buddy-buddy with him?

At the same time, I liked it a little. I crept around the gates of the pool – and I'll never know to this day if any of the neighbors saw me (they must have). As I rounded the brick building that housed the showers and the changing rooms, I expected to come around and see the two of them entangled in each other's arms. Ethan pressing himself up against Natalie, his hands invisible beneath the water but doing unspeakable things to my wife. Right there in public, where all the neighbors might not be able to see *exactly* what he was doing, but they would know. They would know by the way they were embracing, grazing their lips across each other's skin...

But when I rounded the building, Natalie had popped out of the pool and was drying her hair with a towel. Ethan was swimming again.

At least she had the decency not to act like a slut here, in front of all the neighbors.

I was close to her now. I could see her lean torso, her ass spread out on the concrete next to the pool. I had a nice view of her long legs as they kicked slowly back and forth in the water. Her skin was glistening with droplets of water.

My stomach turned and I felt myself craving to see something else. As relieved as I was that they weren't doing anything "untoward" here, where anyone could see them, I was also... disappointed.

And what was I going to do now? Follow them home? Pop into the pool area now?

Ethan's head rose from beneath the water and broke my train of thought. He moved like a shark in the water, positioning himself between Natalie's legs. He was about two feet away from her, but he was on target for the very center of her if he moved forward. He grinned.

"Not *now*," I heard Natalie say. Her voice was a low laugh, edged by a light, flirtatious whisper. She splashed water at his face.

He went in anyway, and Natalie looked around to see who was watching but didn't move away or close her legs to stop him. When she looked in my direction I dropped to the grass. Who knew if she saw me or not.

When I peered into the pool area again, Ethan's head was between her legs. Natalie dropped her hand on his head and pushed him away.

But the bottoms of her suit, between his bared teeth, went with him, until they snapped back against her skin. "Ethan!" she complained, but it

was a joking, coquettish complaint. And I could see from his face that it only egged him on.

He floated onto his back. His cock was hard – that was probably the whole purpose of floating like that, to display himself for her – and then he grinned. “Time to go home. I’m getting a little hungry.”

Natalie kicked up some water with her feet, but she hopped onto her feet and stood up. She stretched sinuously. Ethan stared at her, with that sort of self-satisfied, smug look a guy gets when he’s fucked an incredible woman and he’s about to get some more.

I tucked myself behind the brick wall as Natalie turned around to pick up her towel.

I heard Ethan getting out of the water. Peeking around the corner after waiting a few breaths, I saw that they were by the gate. Ethan was unlocking it and Natalie was behind him, with her hands around his torso.

I flared with rage.

She laughed and kissed his shoulder.

Then the gate swung open, and they headed out.

I crept behind the brick building again, going around the long way to where I could hide behind a bush and see when they were far enough down the street to follow them.

They didn’t hold hands, but they walked just a little too close together, the way a couple who wants to hide their coupledness (but are doing an abysmal job of it) do. Their fingers occasionally “accidentally” brushed against each other.

I felt like I had swallowed a lit match. I narrowed my eyes and came out from behind the bush. I followed them, not even trying to hide that I was there. I stared at the back of their heads and decided if they turned around we’d just have to take it from there. I had no plan, no plan except to see what came of my non-plan.

They didn’t turn around all the way home, and neither of them noticed me at the end of the alley when they opened the back gate and went into the yard.

I peered through the gaps in the slatted fence when I got to my yard.

Natalie was on the porch. She was untying her suit...

She peeled away the top, and then she peeled away the bottoms. Right there on the porch. She hung them over the back of a chair (as if they weren’t dry by now, in this heat).

I leaned from side to side, craning my eyes to see if I could spot Ethan.

Then my eyes went back to Natalie. What the hell? She was never so bold as to do something like that.

Ethan came back out through the sliding doors.

He had an iced tea in his hand. He let out a low whistle. “Why, Mrs. Ossington,” he said, and ran his eyes all over her body. The way he said it was lecherous enough to constitute a felony assault charge in most states, and my neck burned. I realized how ridiculous it was, of course, given everything they’d already done, but for some reason seeing them in the flesh, in color, right in front of me, was so much more realistic than the Nanny-cam or piecing things together through or door or behind my back, that it felt like I was watching it for the first time.

My wife – my reserved and conservative-dressing wife – went inside, saying that she needed to get her cover-up.

Ethan sat down on a patio chair and sipped his iced tea.

I glared at him from behind the fence. What a smug fucker. He shook his head a little.

Natalie reappeared and popped her head out of the kitchen through the sliding glass doors. The familiarity between the two of them, like this was not Natalie’s and my house, but theirs; like they were married instead of us, made my chest squeeze into a ball of fury.

Natalie was wearing a sheer swimsuit cover I had never seen before; a gauzy white material, and her tanned skin was visible through it. “Cover up” was barely accurate.

“You want something for lunch?” she said.

Ethan grinned into his glass of tea.

“Something *real*,” she said. She leaned on the patio doorframe and crossed a long leg over her resting foot.

Ethan grinned again. I could hear the clink of the ice in his glass as he finished off his iced tea.

Natalie smiled and disappeared into the house. She said something as she did, but I couldn’t hear it distinctly. Ethan rose up and followed her.

I waited, my anger rising like the incoming tide.

I unlatched the gate and stepped into my yard.

It was at that moment that I had the idea to look at my phone.

I stared at the screen.

Sure enough, Natalie had sent me a message. I'd somehow turned the sound off.

[Natalie]: *u awake now sleepyhead? turn on ur computer*

A warm sensation came over me, flooding out the cold jealousy that had me in its grip just seconds before. She was still thinking of me, still trying to give me a view into the weekend with Ethan.

Still... where had she been all evening, yesterday? All morning, today? Surely these two had done *something* in the hours between the last tryst I had seen and now.

I stared at the phone in my hand, and then at the house. And then the reality of my situation occurred to me: I didn't have a computer to turn on.

What was I going to do?

From the looks of things, Natalie wouldn't be checking her phone for messages any time soon. And even if she was, what would I text her? Hold on while I go buy a new computer?

And why would she even check her phone? That wasn't ever part of the deal. She had no way of knowing that something was wrong; I hadn't told her.

I realized I didn't really want her to know. For one thing I hardly felt like explaining to her what an ass I was that I got drunk and trashed my own computer.

But also: I sort of wanted this sneaky liberty. This freedom to decide what I was going to do.

I waited, my breath loud in the quiet yard. I waited five minutes, and they passed like an eternity. Then, moving with the confidence of a man who does not care if he gets caught (it was my house, after all; my wife, my marriage) and therefore with considerably more stealth than if I had been sneaking around, I walked into my home. Quiet as a fucking spy.

Still with no idea what I was actually going to do.

CHAPTER 10: UNPLANNED

There wasn't much noise in the house, but what there was led me directly to Ethan's room, fully confident that neither one of them would hear me as I approached. The heavy breathing, the occasional wet smack of lips and skin colliding together, the rustle of bedsheets – everything indicated that they were well on their way to fucking. Passionately. The last thing either one of them would be doing is keeping an ear out for an intruder. Or Natalie's husband, who Ethan was so sure was far away in Charleston, and Natalie herself believed was stowed away in Greenville.

Ethan's swim trunks were on the floor of the hallway. When I peered around the corner, the door was open, and I could see Ethan's bare skin – his muscular back, his sculpted ass – through the open door. I pulled my head back quickly, but not quickly enough to miss Natalie's hands moving over his body, sliding down his back, stroking him lightly as she descended... going down, no doubt, to her knees.

I listened for a moment, imagining the scene in the room. A wet slurp as Natalie's mouth pulled Ethan's cock inside of her, a sharp inhale from Ethan as her lips closed around the base of his cock. I thought I heard a strangled moan of pleasure, which must have been from Natalie, as she enjoyed having her throat stuffed with Ethan's veined meat.

Standing there, my cock getting harder and harder and my heart feeling like it was being wrung out, I had an epiphany. All of the feelings and suspicions I'd had about Natalie and Ethan rose up like a sort of scum on a soup, and I was able to clear them away and see what it was I really wanted. It wasn't like some profound thought came to me: that would happen later. This was more like... I don't know. Some kind of mystical garbage. It came to me as a resolution, and only later would I be able to put it into words.

Then, just like that, I was turning the corner of the hallway. My stomach settled, my blood ran almost cold. My heart gave a final flip, and then seemed to settle on a feeling of excitement.

More and more of Ethan's body became visible as I stepped, very slowly and cautiously, down the hall. Then I could see his cock, pointed straight in front of him, light in color and practically bursting, the veins

throbbing along its side. Natalie's hand worked with her mouth as she stroked and sucked him. As I walked, more and more of Natalie came into view. I walked slowly to savor the increasing clarity of the picture: now I could see her face, now her body, now the way she was on her knees submissively for my friend. With his cock deep in her throat.

Natalie's eyes were closed at first, and I heard through my ringing ears that she was enjoying – or at least making a theatrical show of enjoying – sucking on Ethan's cock. She made pleased noises as she bobbed up and down the length of his meat. And then, she lifted his eyes to meet his.

I froze just outside the door and stared for a moment at my wife's intense gaze up at another man as she pleasured him with her mouth. Ethan placed his hands on her head and pulled her deep onto him.

I was already resolved to do what I did next, so I just did it, as naturally as though I were stepping into a grocery store. I took a big, confident, presence-announcing step into the room.

Natalie saw me first. Her eyes went to the doorway when I moved, and for a moment she just looked at me, her mouth around Ethan's cock. The sight of me standing there was probably incomprehensible to her. Then her eyes went wide, and I saw a host of emotions playing out on her face. I saw that she tried to pull away from Ethan's dick, but he pressed her hard against his crotch and wouldn't let her go. Finally she pressed both of her hands on his thighs, and pushed herself away.

Ethan was coaxing her with some words, and then he said something that might have expressed concern, like "What's wrong?" or "You okay?" I'm not sure. I wasn't really listening. Blood was pounding in ears, and the whole scene was coming to me as though I were having an out-of-body experience.

Natalie's eyes were fixed on me, and she fell back to her heels and stared.

And then Ethan turned toward the door.

I'd love to know what was passing through his mind as he turned around. You'd have to believe a guy like Ethan had been caught more than once in exactly this sort of situation.

When he saw me, though, he froze. He raised both of his hands, almost like I had a gun pointed at him. "Shit," he said, in a quiet voice.

I also wonder what I looked like at that moment. The expression I had on my face felt like smugness. But who knows? I wasn't really thinking

anymore. I was just acting.

I didn't do anything. I noticed, though, with extreme satisfaction that I cannot deny, that Ethan's cock went limp as the seconds passed. Natalie stared at me, and the look on her face was more of confusion than anything else. After all, she wasn't really *caught*.

But she *was* pushed out of her throne of control. I could see she had no idea what to do.

"Erik," she finally whispered. "What are you doing here?"

Ethan, who seemed to have been frozen all that while, looked down at Natalie. Then he looked back at me. I could see that he was putting something together, getting a sense that the scene in front of him had more to it than just a husband catching his cheating wife. There wasn't enough astonishment on either of our faces, and he was reading that.

Like I said, you have to figure Ethan had a lot of experience with this sort of thing.

His hands started to slowly fall to his sides.

I still didn't really know what I was planning to do. But that was sort of it: I was just going to see what happened.

"Erik," Ethan said, "Look, man..."

I didn't look at Ethan. I was looking at Natalie. Waiting to see what Natalie would do with this particular hand of cards. I realized then that I didn't care so much how it panned out, I just wanted to see what Natalie would do. There was no better way to find out where her loyalties lay, or perhaps find out what a pathological liar she was, than to force this very situation.

I saw that Natalie was also holding her hands up, suspended as though I were a hostage taker and not a man in the doorway of his guest bedroom looking at his wife and his friend, caught in the act of fellatio. Natalie was calculating. She finally brought her hands to her mouth, and chewed on her thumbnail as she considered her options. Everyone was breathing pretty heavily.

Then she gave a micro-smile, just a short one, and I saw a little glint in her eye. Her gaze shifted to Ethan. "I'm sorry," she said. "I don't know why he's here... it... this wasn't really the plan."

"My computer broke," I declared, and they both looked at me sharply, Ethan with fear and Natalie with surprise. My voice was deadpan.

Ethan looked from me to Natalie. Finally he said, “*What?*” in disbelief.

Natalie smiled at him and shrugged, the tip of her thumb still in her mouth.

Ethan turned back to me. For a second or two things were pretty intense. I wasn’t sure what he was thinking, or where this was going to go. A short stab of fear went through me, but mostly I just felt curiosity.

Then Ethan shook his head. “Well, *damn*. I’ll be a fucking... *Never* woulda thought you were the type.”

He started this sentence looking at me and finished it looking at Natalie. Natalie looked up at me.

We all sat in an uneasy silence for a moment.

Then Natalie’s eyes glinted again, and she rose up from resting on her heels, her long torso and legs unfolding sinuously. She gave me a look, and wordlessly moved toward Ethan. He had taken a step back, so she had to walk on her knees toward him. He looked over at me, and registering that I wasn’t going to do anything but stand there and watch, he turned back to Natalie, who by now had his cock in her hand.

He had gone soft, though not entirely. Natalie could fit the whole of his dick in her hand easily. She wrapped her fingers around it and fluttered her eyes at him. I saw that he throbbed to life quickly. “Now where were we?” she purred. She held his cock and pointed the tip of it toward her tongue. I stared as my wife flicked her tongue at the crown of Ethan’s cock.

And then.

And then she looked over at me, as she swept over the bulb at the end with the flat of her tongue and her mouth whoreishly open and wet. Her blue eyes met mine, and in her hand Ethan’s cock bobbed violently with singly throb to its fat, full length.

She kept her eyes on me as she tipped her head to the underside of his shaft, and drew her tongue from the base of his dick to the hardened ridge of his glans. I heard Ethan suck in his breath.

I felt my own fingers unbuttoning my jeans, and from there I must have let them fall and stepped out of them, but my attention was all on Natalie as she kept her eyes locked on mine and made another slow sweep with her tongue down the length of his cock and then back up. She released her hand, because Ethan was now completely erect and his cock was pointing in front of him, twitching with the pleasure of my wife’s attention.

I pulled my shirt over my head, and when I looked back at the scene, Natalie had shifted her seductive stare to meet Ethan's eyes. She licked at the tip of his cock, making a complete circle around his crown, and then she opened her mouth and closed her lips around him.

Ethan's hand dropped and sank into her hair, which was still wet from the pool and stuck to her skin in places. He pulled her toward him, and her mouth moved down the length of his cock and all the way to the base. When her lips pressed against his balls and the matte of dark, curly hair above his cock, he pressed her to him, and I saw Natalie's body convulse as she gagged. But then she relaxed. She never broke her subservient stare at his eyes, even though a single drop of water slid from the corner of her left eye and sank into the skin of her cheek.

My own cock was rock-solid, and I felt a little uncertain of where to go from here, so I watched as Ethan moved Natalie's head back and forth and she sucked on his cock. Now that I could smell her scent and the scent of Ethan radiating from his body, and hear the slurping from her mouth as she took him into her throat, I was ringing with excitement.

"Get on the bed," I heard myself say, and Natalie's eyes moved to look at me. Even though her mouth was stuffed with cock, I could see that this electrified her, elicited a bit of a smile from her mouth, even though it was impossible to see with her mouth stretched open and stuffed full of cock like that. She let Ethan push and pull her a few more strokes, and then her body shifted and she pulled away. I heard Ethan groan a little as she released his cock, which fell from her mouth with a wet splat and bobbed in the air. She fell back to her heels and smiled, and then moved backwards and climbed, cat-like, on to the bed, where she took a moment to stretch out sinuously. We both stared at her, and then she looked at me, as though for instruction. I hadn't decided what I wanted her to do – hell, I hadn't even been in control of my mouth when it told her to get on the bed. I could only feel my pulsing cock at this point, and maybe the twist of my stomach.

She dropped to her hands, so that she was on her hands and knees, and seeing that I was just going to stand there, she looked back at Ethan and held up one hand. She crooked her finger to beckon him toward her. As he moved toward her, she backed up a little on the generously-sized bed, but kept beckoning him. As she did this, she stretched again, and her ass pointed upward at the ceiling behind her.

Transfixed, almost in a hypnotic state, I took her cue. I started to move around the foot of the bed as Ethan climbed on to the edge of the bed on his knees and directed his cock to her smiling mouth. As I rounded the edge of the bed, he went inside her mouth again, and I dared for the first time to look at Ethan's face. He was red with lust, his eyes locked on Natalie, watching his dick disappear again into her mouth.

I was on the other side of her by then. I looked at the back of her head as it bounced forward and backward, servicing Ethan's cock with her mouth. Her ass was slightly more elevated than her head, because Ethan had sunk down a little with his legs spread (in what looked like a horribly uncomfortable position). Natalie's legs were spread, the implication clear. Her asshole was pink and puckered, but evidence of its violation was there in the slightly reddened hue, the tiny but visible gape in its center. A creamy liquid was nestled inside of it, and I shuddered, thinking of what had transpired while I wasn't looking. How Ethan's cum had filled her up and stayed there inside her ass while she swam at the pool, getting all clean except where she couldn't. Her gash was soaked and I could smell her sweet, excited scent. The insides of her thighs were wet and sticky: whatever could be said about this moment, there was no denying that Natalie was primed for it. She wanted it.

She was a really, really dirty whore. And I loved it.

I reached for her cunt, and slid a finger through her silky juices, running my finger over her clit and making her shudder visibly. I played with her clit for a moment, but I didn't waste much time in guiding my cock to her pussy and finding her swollen hole. Then, with my eyes on her head between Ethan's legs, and the sound of her sucking him off in my ears, I sank into my wife's dirty cunt.

Her heat closed around me, and for a second I was gripped by a wave of excitement so strong that I thought I would spew myself into right in that moment. I steeled myself, and paused. She moved back and forth slightly as she worked on Ethan, and I had to fight through every stroke of her silky cunt as she did.

I sucked in my breath and let her work on Ethan for a while while I was inside of her. But I think I knew, all along, what I wanted to do. I let her juices coat my cock, and then when I felt I could keep control of myself, I dipped a finger into her folds and drew it up to her ass. I played with the

circle of her hole, my fingers sweeping over it lightly. Her ring contracted in response, and I heard her moan into Ethan's balls.

Ethan looked up at me with some alarm. I stared him down and slowly withdrew my cock from Natalie's pussy. I guided it to her ass, and I had to break my stare with Ethan to press it against the right place: right against the center of her hole.

Ethan's hand dropped to Natalie's head, and she slowed her sucking of his cock. As I pressed forward, she stopped completely, but with his entire dick in her mouth and her face pressed into his groin. I could hear her as she struggled to breath, and I looked briefly at Ethan's face, which looked a little worried. I pushed forward.

Natalie made a noise, and Ethan stroked her hair and looked down at her, then back at me. Maybe he even gave me a slight nod. He wanted to see my cock fill her ass up as much as I did. There was a little resistance, as always, but Natalie was becoming such an expert at anal that she relaxed quickly, and my cock sank in, gliding deep into her hot flesh all the way to the base.

She pulled her head away from Ethan's cock, but she was hovering right over the tip of it. He was looking at my dick buried in her ass. She gave a soft moan, slightly pained, and her feet twisted in circles of discomfort. I slowly drew my cock out to the tip, and then slowly pushed back inside of her.

She moaned again, but it was different this time. I saw her head lower again between Ethan's legs as she took his cock back into her mouth.

Ethan curled his hands up in her hair, and began to move her head for his own pleasure. His eyes were still on her ass and my cock, and at this point I was completely ready to burst.

I felt Natalie's fingers brush over my balls – she was reaching between her legs with one of her arms, tucked under her body. She sank her fingers into the dripping folds of her pussy. I fucked her slowly, almost concerned about what would happen to Ethan's cock if I began to slam myself into her the way I wanted to. But soon enough it was too much for me. I felt the quick movements of Natalie's fingers, and I saw that Ethan's jaw was set firmly and straining against his skin.

I started to fuck her rapidly. I could feel her body squeezing my cock, and she began to squirm as her own orgasm built up inside of her. I lost

control and grabbed her hips, and started to pummel her. I felt her legs grow stiff next to me, and she began to scream into Ethan's pelvis.

Ethan came first, his face going totally red and a vein on his temple forming such a terrifying ridge that he looked like he would stroke out. His mouth popped open and he yelled, and pushed Natalie's face deep onto his cock. The sounds from her throat went quiet and I knew he was ejaculating straight into her throat. Natalie's ass squeezed violently around my cock and then began to convulse, and her legs began to shake with her own climax.

I thrust into Natalie hard a few more times, and then I yelled as I buried myself deep in her ass. She released Ethan's cock, and it slapped against his thigh with a wet splat. She turned to look at me, her eyes and cheeks wet with the tears of her gagging on his cock. Saliva and a rope of cum clung to her face for a moment before falling to Ethan's thigh and pasting to her chin. My cum exploded inside of her, and I felt the tight canal of her silky, hot ass throb. My cum turned it to an even slimier, silkier liquid channel. I pounded my seed into her, and her head slammed against Ethan's stomach as I did.

Finally, I pushed on her back to hold myself steady as I shuddered the remaining spurts of cum inside of her. She rested her cheek on Ethan's thigh, her hair mingling in her saliva and his cum, his cock still throbbing away in his lap, scraping against her face. I stayed where I was. My dick was still hard and if I moved it in the slightest, it sent a jolt of pleasurable but almost painful electricity through me.

We panted like this for a while, and then Natalie rose to her hands and knees again. As her body shifted, her ass massaged my sensitive dick.

"Well..." she said, and Ethan actually looked at me in exasperation, the same kind I felt: what the hell would Natalie say now? "Surprise!" she said to Ethan, but in a low, soft voice that almost made me stir back to life again.

She shifted her body and moved her hips forward, then she looked back at me. The implication was clear: she wanted me to slide out of her ass, which was probably good and sore now, considering what she'd been doing. I eased my cock from her ass, and she fell back on to her heels and tossed her hair.

"I... am goin' to take a shower," Ethan said. He was trying to maintain his cool, but it was clear he was pretty knocked off his game. I felt

a flush of pride, almost like a victory: I had finally done something that was outrageous enough to unsettle the great Ethan.

Natalie put a hand on her arm and watched him leave. We waited in silence until we heard the bathroom door close. Then she twisted to look at me.

Her face was a disaster, streaked with tears, a film of drying saliva and probably cum on her chin and cheeks. She wiped under her eye and – actually *giggled*. “What,” she whispered, “got into *you*?”

I kissed her shoulder. There was something about the way things had transpired in that room that had worked like water on the fire of my jealousy. The bad jealousy, the one that suspected Natalie of something nefarious. She was, after all, staying in the room with *me*. Ethan was sufficiently surprised and now isolated enough that it felt, genuinely, like she was *with me*, even if she had just swallowed all of Ethan’s cum. I put my finger on her lower lip and she nipped at my thumb. “Hmm?” she prompted.

I collapsed on the bed and looked up at her, in all of her ruined, naked glory. “It’s a long story,” I said. I rubbed my face.

Natalie rubbed her arms. Then all of a sudden she burst out laughing, and pulled a sheet up to cover her breasts. “What do we do now?” she whispered. She bit her lower lip, smiling at me.

I felt like sleeping, if anyone really wanted the truth.

But I also felt something in my stomach again. And then I realized: I was hungry as hell.

I looked at the door from where I was, as if I would get some clue from Ethan, even though he was clearly still in the shower. “Well,” I said, turning back to Natalie. “I don’t know about you, but I’m hungry as hell.”

She slapped me lightly on the chest. “No. I mean about *Ethan*,” she said.

Oh, that.

Natalie looked thoughtful.

I propped myself up on one elbow. “What happened last night? And this morning?”

She looked at me. “Is that why you’re here?”

I shrugged. “Kind of.”

She sighed, and for a moment I felt my stomach start dropping through the floor again. “I’m sorry about that,” she whispered. “It was...

there wasn't really any way to get in here after.. you know."

Her face was serious now.

I didn't know.

"After...?"

She looked taken aback. "After I told him." She had the impatient-face on. This was the face she got when I had forgotten about something she had said about something she considered really important. I'd seen a lot of it in all these years of marriage.

Told him..? told him? But she hadn't told him about us. Told him what?

"Huh?" I said, stupidly.

She slapped me again. "Told him that he had to move out," she hissed. "After that it was... kind of somber."

I looked at her. My head was spinning. I was relieved, of course, because it had been in the back of my mind that dropping that particular bomb would be a little tricky at this point. "So... what did he say?"

She shrugged. "I mean... mostly he just agreed. And then..." she looked down. "It was, sort of... a little bit sad, so..."

I leaned closer. "So?"

She shrugged again.

"Did you have sex again?"

She looked at me. She looked a little guilty, and as perverse as it might be, I was turned on by it. She bit her lip.

I realized, in that moment, that I really enjoyed throwing her off her game. "Did you?" I pressed.

She shrugged again, but this was more of a deflection than anything. "It was kind of.. sad, you know? Like, not really something I thought you'd want to watch."

The back of my neck burned.

"More like 'making love?'" I said acidly.

This annoyed her. I saw it in her face. "Look. Don't make a big deal of this, I -"

The bathroom doorhandle rattled.

Natalie clamped her mouth shut, and climbed out of the bed, taking the sheets with her. She leaned over me and kissed me on the mouth, and the taste of her mouth was surprisingly free of what I had suspected it might

taste like. "I'll tell you about later, I promise." She threw my shirt and jeans at me on the way out. "I'm going to take a shower," she said.

I hopped out of bed, because I didn't know how long Ethan would be in the bathroom, and I didn't really want him to come back in the room and find me lying around there.

I put my jeans on, after looking around and discovering I couldn't find my boxers. I abandoned them and moved swiftly down the hallway. I was planning to look like I was headed to the kitchen, but the bathroom door was open and steam was escaping it, so I walked by quickly.

I looked in as I passed, and saw that Ethan was standing in front of the mirror, shaving cream on his face. He raised his hand in greeting, comically. I waved back and kept walking, grateful for his sense of humor.

CHAPTER 11: NATALIE'S FANTASY

Natalie was already in the shower, and she was sudsing her hair in a way that communicated that she didn't want to continue our conversation. I sat down on the bed to wait my turn for the shower, watching her rinse our recent escapades away. Her eyes were closed, and her expression was impossible to read.

I was trying hard not to feel.. whatever I was feeling... about the fact that she had fucked Ethan after, what would it be? Breaking up with him? And that she had done it out of sight. Something about that burned me.

I should have been glad, right? I should have been happy that he had agreed, happy that he seemed to be able to be casual about what had happened, happy that "this" wasn't turning into a big deal. Natalie had managed to wrap things up and we could have this little adventure stowed away in our hearts and minds, our sex life invigorated, and everything still intact.

But it gnawed at me anyway.

Natalie stepped out of the shower, and placed a foot on the bathtub to dry herself off. Was it my imagination, or did she do everyday things like drying herself off in a more seductive way now? She seemed to be preening while she dried herself off. Not that I didn't enjoy the show, just... was this Natalie from now on? What was it going to be like living with her?

I slipped out of my jeans and walked past her to the shower. I slid my arms around her and kissed her neck. She responded warmly, making a soft noise and pushing back gently against my mouth. She put one hand behind her and around my neck, and her fingers swept like feathers over my skin. I let go of her reluctantly and got into the shower.

Natalie finished drying off. I struggled to come up with some way to introduce the topic again, but I didn't really know what I wanted to say. Deep down inside, I knew I wanted some kind of reassurance from Natalie, some sort of sealed and signed contract that stated she had no feelings for Ethan.

I was really being kind of a girl, which made me a little revolted by myself.

Natalie slipped on a t-shirt made of very thin cream-colored fabric. No bra. The outline of her breasts was clearly visible, especially now that her skin was darker from so much time in the sun. She shook her hair out. This, too, was different: streaks of sun-kissed blond gave her a vaguely Californian, surfer-girl look. The warm glow of rosy pink and tan on her face changed the color of her eyes, normally a sort of Nordic icy color, to a greenish hue. She smiled at me as she pulled a pair of cream-colored underwear on and slipped them over her hips. They fell neatly against her skin, a perfect contrast against her tan. The shape of her slit showed through the center of them, the two mounds of her labia and the faint tracing of the line of her gash.

She shimmied into a pair of cutoffs and smiled at me again. I realized I was standing there stupidly, so I started to wash my hair. I closed my eyes to rinse off the soap, and when I opened them, she was gone.

I hurried to finish up my shower, a dull panic building in my gut. I knew she had just gone out to the kitchen to get herself a beer or something. She was probably hungry. But she was possibly out there *with Ethan*.

It seemed stupid, even to myself, given what had just happened, to not want my wife to be hanging out with Ethan in the kitchen. But that particular thing bothered me far more than anything else that had transpired.

But I also didn't want to *reveal* that it bothered me, because we'd already talked this one to death.

I dried myself off hastily and threw on a shirt and the first pair of shorts I found in a drawer, which happened to be a pair of Hawaiian-themed shorts Natalie had bought me years ago as a joke. I didn't care. I put my best "calm" act on, and strode into the kitchen.

Natalie and Ethan were on opposite sides of the kitchen island, leaning against it on their elbows and sharing a bowl of chips between them. Natalie was smiling at whatever Ethan had just said in his lowest possible voice, and she brought a chip to her mouth daintily and bit into it, giving him a grin.

My stomach twisted. At the same time, I was sort of relieved to see the normalcy of the scene.

Ethan caught sight of me and stood up. He clapped his hands together loudly. "What do you think," he said, and I felt like I was in free-fall as I waited for him to finish his sentence.

"Of hamburgers?"

My eyes shifted to the back porch. The barbecue was already on, and the air above it was warped with heat. The chips were on the table in a bowl. Natalie was leaning on the counter, biting into a chip, and aside from her bra-less shirt and short cutoffs, there was nothing particularly... well, *anything*.. about this scene.

Ethan twisted off the cap of a beer and extended it to me.

I took it, and he clinked the lips of the bottles together. We met each other's gaze, and had one of those guy moments, of which I'd had many with Ethan. Where something fairly dangerous or stupid had just happened, and we were both silently agreeing to resolving it right then and there with... you know, the "eye."

Natalie watched us and popped a chip into her mouth. "Can somebody make me a margarita?" she asked. "I'm sort of done with beer."

My cock twitched as I thought of the taste of Natalie's mouth, cold and sweet after she sipped on a margarita. The imagery cost me, because Ethan hopped to the other side of the kitchen and was already making her drink. "Comin' right up, darlin'."

I drank about half of my beer in one gulp and went to check on the burgers.

Natalie got into the margaritas pretty heavily. After a few drinks, the mood lightened up. Or maybe I should say, *I* lightened up, because Natalie and Ethan seemed curiously at ease with the situation from the beginning. Ethan was being a pretty gracious guy, even cracking some jokes about how we were kicking him out of the house.

We ate our burgers and steered the topic clear away from anything sexual, mostly gossiping or talking about vacations we'd taken, even a brief foray into politics that was semi-intellectual. No matter how hard I tried to just put myself at ease and enjoy the evening, though, my mind kept coming back to those lost hours with Ethan, to all the suspicions that had built up over the past few weeks and never been resolved. I was good and tipsy, so it wasn't easy to even articulate what those suspicions were, but I still felt them.

The sun went down completely and the bugs started coming out for real – we kept a fan on the porch to blow them away during sunlight hours but at dusk there was no hope. We moved inside in a flurry of glasses and plates and slapping at mosquitoes. At some point, Ethan and Natalie

bumped into each other, face to face, and their bodies collided and pressed together. Just a casual, incidental bump. But they lingered for a moment.

At least, that's what it looked like to me.

I inhaled, and the breath felt like liquid nitrogen instead of air. It sent a shiver through me.

But the moment was over, and Natalie slipped past him to make one last dive at the plates outside. She ran back into the house, nimbly slipping through the door as quickly as possible. She slapped at her arm and dropped a plate. She was drunk. She laughed and nudged the plate under a plant stand with her foot. "Tomorrow," she said.

She plopped onto the bench table, across from Ethan. There were two beers already out, and even though I was pretty drunk, I couldn't refuse the invitation. Natalie still had half a very large (and judging by her demeanor, very strong) margarita that Ethan had kept refilled at all times for her.

I sat down, and we clinked our bottles together again. We exchanged a look between us as we had earlier. But, in that way that drunken evenings shift in mood quite suddenly, the atmosphere changed drastically and without warning. Ethan had something in mind, I could see, and I knew it was something sexual. It was dangerous, it was exhilarating, and my cock was affected whether I really knew what it was or not.

I looked over at Natalie. She had a straw in her fingers and was sucking the margarita up, her eyes on the iced drink. For a moment I thought she was completely oblivious to the new tension at the table, and I had a worry that maybe Natalie was just... done with this whole game. That Ethan was going to start something and she didn't want any part of it, and I would have to be the deciding factor. Ethan's eyes were burning by then, and I could pretty much feel the testosterone burning off of him. He wasn't alone. I could already feel my cock pressing against the cheap fabric of my joke vacation shorts.

Natalie's eyes fluttered up, and she looked first at Ethan and then at me. She wasn't surprised at the way we were looking at her, in fact I could see she had been expecting it. She sat up straight, and her breasts pushed out against the thin white shirt. Her nipples were hard and the view was breathtaking. I looked over and saw that Ethan was gazing at her tits as well.

She played with the slush of the margarita with the straw in one hand. "So," she said, breaking up a silence that I only then realized had been

going on for a strangely long time. “This is it, our last night together.” There was the hint of a smile on her lips.

My cock pulsed to full-throttled life. Ethan’s jaw throbbed under his skin.

Natalie looked from each one of us to the other. Amused with herself, she let the tension build for a minute. “Well,” she said finally. “What do you guys want to do?”

I exchanged a look with Ethan at that point. Even though Ethan had been a pretty big sonofabitch, there was a certain amount of shared camaraderie in this exchange, because the two of us were being taken on essentially the same ride by the newly powerful Natalie, and neither one of us really knew what she was capable of at this point. Especially now that she was two and half margaritas in the bag.

She pulled the bottom tip of the straw out of her drink and brought to her lips, biting on the end of it.

I had a feeling this was some kind of challenge in her mind, that she was waiting for one of us to speak first. Ethan gave me the tiniest, tiniest shake of his head – or maybe I imagined it. It wasn’t going to be him.

There was a long, almost eternal-feeling moment as we sat there, all of us aching in our own way. Ethan took a sip of his beer.

“*I have a fantasy,*” Natalie said finally. Her words cut through the air, and I saw Ethan visibly shudder. She put her hand on my thigh and slid it toward my cock. Without her even touching me, she made it bounce. It brushed against her fingers and she smiled. “Do you guys want to hear it?”

I was pretty certain that I wouldn’t have been able to speak properly even if I had known what to say. Yes, I wanted her to tell me her fantasy, which was almost certainly something so absolutely filthy that we would never be the same, because apparently that’s the creature that had been lurking inside my wife all this time. Did it matter if I knew how I felt about it just then?

I looked at Ethan. I realized that, no matter what had happened here and how I felt about that, I was sort of looking to him for help. He looked, to my disappointment, almost as stunned as I did.

And then his face broke into his very charming smile, and he leaned across the table to take Natalie’s hand. He kissed it, and then grinned. “I’d love to hear all about it, darlin’. Or maybe you can just show us.”

Natalie smiled and looked over at me. She moved closer to me and brought the hand that Ethan had kissed with her to slide into my lap and rub my cock as she leaned into my ear and breathed: “And what about you?”

All I managed was a nod.

Natalie took us to Ethan’s room again. She rose and walked away from the table and back to the room without saying another word. We followed, and by the time we got there, Natalie had stripped off her shirt and was shimmying out of her cutoffs. The two of us stood in the door, not really sure what Natalie’s fantasy was or where we should be to do it.

My head was racing with all kinds of terrible thoughts. I mentioned I’m no newbie to hotwifing, it’s been my fantasy for a long time. But there were things that went beyond that realm, that I wasn’t about to do. I wondered how far Natalie wanted to take things, and even though my cock was pulling me into the room, screaming at me to just do whatever she wanted, there was a part of me that really wished I could call a time out and make sure we were on the same page.

Natalie sat down on the edge of the bed.

Ethan didn’t have the same hesitation I had, evidently, because he moved right over to her. She pulled his shorts down and his cock popped out. She smiled as she stroked it. She gave me a glance and then went back to her visual worship of Ethan’s dick, stroking the length of it with her hand. She brought it close to her lips, and brushed the crown over them. At first, his cock moved with an unhindered smoothness; he was dry and soft against her lips. But the she played with dick against her mouth, teasing him, and soon he was leaving a smear of salty precum on her mouth. She rubbed it all over her lips and then ran her tongue over them, drawing the taste of his seed into her mouth.

I dropped my shorts to the floor and took off my shirt. Natalie looked over at me and beckoned me closer with her eyes.

When I was close enough for her to handle, she took my cock in her other hand. I stared as she stroked Ethan with one hand, and me with the other. She watched my cock until a bead of precum dripped onto the glans. She turned toward me and licked it from the tip of my cock.

“You have to promise not to come,” she said, to us both. “Because then I won’t get what I want.”

Ethan inhaled. “You gotta stop talkin’ like that, darlin.’”

Natalie grinned, and she moved her mouth closer to Ethan's dick. She looked up at him, and made a circle around the tip of his cock with her tongue. All the while she pumped my cock slowly. And then she took him inside her mouth.

My cock throbbed in her hand, but she squeezed it to keep me from bouncing, and from boiling over right then and there. She sucked Ethan down the base of his cock, but she came right back up and let him pop out of her mouth with a plosive slurp. In an excruciatingly slow movement, she shifted her eyes to me, and then her mouth, and then gave me the same treatment: she licked my glans, sliding the tip of her tongue over the ridge, and then she took me into her mouth, all the way to the base. As she did this, she stroked Ethan's dick.

She repeated this cycle a few more times, and each time my gut twisted with the pain of trying to keep myself from exploding right then and there. On the third or so pass she added another element, and tipped her head to the side to drop Ethan's balls into her mouth. I watched her nibble at them greedily and I felt the veins in my cock fill to near-bursting. Natalie looked at me, over Ethan's dick, his balls in her mouth, and squeezed my cock in warning.

Oh yes, Natalie's fantasy.

She released Ethan's balls and licked them like a kitten one last time. Then she sat up and gave her hair a toss. "I want to get *all* filled up, at the same time," she said. She let go of my cock and pulled Ethan toward the bed by tugging at him gently. As I stood there staring, trying to process what she had meant by those words and what I was supposed to do, she pushed Ethan onto the bed and climbed on top of him, straddling him.

She rose up to her full height on her knees, and hovered over Ethan's stiff cock. She took him in her hand, and pointed the tip of his cock at her slit. The room was lit only by the light from the hallway, but I could see that she was glistening with her own excitement. It dripped down Ethan's cock, which was visibly pulsing and looked like it was going to burst open, it was so hard. She drew his cock along the wet center of her body, until she found her clit. And then Ethan and I could do nothing but stare at her as she used his cock to masturbate. She started slow, and moved it in circles over her clit. Then she slid her free hand into her slit and pulled her lips apart. Ethan's cock was shining with her juices by now. His abdomen was strained

as he lifted his head to get a better view – and what a view he had – of my wife using his cock to pleasure herself.

Natalie's breathing became more rapid, and her legs squeezed against Ethan's thighs, and then she threw her head back and gasped.

Ethan lost control, reached for her hips, and jerked her down onto his cock. He lifted his hips to get his thick meat as deep inside of her as possible.

Natalie immediately put her hands down to his chest and leaned toward his chest. "Wait," she said. Her voice was calm and assured. She pressed her hand against him and used her other hand to push her hair from her face to look back at me. Then she drew her hand down her ribcage and along her thigh, back up and between her legs.

Following her cue, I moved to the right, positioning myself at the foot of the bed.

There, I had a nice view of Ethan's cock, glistening with Natalie's cum, embedded in her flesh. She was rocking slightly and lifting her hips, so a few inches of his dick were moving in and out of her. Her pussy was stretched open wide. I had never had quite this view before, and it froze me in place, transfixed.

Natalie moved her fingers over her ass and down to Ethan's balls. She sat up to ride him cowgirl style, and her fingers made lazy circles over his testicles. Ethan groaned, and Natalie slowed. "Not yet," she said. Her breath was ragged. She leaned forward again, and looked back at me. Her hand slid from Ethan's balls to her stuffed cunt, to the small circle of her asshole. She spread her fingers apart, pushing the flesh of her cheeks apart further. She was showing me what she wanted.

I looked at her face again. Her hair was pasted to her cheek, and a strand of it was caught in her mouth. Ethan reached up and pulled it away, and then he traced her lips with his fingertips. Natalie gave me one final searing look, and then she turned to face Ethan and sucked his fingers into her mouth.

I hesitated only a moment more, and then that same compulsion that had driven me into the house in the first place took over. I knelt on the bed, and Ethan moved his legs apart to accommodate me. The shift in position stretched Natalie's pussy even more, and the top of them began to move, unable to stop themselves from the pleasure. I placed a hand on Natalie's

back to steady her, and she tossed her head back with a low moan. I guided the tip of my cock to her ass, and pressed it against the pucker of her hole.

“You’re sure,” I breathed, but it was less of a question than I had meant for it to be. Natalie didn’t say anything, she just lowered her head to Ethan’s chest and waited for me to enter her.

When I pushed into her, she let out a low, strangled cry, and I stopped. Ethan placed his arms around her and pressed his mouth to her ear. Her teeth bit into his bicep, and she panted: “don’t stop.”

So I kept sinking into her flesh.

She was as hot and silky as before, but through her skin I could feel the hard weight of Ethan’s cock pressing back at me. Her ass was tighter than ever before, clamping around me like she was having one fierce orgasm that was unrelenting. At last, my cock sank all the way into her body. I had to lean on her to get myself inside, all the way to the base, but I wanted to feel every inch of her.

She squirmed underneath me, and Ethan whispered to her in her ear. I waited until I could feel her body relax, and then I began to slowly fuck her. At first she whimpered, but Ethan gave me a look that said to keep going, and so I did, slowly, until she began to moan in pleasure.

She rose up a little, and put her hands on either side of Ethan. She was looking him in the eye, and he was looking at her, as I started to pound her from behind. The added pressure of his cock against mine was sending me quickly over the edge, and I had to fight hard as I looked at the two of them staring into each other’s eyes not to just explode. I wanted it to last, and I closed my eyes at least twice to make myself endure.

“Is that what you wanted?” Ethan growled to her, putting his fingers in her mouth again. “You want two big loads of cum at the same time? You dirty girl.”

Natalie just sucked on his fingers, and I was gone at that point. I hammered my cum into Natalie’s ass, and I could feel that as I pounded her, she was also going over the edge. Her ass spasmed around my cock, squeezing it even tighter as it grew wet and slick with my cum. Ethan lifted his hips and thrust upward, even against the weight of us both, until at last he froze with his cock deep inside of Natalie, and yelled loudly. “Holy *fuck!*”

My cock was still hard, and I didn’t feel like pulling out of Natalie just yet. I stared down at the scene, watching Ethan’s fingers work through

her hair with an unsettling familiarity, pulling her sweaty hair from her face, trailing down her neck, setting her skin on fire with goosebumps. I could feel his cock pulsing inside of her cunt. Our cum was draining from inside of her and mingling, pooling on the sheets. Natalie made no effort to extricate herself from the situation, so we remained that way for a while. Then Ethan kissed her on the mouth, and I watched, my cock still inside of her – *his* dick still inside of her – as another man kissed my wife.

It just made my cock twitch to life again.

We rolled to the side, in an extremely awkward motion. But somehow, I managed to keep myself inside of Natalie, though I felt Ethan's dick slip out. My cock was throbbing back to life again, and I wondered what that felt like for Natalie, who made no effort to stop me. She turned slightly and kissed me, but it was a little bit of a strain for her and the kiss landed on the side of our mouths.

Ethan was still facing her, and me, and he was moving his hand up and down the length of her body. I felt Natalie shudder as he stopped at her breasts. I could feel her excitement building up again: she went stiff and jiggled and then squeezed against me as Ethan made circles around her nipples. He lowered his head and made the same circle with his tongue. He bit into her nipple and she quivered all around me. I moved so that I was close to her ear and could nibble at it, and she shuddered with my touch as well.

I felt every ripple through her body as Ethan sucked on her nipples and slid his hand down to the center of her legs. When he ran his finger over her clit, her whole body responded with a sharp jerk. Her throat purred against my hand, and she said something about it being too much. But Ethan kept going, and when Natalie squirmed like she might try to get away, I slid my hand between her legs and lifted her top leg up to give Ethan better access to her pussy.

Each time his finger slid over her clit, her body jerked and she gasped. I moved my lower hand, my right hand, up and close to her head, and I wound her hair in my fist and held her in place. Ethan used one hand to hold her lower leg to the bed. Together, we held her down as Ethan fingered her. She began panting and trying to toss her head, then she whimpered, then she squealed. "Please," she said, "I can't. It's too much... oh, oh, oh..." She started to make utterly incomprehensible noises, and then her whole body went wild. She began to rock her hips against he resistance

of Ethan's grip and mine, and she was so wild it was hard to hold her. Finally she screamed, and I felt the gush of hot liquid from between her thighs as she came violently.

By now I was close to coming myself.

Ethan slid under her leg, and I felt the hard fullness of his cock balloon open her pussy, pressing against me. Natalie was moaning, but her body had gone limp. She resisted nothing as Ethan filled her a second time, and then began to fuck her slowly. His cock was rubbing against mine through the thin, silky layer of flesh between her ass and pussy. I couldn't really move, so I just had to wait for Ethan to quicken his rhythm and send us both, finally, over the edge. He came before me, and I thrust my cock forward and deeper inside of her, filling her a second time with my seed.

I don't know how much time passed between that final orgasm and when I slipped my cock out of Natalie. Ethan was still inside of her, and he dropped a hand quickly to pull her by her ass closer to him. I pushed Natalie's wild hair from her ear and whispered to her, to ask if she was alright. She smiled, and nodded, but she was drifting off to sleep.

I rolled on to my back. I was pretty wiped myself. I stared at the ceiling. I had vague thoughts of getting up, going into my own room. And vague thought about how that was sort of admitting some kind of defeat in this strange game we were playing. While I was thinking about all of this, I drifted off to sleep.

When I opened my eyes next it was still the middle of the night. Natalie had shifted over to rest her head on mine. Ethan was on his back and snoring quite loudly, which meant he'd a great deal to drink somewhere in the evening.

Natalie kissed the underside of my jaw. "You awake?" she whispered. I nodded.

"I can't sleep with this racket," she whispered. "I've been waiting for you to wake up."

She pushed up and held herself suspended with one arm. "Let's go."

So we went back to our room, leaving Ethan buck naked and snoring on the bed.

"I didn't want to leave you in there naked with just Ethan," Natalie said, climbing into bed. She had an amused look on her face.

She grinned at me. At least I thought she did.

I had to say, after I lay down and thought about it for a while, that this was a very thoughtful consideration on her part. Especially for someone who had never had a threesome before.

I was exhausted, but of course this last thought I had jolted me awake: At least, I *thought* she'd never had a threesome before.

Who really knew Natalie anymore? It was a long time before I could get to sleep.

The next morning, Natalie was sleeping with a pillow over her head, which was her sign for "Do Not Disturb." It was late in the morning. We hadn't even gone to sleep all that late, in the end. She must have had a terrible hangover.

I got up and took a shower, and Natalie didn't stir, so I figured she was either genuinely asleep or faking it. I wasn't really looking forward to seeing Ethan, but I also wasn't freaked out by it. And I was hungry as hell, so I went ahead and strolled out into the house.

At first, it seemed Ethan was still asleep. No one stirred in the house except me. I opened the fridge and saw nothing appealing. I thought about going to the store, getting some bacon and eggs, trying out Ethan's method of casual cooking as a cover-up for awkward sexual situations. I was looking for my shoes when the front door opened and Ethan came through. He had an empty milk crate in his hand.

He shut the door quietly.

We nodded at each other.

"Hey man," he said. "Natalie sleeping?"

I nodded again.

He held up the milk crate. "I'm gettin' out of here," he said. "I... you don't mind if I come back for my stuff in the garage later?"

When Ethan had first moved in, he'd brought all kinds of shit with him, including a dining set that was taking up half the space in the garage.

I shook my head in answer to his question. It would be fine.

He strolled back to his room and came out with a suitcase and the filled milk crate.

He started whistling, and I slammed a glass of water while I watched him load his stuff into his car.

He came back into the house. "Well," he said, almost jovially. "That's it."

I was a little slow to say: “Oh. Hey, want some breakfast?”

Ethan shook his head. “I think it’s best I roll out,” he said. He looked toward the hallway and our bedroom. “I think... I’m not gonna wait for Natalie.”

I had no idea what to say to that, but I certainly wasn’t going to argue that he should.

We stood there a little awkwardly for a moment. He made a sound, and then said, “Mmmm...okay. Well. See you around.”

“Yeah,” I said.

We shook hands. In that awkward way guys do when things are awkward.

Ethan walked toward the front door, and I sort of followed him because I felt like locking it after he left. He spun around, like he was reading my mind, and gave me his copy of the key. “Oh yeah,” he said.

I took it and did my best to give a smile of thanks.

Ethan started to turn away, and then he put his hand on the doorknob and turned back. “You know, it’s not really... it’s not my place to say anything, man. After... you know. But... Natalie is really fantastic. Maybe it’ll turn out different for you, maybe she’s not...” he faltered, and I felt dread filling up my torso. “Moirra and me,” he said. “We tried to have an open relationship. So just... be careful, man.”

I raised my eyebrows.

“I know,” Ethan said. “It’s really, really not my place to say.” He was suddenly back to his usual, jokey self. “I’m gonna get outta here before I get hit in the face.”

He clicked his heels, like he was Dorothy.

And he was gone.

CHAPTER 12: THE QUESTION

I stood in front of the closed door for a long time, looking at it blankly. A lot of things ran through my head. Mainly, that I had no idea what to make of what had just happened. Just moments before Ethan had left, it had all felt incredibly and painfully real. Now that he was gone, it took on the quality of a dream so instantaneously that I almost believed it was for a second.

I don't know how long I stood there with my jaw hanging open a little.

“He gone?”

Natalie's voice woke me from my reverie. It was soft, distant. I turned and saw that she was settling into a stool at the kitchen island.

I looked at Natalie in disbelief. She was peering into a cereal box, which by itself was such a monumental change in personality that two weeks ago it would have prompted me to feel her forehead to see if she was feverish. Her hair was down, a little messed up. The sun streaks she had acquired in the past few weeks of sunbathing had bleached her oaky hair. In the light streaming through the window her hair seemed to be blond.

Who *was* this woman?

I started walking toward the kitchen. Natalie abandoned the cereal and set it on the kitchen counter. She rubbed her eyes and put her feet on the bar of the stool. “I'm sooo hungover,” she said.

I was in the kitchen when she opened her eyes.

“What's wrong?” she asked me, when I didn't say anything. I must have had an expression on my face betraying what was happening inside of me, which I didn't even really know or understand. I shook my head.

She reached out for my hand. “Are you sad Ethan is gone?”

I shook my head again, and my gut twisted a little. I was definitely *glad* Ethan was gone. It felt like a huge relief.

“You didn't come out to say goodbye,” I said.

She shook her head. “Yeah, I mean... we cleared everything up when we talked.”

I swallowed hard. This was the thing, the thing I wanted to talk about, and didn't want to talk about, because if she were to tell me something I

didn't want to hear...

"About that," I said.

She looked at me.

"I'm still bothered by it," I said to her silence.

Her face turned to confusion. "How so?"

I sat down on the stool. "I don't know. What... how did you leave it?"

At that particular moment, and for no particular reason, I realized that I had left all of my stuff at the hotel and still needed to check out. I submerged the worry, putting it on the back burner and trying to concentrate on the conversation we were having.

Natalie shrugged. "I mean... we left it like it is. He had to go."

"Yeah, but what'd you say?"

Natalie leaned on her knees. "You really want to know?"

I did. I didn't. I did only if it was what I wanted to hear. "I just want to know what you said. And then... what happened after that."

Natalie seemed to get something in that moment. She lifted her chin.

"Ah ha. So... you're saying you don't really trust me."

I shook my head. "No..."

"That's what it sounds like to me," she said. "It sounds like you're thinking there was something else to this whole thing than just what it was."

I went cold. The kind of cold you get when you've been caught. I tried to maintain her gaze but I had to look away. It was true, after all.

She slid off the stool. "I told Ethan we had to break it off. I felt bad, we have kids, all that. He said he wondered if you didn't already know, and then he told me this whole story about him and Moira, and it was just... sort of depressing, you know? And then it was just like... not even all that sexy when we had sex that time, and kind of just... I don't know. Pity sex or something. And then... I didn't want to disappoint you, so I cheered him up and convinced him to have one last fun day before he left, and that's when you threw in this wild card of showing up." She folded her arms. "Now, do you really want any more detail than that?"\

The question was loaded. What she really meant was: do you actually trust me?

I supposed her story all added up. It was hard to see a softer side of Ethan, but if I was being fair, I'd seen glimpses of it. Back in Chicago when we first saw each other after so many years, back when Natalie and I began on this wild journey by playacting my hotwife fantasy. It was certainly not

impossible to believe that Ethan's mopey mood would last only one evening, and that he would feel better in the morning and let himself be cheered up for one last day of fun.

All the pieces fit in this story.

"I'm sorry," I said, leaning forward and up to kiss Natalie on the chest, grazing over the tank top she had put on. "I just... this was..."

I didn't really have any words to finish the sentence. She put her fingers in my hair and raked her nails delightfully along my scalp, sending a shiver through me. She kissed me somewhere at the back of my head. "I know."

There was a long pause. "I'm pretty happy Ethan's gone," she said. "As fun as this was."

I looked up at her, and reached down to her knees to pull her closer to me. "Are we okay, after all of this?"

Natalie scanned my face, and looked in my eyes. "I'm okay if you're okay," she said finally. "I thought we were just having fun."

"And that's all it was to you?" This was the real question, the one I had been avoiding. "Just fun?"

My heart felt like it was in free fall. It was almost as nerve wracking as asking her to marry me. Maybe more so, because this was a different question, a question about whether or not the stress of this adventure, and all the other stresses of marriage, had broken something inside of us. Or if we were stronger. Or even the same. Any idiot, I realized, can fall in love. It was staying there that was hard. I had a lot of insight in that moment, waiting for answer, into what it was I had really wanted out of this fantasy. And now all I could do was wait to see what she said.

"You mean with Ethan?" she said, and her sentence ended with a laugh. "What else would it be?" She was incredulous.

"I don't know. You didn't... get any feelings for him or anything?"

"Uh... no." She rolled her eyes. "You *can't* be serious."

I felt like a big weight was being lifted. "Not even when you... er, broke up with him?"

"The guy was in the dumps because he lost. He might have been saying he was really in love with Moira, but really he was just.. it was something else. I didn't buy it. He's too much of a... I dunno. Narcissist or something. Fun... but come *on*. You think I'd fall for a guy like that?"

It was true, I didn't think Natalie would fall for a guy like Ethan. But there were a number of things that if someone had asked me three weeks ago whether I thought my wife would do them or not, I would have said no to. And been totally wrong.

"You've been doing a lot of surprising things lately," I countered.

This made her laugh. "True. But... not like that. No." Her face got suddenly serious. "I thought we were just having fun," she said. "I didn't think it was going to get serious like this."

"You said it wasn't."

"You're the one being serious, I mean. I thought we talked about this."

I shrugged helplessly. I was the one being serious, my shrug said, but here was nothing I could do about it.

She pulled me to her again and kissed me on the top of the head. "I only love Erik Ossington," she said. "Promise."

I inhaled the scent of her body. Somehow, she had showered in the morning, while I was out in the kitchen with Ethan. I looked up at her.

She looked concerned. She brushed her fingers over my lips. "Don't you believe me?"

For the first time ever, there was a sort of desperation present in her voice.

Finally. It was important to her if I believed her or not.

I put my hand behind her neck and pulled her toward me. "God, of course, Natalie."

I kissed her, and it was a long, deep kiss. I felt something else inside of me reignite – something distinct from physical passion. An appreciation of Natalie, of what we had, of the trust that existed between us. It suddenly felt so silly that I had doubted these things, but they were much more valuable now that I saw them in a new light. As something to cherish, pay attention to. Something that could be risked and therefore was not just a given.

Natalie sat back down on the stool when I released her. She was still looking at me, scanning my face to be sure that I meant what I said.

"I love you," I told her.

"I love you, too."

And then I remembered it again. "Shit!" I said. "The hotel."

She frowned.

“Want to go with me to check out, and get some breakfast at the diner down the road?”

She smiled and shrugged. “Sounds good. You didn't check out?”

I felt a red flush on my face. “I was in some kind of state,” I told her.

She kissed me again. “Tell me about it in the car. It's like... ten-thirty.”

She scurried to the bathroom. “Should I wear that white shirt again?” she called out.

I followed her after second-guessing a decision to get my shorts from Ethan's room. “Uh...” I said loudly. “Let's maybe tone it down for a bit.”

She was already pulling on a conservative – but still sexy – red t-shirt, and I just missed a glimpse of the bra she had put on underneath it.

But she did pull on her cutoffs.

“Meet you in the car,” she said, tapping me on the shoulder as she bounced out of the room, pulling her hair into a ponytail.

She looked both more like herself and even less so as she hopped away.

The juxtaposition was pleasing.

END

MORE FROM ARNICA BUTLER

*If you enjoyed **Te Houseguest** and **Natalie's Seduction**,
give my other novels a try!*

*See [My Author Page](#) for a complete list of books, or peruse the
blurbs and titles here.*

[*Body of Research*](#)

When ever-suspicious Chris plays private detective on his wife's phone and finds that she uses dozens of dating apps, he worries that his darkest fantasies have come true. And it may not be as delicious as he had

imagined.

It turns out that Jen is up to something other than cheating, and the door is open for the two of them to explore the boundaries of their marriage. But in any experiment, the results can be unexpected...

A Conventional Hotwife

Paul Banks was thrilled when a luggage mix-up five years ago opened a window of opportunity for his long-buried desires. Since that time, he and his wife have been playing a little game at their yearly company conventions, and every year his wife ups the ante, going further into his fantasies. But Kathy Banks might be getting just a bit out of control, and things might be going a little too far...

Or not.

Grand Slam: An Interracial Hotwife Adventure

Charles keeps a secret desire about his wife Zoe. Her sizzling beauty is typically hidden under scrubs and a hair bun, so his fantasy may never happen. But a wrong turn on a weekend getaway turns out to be the opening pitch of a very naughty game, and Zoe seems determined to knock it out of the park.

A Well-Laid Trap (2-Part Series)

It all begins when Patrick is convinced he saw his wife with another man at a downtown bar.

He begins to investigate. But the more Patrick uncovers about Jordan's activities, the less he understands.

The biggest problem is, Patrick can't decide how he really feels. On the one hand, his wife seems to be betraying him, and on the other, his sex life has reached a scorching pinnacle he never thought possible.

But he had better hold on to his hat, because when he finds out the truth, things will get much, much hotter than he might have ever imagined...

Opening Up

If you are a fan of Arnica Butler but missed her first few novels, or if you prefer scorchingly hot but romantic fare, enjoy this bundle containing Arnica Butler's previously published, light and fun hotwife novels: ***The Hotwife Summer***, ***The Hotwife Tattoo*** and ***A Gamble***. These novels are not in KU, but the whole set can be yours for only \$4.99!

Ela's Performance

Peter's sweet-faced and fiery wife is headed back to school for a degree in violin performance. Unexpectedly, Peter finds himself becoming very paranoid about who Ela is spending so much time with, and what she is doing at school so very late. It isn't as if he doesn't have his reasons for suspicion. There's the way his own relationship with Ela started, and their own past experiment with an open relationship before they were married. A few other strange things to fuel his jealous fantasies...

And when he discovers someone from Ela's past has resurfaced, he'll take a chance and confront his own desires and obsessions...but will he get what he really wants?

The Hobby Job

Former career professional Laura is going crazy living her stay-at-home-mom life in a small country town. Her husband Conrad has the perfect solution: get a “hobby job.” Laura gets turned on to the idea, and to Conrad's surprise, chooses to wait tables at a run-down restaurant down the street. But she gets a lot more than a hobby job when she meets Nate, a young, hot waiter who has his eyes on her from the start.

Conrad and Laura start on separate journeys, exploring new possibilities in their marriage, and opening up to their hidden desires, fantasies, and needs. Will their journeys merge, or will Laura's “hobby job” make a hobby of their marriage?

The Hotwife Tattoo

When Greg's brother marries his wild, tattooed, ex-girlfriend Renee, he knows things will be a little complicated. But when Renee befriends his wife Sara, she starts to change in almost unbelievable ways. Greg sees that there is something more to Renee's plans than just friendly sister-in-law bonding. Is Renee's influence all bad, or can Greg get something he has always wanted and never admitted to his wife – maybe even himself?

The Tenant: A Very Naughty Hotwife Novel

Once upon a time, his exotic and incredibly sexy wife Anna loved to indulge Brian's fantasies...to a point. She teased strangers, and took them to cruel, tantalizing places. But she never went all the way. The game ended when Brian and Anna got married, and that was that.

Or was it?

When the gorgeous, charming, and very black John moves into their basement rental, Brian finds that his sleeping desires have been building up all these years. He doesn't just want Anna to tease. He isn't just toying with the idea. He is obsessed with driving his wife to do things with another man. Lewd things. Obscene things.

When he confesses his desires, is Anna just a little bit too willing to make things just like old times? Is she too easy to push over each new line? Brian can't help but wonder if his own obsessions have gone too far...or if Anna's have.

A Gamble: The Making of A Hotwife

Ryan is just an average guy, coaxing his sweet, beautiful wife Victoria into playing into his hotwife fantasy – even if they're just pretending. But a trip to Vegas with his co-worker Brad and his sexy wife Irena turns Ryan's life upside-down. To help Ryan, Brad makes a proposal that could change everything...but it all centers on Victoria's innocence. How far will Victoria go to save what she holds most dear, now that her virtues, her love for

Ryan, their marriage, Ryan's desires, and even their finances all hang in the balance? This is a 52,000-word novel about risk and romance, filled to the brim with the hard, steamy scenes you love. Please enjoy!

The Hotwife Summer

When Ben and Summer have the chance to spend the summer in Italy, their stale marriage starts to heat up in ways Ben could only have dreamed about. Summer is ready to take his hotwife fantasy all the way, and her choice is a sexy, Italian, Michelin star-studded chef. It's too late to put the brakes on what he's set in motion when Ben discovers the humiliating truth about Summer's choice of man. Summer has a taste for being naughty, and a filthy little plan of her own. Will it be everything he could wish for, or will Ben's cuckold fantasy turn into a nightmare he can't escape?

Well-Constructed Affairs

As a hot female construction engineer, John's wife Adria draws a lot of attention at the job site. Which isn't all bad. But when Adria opens the door for him to tell her about his sexual fantasies, he doesn't realize she has opened the door on her own – very dark – fantasy as well. A fantasy she hasn't shared with anyone until now. The couple are off on an exploration of their desires...but is their marriage well-constructed enough to withstand the forces of their fantasies?

Nikita Gets In Too Deep

When Cole and his wife Nik arrive at their usual vacation spot in dull Cape Breton, they're taken by surprise by the most unlikely of next-door neighbors: ultra-sexy Paige and wealthy, commanding Mitch. And these new neighbors are full of surprises. Cole and Nik embark on new adventures in their marriage, trying new things and pushing boundaries they'd never even discussed. It's invigorating, but Cole can't help but wonder if his transformed wife hasn't gotten herself in too deep...

Not Black And White

When a photographer turns Rick on to the idea of watching his wife with another man, Rick feels an obsessive desire inside of himself catch fire. He can't help arrange for his shy, girl-next-door wife Danielle and the rugged, black photographer to cross paths. He knows that Drake Reyes' erotic photographs are not as abstract as they appear, and that Reyes sleeps with his married models. He knows his wife is not immune to Reyes' charms – no one is. He just can't help but imagine what it would be like to stand in his gallery, looking at Reyes' lurid photos, knowing his own wife is the model, knowing how the photos were taken.

But was it really his idea, or have Drake and Danielle been as manipulative as he has?

Please note, this is the novelized version of the short story Black and White, with significant changes to all scenes depicted in the short story, as well as the point of view. There is, however, some repetition: scenarios which occurred in the short occur in the novel. There are plenty of fresh new adult scenes, however. Please enjoy.

A Dark Place: Cuckolded In Lagos

Three people are carving out their fortunes in Africa's largest city, but each of them holds a deeper, darker desire. What is the secret desire of the angelic Charlotte, who finds all men's eyes on her after dark in Lagos? What about Andrew, who keeps a secret hunger so buried perhaps he doesn't admit it even to himself? And what could be darker than Clement Ambode's already shadowy “*reliability*” as an all-purpose contractor in the underbelly of Lagos?

Charlotte, Andrew, and Clement will find themselves in a very dark place when their worlds collide in this ultra-sexy, novella-length cuckold story.